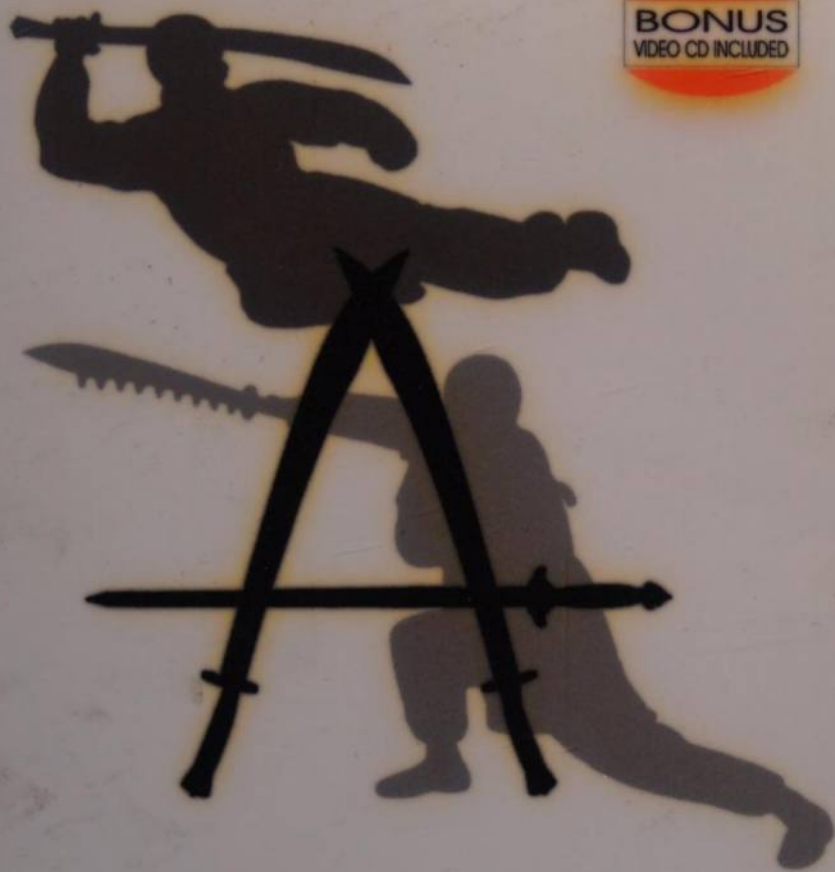


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Wushu

The Ultimate Fighting Art

by

Andrean Karavastev

Wushu: The Ultimate Fighting Art



Wushu

THE ULTIMATE FIGHTING ART

STYLE DIRECTIONS, STYLES AND COMBAT APPLICATIONS

By Andrean Karavastev

DISCLAIMER

Please note that the author and the publisher of this instructional book is NOT RESPONSIBLE in any manner whatsoever for any injury, which may occur by reading and /or following the instruction herein.

It is essential that before following any activities, herein described, the reader or readers should first consult his or her physician for advice on whether they should embark on the physical activity described here. Since the physical activities may be too sophisticated in their nature, it is essential that a physician be consulted.

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Foreword

The strong penetrating influence of "Eastern" combat arts has generated an interest in studying this genre. As a consequence of this invasion, an arising "hunger" for more information has appeared. This necessity has been intensified with the increased featuring of "Eastern" movies on the world big screens.

This book contains consecutive series that constitute an "Encyclopaedia of the Martial Arts", published by "Vitezda". The choice of the Wushu (the Chinese Combat Arts Direction) is not accidental. According to the scholars "Wushu is the root", and the other styles and directions are the branches of Eastern Combat Arts. Returning to the primary source and its knowledge gives us the basis for the respective training. As a result, the training is naturally following the century-old traditions in these arts.

The aim of this book is not to fully embrace all aspects of Chinese Combat Arts. It is impossible to present the great variety of information in this publishing. Here, the basic style directions of Wushu have been extracted so that the reader can have a sample of some of artistic forms. The goal is for the reader to become acquainted with the practical aspects and the essence of this art. The terminology used herein is suited to incorporate a wider audience. In the Chinese Combat Arts the concept Wushu means Military Art. The colloquial name "Kung Fu", which gained popularity means "High Arts". It characterizes the human activity not just in the combat arts but in the other areas too. For comprehensive understanding of Wushu, the styles and style directions* included here are presented in the light of the modern classification* used in contemporary China. The analysis of the forms of Wushu and their combat applications are consistent with the motto "*Ten ounces practice are more than thousand pounds of theory*".

From the Publisher

**There is a difference between the concepts "style direction" and "style". The first one is used in a wider sense and includes styles similar in origin and principle.*

**From the traditional perspective this classification of Wushu styles is relative and can be subjective.*

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Brief history and origin of Wushu

The rise of the Combat Arts in China began in ancient times. The first documented information was in the epoch of the Yellow Emperor (2670 B.C.), who possessed an elite army. This massive power of ancient China was a serious threat to its enemies. Historical documents reveal the existence of an overwhelming amount of knowledge in the area of the Military Art. The individual training of the ancient soldiers included excellent mastering of the fighting methods with different weapons and bare hands. The use of strategy, such as planning and preparation of the place of military actions in advance were mandatory conditions for leading a successful fight.

Individual techniques with bare hand are referred to for the first time in the Ceremonial Book (Chou Dynasty B.C. 1045-256). Records for the Art of the Fist are missing until Han Dynasty (B.C. 206-A.D 220). Later, at the end of the second and the beginning of the third century (A.D) the famous doctor Hua To wrote the book "Five Animals Play". He presented some physical and breath exercises, imitated the behavior of the Tiger, Deer, Bear, Monkey and Crane. Even though the techniques could not be defined as martial, they include some elements of the current Internal Styles.

The new Combat style, similar to "Long Hand" was created from Kwok Yuen. Unfortunately, the original movements were lost during the centuries, but the similar movements that reached our days show that the toughness and force existing during that time were replaced with the adroitness, dexterity and mindfulness of the Combat Arts.

1. Shaolin direction

The new era in the creation of the Chinese Combat Arts began from Shaolin monastery in the Honan province. The Temple was founded in 497 A.D. Under the guidance of the monk Batuo this cloister is transformed into Center of the Buddhist doctrine. Thirty years after (527A.D), in Shaolin came another monk.

This was the legendary Bodhidharma, well known as Daruma Taishi, Dot Mor, Ta Mo. As a son of Sugancha Maharaja, he obtained the mandatory training and excellent knowledge in Combat Arts as required of every Kshatriya (member of the warrior caste in India). Trained by the famous at that time in India, master Guinatar, he achieved perfect mastership of Vairamutchi – forms, that are accepted as basic of the 18 Hands of Lo Han. According to the legend, Bodhidharma went into a seclusion in a cave close to the monastery and meditated facing the rock walls for 9 years and that is why he left the print of his face on the stone. Today every tourist or pilgrim can get a wax stamp of it. It is presumed, that during his stay in the cave, Bodhidharma prepared the new trend in Buddhism-Chan (well known in Japan as Zen), which afterwards strongly influenced the Eastern Martial Arts. Training his students, he introduced a system of exercises for concentrating one's inner power of the "heart and mind". The physically weak monks would hardly endure the heavy meditative practices without this preparation. The legend tells that Bodhidharma, upset from the nap he fell into during meditation, cut his eyelids. His system of exercises has remained in the history of Chinese Martial Arts (Wushu) under the name "The 18 Hands of Lo Han". Its movements have the effect of strengthening one's health and also contain fight elements. Besides "force" it trains people in the Art of Striking with Dexterity.

The appearance of Bodhidharma and his system is the foundation in the creation of Wushu, but he is not the founder of the Combat Arts. His successors created and enriched his system, in which the emphasis has been on the inner aspects of the techniques. The history of the monastery tells of an unknown monk, who succeeded to expel with "wild" blows and kicks the "Dispersed" (robbers), who terrorized the holly for Buddhists Cloister (A.D 580). The creation of the Shaolin direction in Wushu has been directly connected to the political situation in China at that time. Indicative is the history of the 13 monks who rescued Emperor Li Shi Min and assisted in the establishment of the Tang Dynasty (A.D. 618-907). Thereafter began the best years of the monastery. Its fame spread all over the country. The consequence was a ceaseless flow of pilgrims, some of which were masters of Wushu. They have contributed to the enrichment of the Combat Art of Shaolin. Many monks preaching the Chang Buddhism traveled throughout the country and adopted the fighting methods that have been used from the inhabitants of the respective provinces. The turning point in the creation of Wushu began during the Ming Dynasty (A.D.1368-1644) and it is directly related to the name of the monk Kwok Yuen (second half of the 16 century). He further developed the 18 techniques of Lo Han, increasing them to a total 72. While on a journey to look for new techniques for enriching the martial system of the monastery, Kwok Yuen met two masters, Pai Yu-feng and Li Chang. With the latter one he went back to the monastery. Kwok Yuen and Li Chang developed a system containing 172 martial techniques, based on

the movements of the five animals – Tiger, Crane, Monkey, Snake and Dragon:

Tiger: hand (fingers), intuition.

Crane: blows, pushes, mind, concentration.

Monkey: legs, character, personal skills

Snake: combination of hand- made weapons, Chi cultivation.

Dragon: circle movements, Chi circulation.

They symbolized the actions of the human mind and body. Two-thirds of the Combat systems are built on this basis. These are the so called External styles. The preparation of the monks went through a very heavy psychological and physical training. The legend describes that the covering of the masters degree comes after the overcoming of very heavy and dangerous constraints. The tested monk had to get through labyrinths with different traps. On the way he went through rooms with poisonous snakes and dangerous predators. In other rooms of the labyrinth, he would be confronted armed attackers, whom the monk had to eliminate without injuries. Artificial precipices and mechanical knives, hammers, wooden dummies, permanently threatened the monks' life. A false step or movement could run hidden mechanisms that additionally complicated the already dangerous passage. At the exit of the labyrinth, a 300 lbs red-hot cauldron was positioned. Passing the labyrinth the successful monk received original master "certificate" – two stamps on his burned hands, called "The nails of the Dragon".

The falling of the Ming Dynasty (1644 AD) and the establishment of the power of the Manchurian Ch'ing Dynasty (A.D 1644-1912), brought about the burning of the Shaolin temple and killing the most of the monks (A.D 1650). According to the legend, only five of them survived and they kept alive the Combat Art of Shaolin. The five monks visited and stayed in many provinces of ancient China. They combined Shaolin fighting methods with those practiced by the locals. This led to the creation of the five major combat directions in Wushu:

Hun - based on force and techniques of the "Long Hand".

Fut - "Short Hand", cutting techniques with hands and light footwork.

Mok - a type of "Long Hand" with high kicks and explosive techniques.

Choi - fast and sneaky movements of the hands and body.

Li - a type of "Short Hand" with many pushing techniques.

2. Wudang direction

Another revolutionary trend in the development of the Chinese Combat Arts (Wushu) is the Wudang direction . It got its name from the mountain with the same name,

located in the Hubei Province. The Taoist monk Chang San -feng is accepted as the "father" of Wudang direction. One day he became an involuntary witness to a fight between a snake and big bird. The heavy and strong strokes of the hard beak and nails did not succeed to affect the reptile, which "won" the battle using soft and flowing movements. Chang San -feng created the Principles of Tai Chi Chuan (The Fist of the Great Ultimate) based on Taoist philosophy and examination of the analogical movements in the nature (water breaks the rocks, the grass stands up to strong wind). Striving for harmony and following the laws of the Nature is the leading point in this system. Enriched by many masters, like Chen Wang Ting (7 C.E), Chen Chang Hsing (1771-1853), Yang Lu Chan (1799-1872), Yang Cheng Fu (1883-1936), the Art of Tai Chi Chuan became the most popular style in recent days.

Another system of Wudang (the roots of which could be traced back to ancient times) is Ba Gua Chang (The Box of the Eight Trigrams). Many discussions are held about its origin and the founder of this system. One of the most interesting styles of Ba Gua was created by the great master Tung Hai Chuan (1798-1879). A robber, a monk and a bodyguard of the emperor, a person with immoderate temper, an excellent fighter-these are the characteristics given to this great man by the historians. Trained in the Lo Han Chuan (the Box of Buddhists Arhats), Tung Hai Chuan learned the Principles of Ba Gua from Pi Cheng Xia - Taoist preacher from the Anhui Province. In addition, he developed and enriched the system with his personal technique, which later became the most popular system of Ba Gua Chang. He taught his art to many students the most famous of whom were Cheng Ting Hua, Yin Fu, Ma Wei Chi and others.

Hsing-I Chuan (Form Mind boxing) is the third by significance combat system from the Wudang direction. It is not known when and who created this style. The legendary general Yueh Fuei (A.D 1103-1142) is credited as a "father" of Hsing -I. His teacher was a wandering Taoist who had no traceable name.

The master Ji Long- feng (A.D. 1602-1683) from Shanghai is regarded as the founder of Hsing-I, the style that reached recent days. Trained by the Taoist mentor Ji Ho, he learned the techniques of a fighting system accepted today for the prototype of the contemporary Hsing-I. The tradition continued and was refined by many masters, among them the legendary Li Luo Neng, Ma Xue Li, KuoYun Shen and Sun Lu Tang. Comparing the two directions in Wushu (Shaolin and Wudang) the following conclusions can be made:

Spiritual structure:

Shaolin- Buddhist influence

Wudang – Taoist influence

Character:

Shaolin- – external, (exoteric)

Wudang – internal (esoteric)

Work:

Shaolin – external, upon body

Wudang- internal, upon breathing and circulation of the internal power Chi.

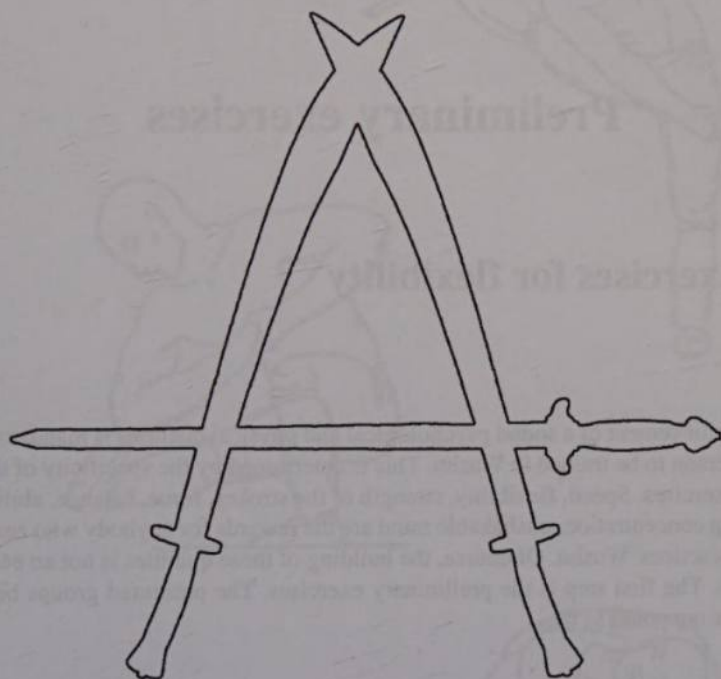
Movements:

Shaolin – hard, extreme, dynamic.

Wudang – soft, smooth, harmonic.

According to the same Chinese historians, the fight of the representatives of Shaolin against the emperor court (Ch'ing Dynasty) took the form of numerous rebellions, which brought about the "antipoison"- direction of Wudang. Other researchers proved the connection between these two directions in Wushu. A very popular explanation is that Chang San- feng on his way to Sichuan stayed in the Shaolin monastery to be trained in Combat Arts. He turned to Taoism later. Disappointed by the practice of Shaolin causing a huge loss of "preliminary energy", Chang Sang-feng refined what he had learned and created a more effective system. Although there are contradictory explanations, having in mind the origin and the creation of the styles and directions in Wushu, one fact is undeniable, the primary sources is one. This is proved by the similar general principles, characteristic movements, the natural supplementation, combination and integration of the combat methods of the different fighting systems.

Today, Wushu embraces more than 350 styles. The two major trends are - External and Internal styles developed on the basics respectively of Shaolin and Wudang. The first trend is classified in three subdirections- Long Fist (Chang-Chuan), Short Fist (Nan Chuan) and Imitative styles. The grouping is relative and subjective. In every style there are tens of other substyles but they do not differ from the main Principles. Today Whushu is known throughout the world . This system gives to people who exercise it health, joy, mental and spiritual mastership.



CHAPTER 2

BASIC TRAINING

Preliminary exercises

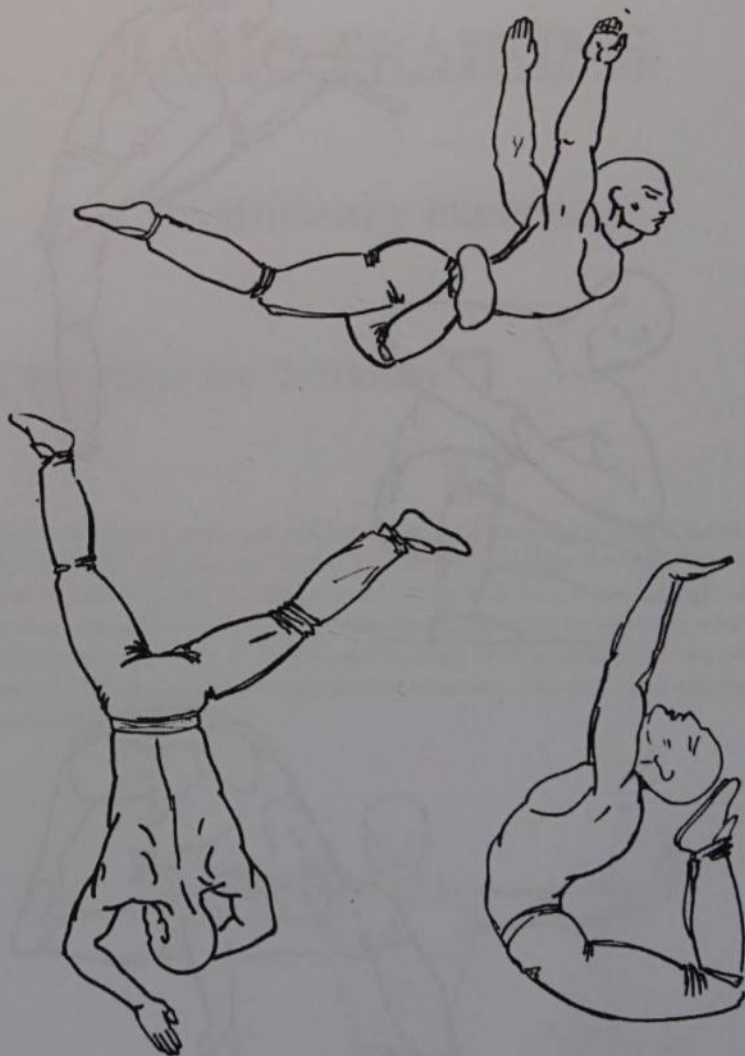
1. Exercises for flexibility

The achievement of a sound psychological and physical qualities is mandatory for a person to be trained in Wushu. This is determined by the specificity of the form exercises. Speed, flexibility, strength of the strokes, force, balance, ability for deep concentration, unshakable mind are the rewards for anybody who zealously practices Wushu. Of course, the building of these qualities is not an easy process. The first step is the preliminary exercises. The presented groups best illustrate our points so far.





2. Exercises for dexterity and coordination



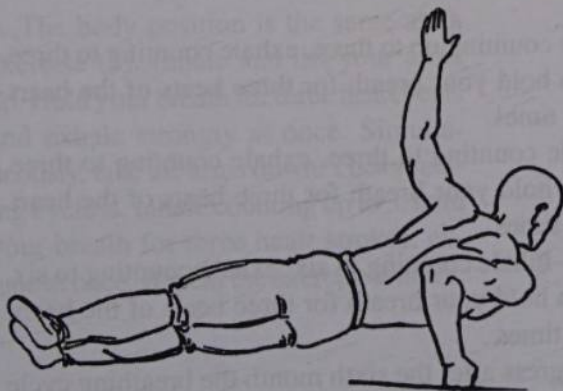
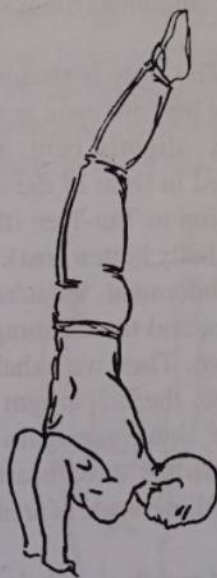
3. Exercises for balance



4. Falls



5. Exercises for force



The exercises of the Buddhists monks

Here we present the very popular Bodhidharma's system of preparation exercises - "The exercises of the Buddhists monks".

1. The body is straight and relaxed. The legs are open at shoulder width and slightly bent. The hands are lifted in front of the chest. Concentration in Tan-Tien (the point under the belly button area). The breathing is abdominal. We inhale counting to three and the diaphragm is pressed down. Then we exhale counting to three, the diaphragm goes up. Before inhaling again we hold our breath for three heart strokes. The breathing cycle is presented below:

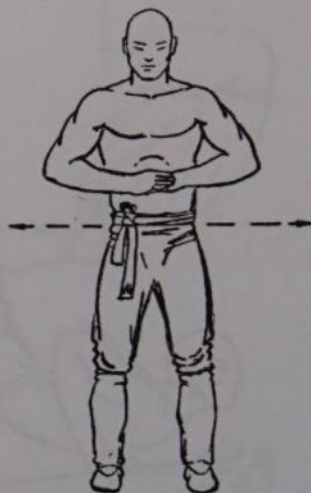


Fig.1

First month – inhale counting up to three, exhale counting to three, before inhaling again hold your breath for three beats of the heart. Repeat the exercise 6 times.

Second month –inhale counting to three, exhale counting to three, before inhaling again hold your breath for three beats of the heart. Repeat the exercise 9 times.

Third to sixth month -inhale counting to six, exhale counting to six, before inhaling again hold your breath for three beats of the heart. Repeat the exercise 9 times .

Depending on the progress after the sixth month the breathing cycle can be longer, for instance counting up to twelve instead of six.

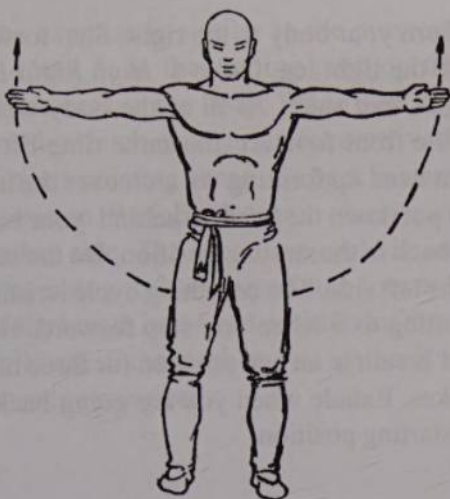


Fig.2

2. This exercise is naturally related to the first. Start to inhale. The arms are going in an arch at the sides and upwards at shoulder level. Simultaneously, the body is raised on the toes. In this end position hold your breath for three heart beats and begin to lower the body. The breathing cycle is the same as in exercise 1.

3. The body position is the same as in exercise (2). Inhale and lift your arms up. Hold your breath for three heart beats and exhale strongly at once. Simultaneously, take the arms down. The breathing cycle is: inhale counting up to 3, hold your breath for three heart strokes, exhale at once. Repeat the exercise 9 times.



Fig.3

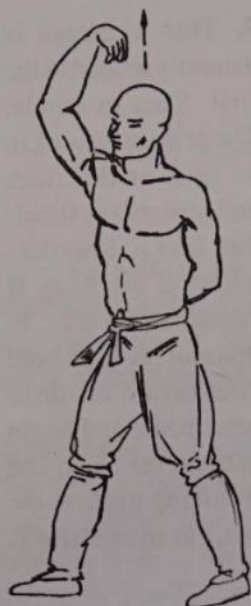


Fig.4

5. This exercise is similar to the previous (4) one. The only difference is in the arm position. The raised hand has the fingers pointing upwards and the palm is facing backwards. The rear arm goes straight back. The palm is directed upward (fig5). The breathing cycle is the same.



Fig.5

6. The exercise is similar to the previous two, 4 and 5. In the starting position the arms are next to the body. When you step forward, stretch your arms forward with the fingers pointing ahead. Go back in starting position. Perform the same exercise on the other side. The breathing cycle is: inhale counting to 3 when you step forward. Hold the breath in the end position for three heart beats. Exhale when you go back in the starting position.

*Fig.6*

7. Step forward as in the previous exercises. The right hand goes behind the head and touches the left ear. Simultaneously, the left hand is bent at the right side of the back. Go back to starting position. Perform the same on the left side. The breathing cycle is: inhale counting to 3 when you step forward. Hold your breath in end position for three heart beats. Exhale when you go back in a starting position.

Fig.7

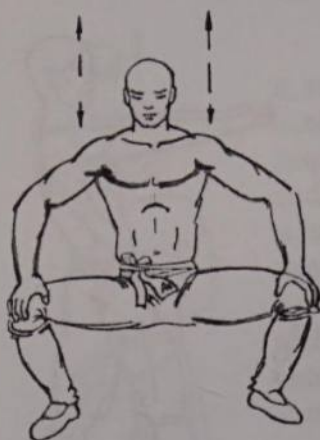


Fig.8

8. Go into a *Horse Stance*. The feet are parallel and the distance between them is twice your shoulder width. Begin to squat slowly until the pelvis touches the floor. Stay for a while bit in end position. Start to get up slowly. The breathing cycle is: exhale counting to 3 when you squat down, inhale when you get up back in the starting position. Hold your breath for three

heart beats.

9. Take *Neutral (Standing) Stance*. Stretch your right arm. The left one is held on the hip. Perform the same on the left side. The breathing cycle is: inhale counting to 3 when you stretch your arm. Hold your breath in the end position for three heart strokes. Exhale when you are taking down your arm and changing the position.



Fig.9

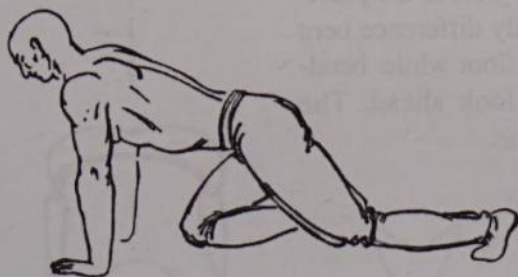


Fig.10

10. Take a knee position and put your hands on the floor. The toes are bent. Begin slowly "to creep" at one place changing your legs. When the right knee goes ahead, the left leg is stretched back and

when the left knee goes ahead the right leg is stretched back. The breathing cycle is: inhale counting to 3 when you move your legs. Hold your breath in the end position for 3 heart beats. Exhale counting to 3 in this position (the end position).



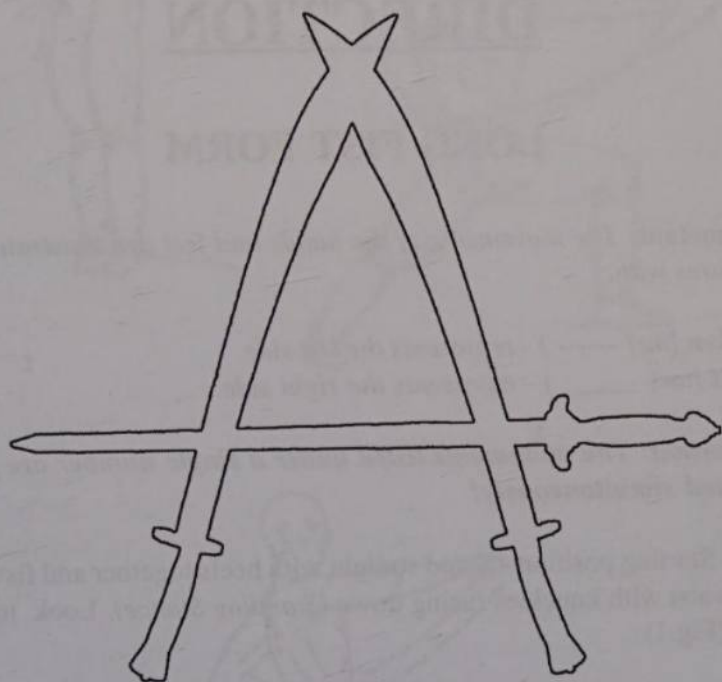
Fig.11

11. Start by placing your hands behind the neck. Bent down your body slowly. When the head reaches the knees stay for a while and go back in upright position. The breathing cycle is: exhale counting to 3 when you bent down. Exhale when you go back in the starting position. Hold your breath in the upright position for 3 heart beats.

12. This exercise is analogical to the previous one (exc.11). The only difference here is that the fists touch the floor while bending the body and you look ahead. The breathing cycle is the same.



Fig.12



CHAPTER 3

NORTH SHAOLIN

DIRECTION

LONG FIST FORM

Important: *The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:*

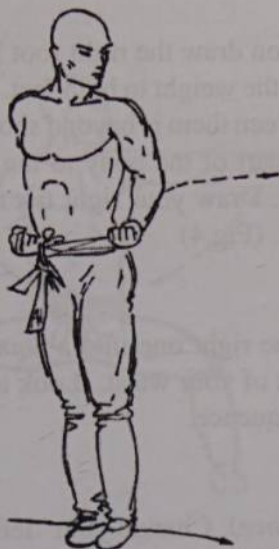
*Broken line(-----) - represents the left side.
Solid line(_____) - represents the right side.*

Important: *The movements listed under a single number are performed simultaneously!*

1. Starting position - Stand straight with heels together and fists on the waist with knuckles facing down (*Standing Stance*). Look to the left. (Fig.1)

2. Take one step forward with your left foot. The center of gravity is shifted to the left foot. The left leg is bent and the right straight (*Left Bow Stance*). Move your left hand forward "parrying" a left blow with the fingers pointing upward. Look ahead. (Fig.2).

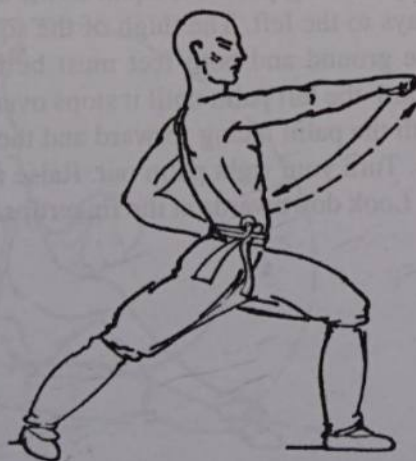
3. In the same position, strike forward with your right fist. Hold your left hand into a fist and draw it back to the left side of your waist (the knuckles facing downward). Look ahead. (Fig.3)



1



2



3

4. Following the preceding position draw the right foot half a step to the right, squat slightly and shift the weight to both feet. They are placed parallel and the distance between them is beyond shoulder width (*Horse Stance*). Turn the upper part of the body to the right and strike to the left with your left fist. Draw your right fist to the right side of your waist. Look to the left. (Fig.4)

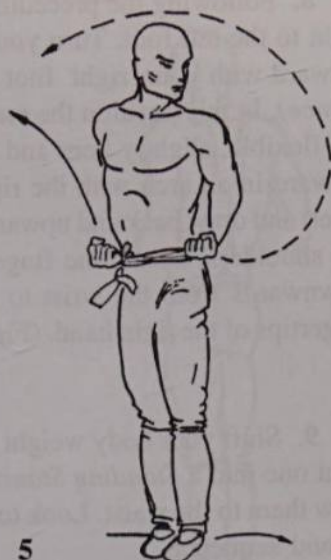
5. Move your left foot back to the right one into a *Standing Stance*. Draw the left fist to the left side of your waist. Look to the left (fig.5). This is the end of the first sequence.

6. Raise your left knee (*Crane Stance*). Change your left fist into a palm, bend it in front of your chest. The palm is facing down. Strike with the fingers of the right hand diagonally upward (the palm is facing up). Look to the right. (Fig. 6).

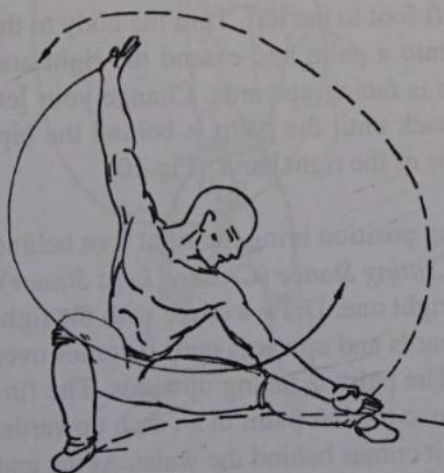
7. Following the preceding position, squat down on the right leg and stretch sideways to the left. The thigh of the squatting leg must be parallel to the ground and both feet must be flat (*Snake Stance*). Twine downward the left palm until it stops over the inner side of the left foot with the palm facing forward and the fingertips diagonally downwards. Turn your right palm out. Raise and extend the right arm upwards. Look downwards at the fingertips. (Fig. 7).



4



5



7



6

8. Following the preceding position shift your weight from the right to the left foot. Turn your body to the left and take one step forward with your right foot to form a *Frontal Empty Stance (Cat Stance)*. In this position the rear leg is turned inwards with the front leg flexible, slightly bent and relaxed. The feet are parallel. Strike forward in an arch with the right palm (the fingers are at shoulder level) and draw back and upwards the left one until it goes higher than the shoulders. Bunch the fingertips of the left hand and turn them downwards from the wrist to form a "hooked hand". Look at the fingertips of the right hand. (Fig.8)

9. Shift your body weight forward and draw the left foot to the right one into a *Standing Stance*. Change your palms into fists and draw them to the waist. Look to the left (fig.9). This is the end of the second sequence.

Important: *For better understanding the reverse (frontal) side of the third sequence is also presented. It is performed in the opposite direction.*

10. Take a step with the left foot to the left. Turn the body to the right. Change your right fist into a palm and extend the right arm diagonally upwards. The palm is facing upwards. Change your left fist into a palm and move it back until the palm is behind the hip, facing in. Look at the fingertips of the right hand. (Fig.10)

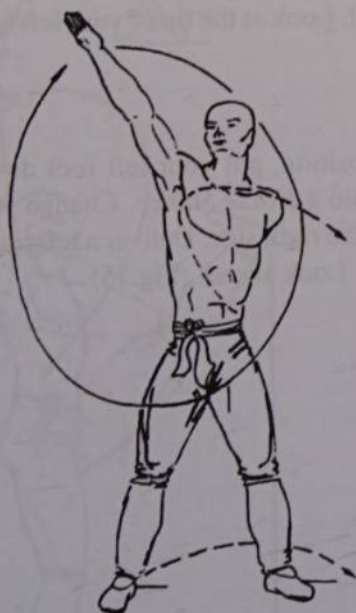
11. Following the preceding position bring the right foot behind the left one. Squat down into a *Sitting Stance (Crossed Legs Stance)*. The left leg is "sitting" on the right one. Draw a circle with the right palm leftward and then downwards and upwards until it comes over your head (on the right side). The palm is facing upwards. The fingers are pointing to the left. Move the left palm in an arch upwards, rightward and backwards until it comes behind the waist. At the end position form a "hook- hand" with fingers pointing upwards. Look to the left. (Fig.11)



8



9



10



11

12. Lift upwards your body and turn it slightly rightward. Extend the arms. Move the right palm diagonally upward and the left palm down and backwards. During the movement stretch the fingers. Look ahead. (Fig.12).

13. Following the preceding position, turn your body 180 degrees counterclockwise (to the right) while pivoting on the right foot. The arms are still extended. Move the right palm in bow down and backward. Bring the left up and forward. Look forward. (Fig.13)

14. Following the preceding posture, continue the movement of the left palm forward, downward and backward until it comes behind the waist forming "hook-hand". Move the right palm in an upward arch. Kick forward with the left foot. Look at the tip of your left foot. (Fig.14)

15. Following the preceding position, put your left foot down, turn the body to the left and go into a *Horse Stance*. Change your right palm into a fist and bring it to the right side. Deliver a left round elbow stroke in front of your chest. Look ahead. (Fig.15)



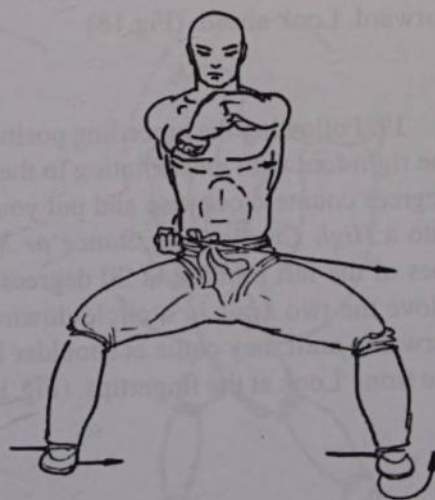
12



13



14



15

16. Turn the body and the left foot 90 degrees counterclockwise (to the left), pivoting on the right foot. Squat down into a left *Sitting Stance*. The left leg is positioned upon the right one. Punch straight down with the right fist. Draw the left fist to the left hip. Look ahead, at the right fist. (Fig.16)

17. Shift your body weight forward to the left foot, lift your body upwards and turn it to the left side. Move the right foot to the left one into a *Standing Stance*. Draw your fists to the waist. Look to the left (Fig.17). This is the end of the third sequence.

Important: *The presentation of the next, fourth sequence is given in actual side and direction, starting from fig.17.*

18. Take one step left with the left foot. Change your fists into palms. Extend your arms in front of the chest with palms facing forward. Look ahead. (Fig.18)

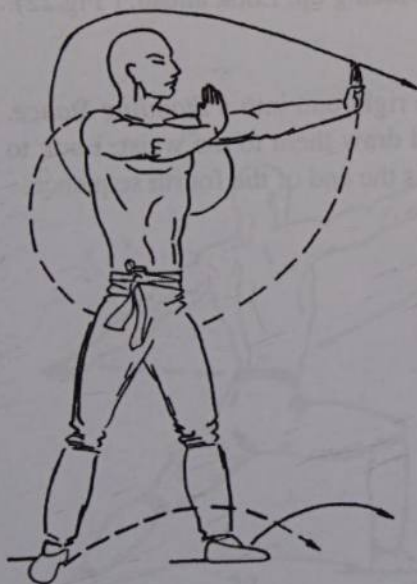
19. Following the preceding position take one step forward with the right foot with toes pointing to the left front, turn your body 180 degrees counterclockwise and put your left leg behind the right one into a *High Crossed Leg Stance* or *X- Stance* (in this position the toes of the left foot are at 90 degrees to the heel of the right one). Move the two arms in a circle downwards, leftward, upwards and forwards until they come at shoulder level. The palms are facing to the front. Look at the fingertips. (Fig.19)



16



17



18



19

20. Turn your body 270 degrees counterclockwise (to the left) while pivoting on the balls of the feet. Move the left arm in a circle downward, leftward and the right one downwards and leftward. The palms are facing in. Look at the fingertips of the left hand. (Fig.20)

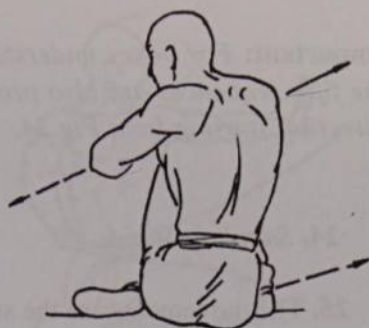
21. Continuing the preceding movement turn your body 90 degrees counterclockwise (to the left). Sit down in a low *Sitting Stance* (*Twisted Stance*). The left leg is positioned on the right one. Slightly hold the right wrist with your left hand and deliver a left elbow stroke backwards. Look to the left(Fig.21a and Fig.21b).

22. Shift your body weight forward to the left foot. Lift up your body and turn it slightly rightward. Take one step with the right foot forward into a right *Bow Stance*. Deliver a blow forward with the edge of the right hand and bring the left downward to the back. The arms are extended. The palms are facing up. Look ahead. (Fig.22).

23. Move your left foot to the right one into a *Standing Stance*. Change your palms into fists and draw them to the waist. Look to the left (Fig.23 and Fig.24). This is the end of the fourth sequence.



20



21a



21b



22



23

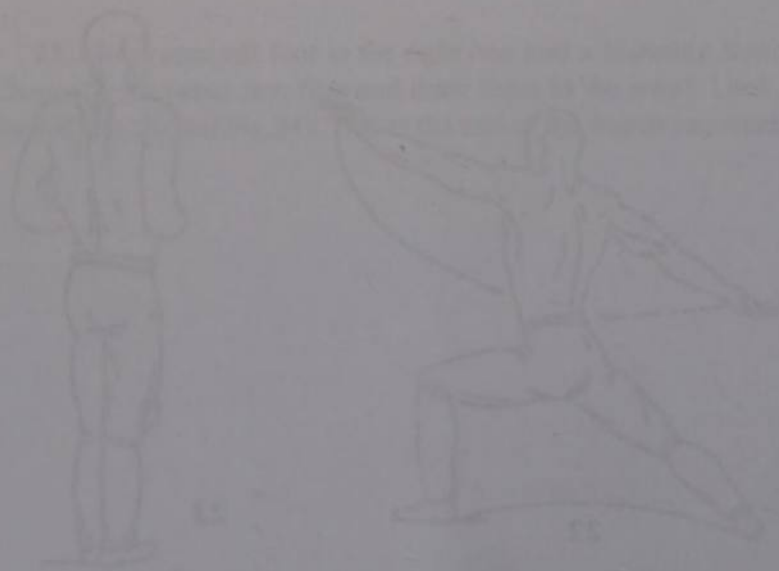
Important: *For better understanding the reverse (frontal) side of the fifth sequences are also presented. It is performed in opposite direction starting from Fig.24.*

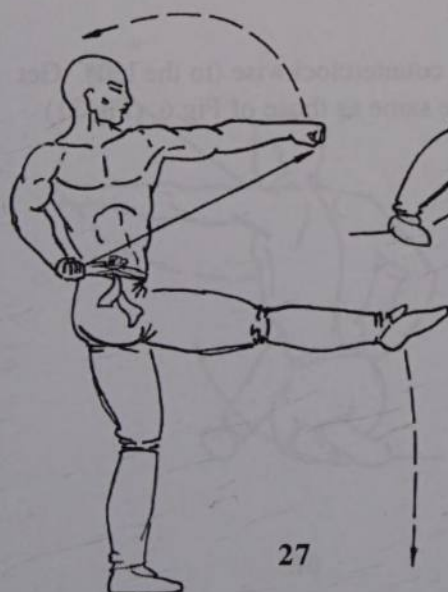
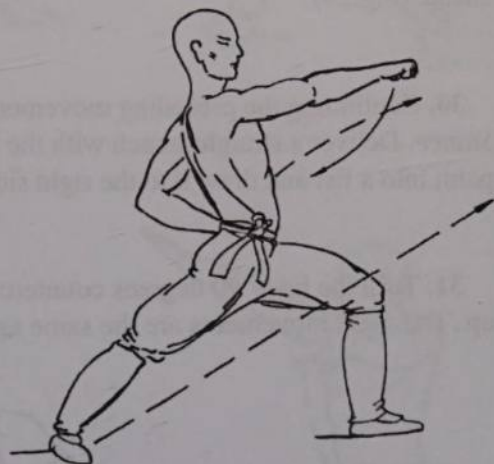
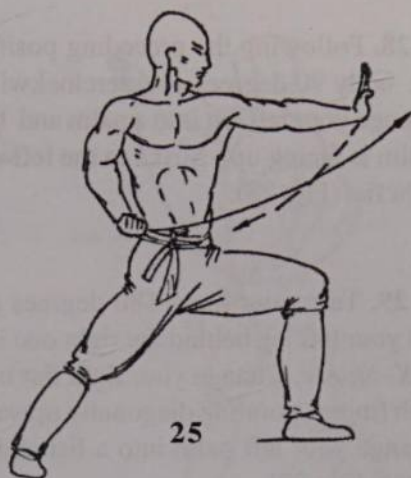
24. Standing Stance.

25. The movements are the same as those in Fig 2. (Fig.25)

26. The next movements are the same as those in Fig.3. (Fig.26)

27. Following the preceding position, strike forward with your left fist, kick straight forward with the toes of the right foot on the level of the stomach and draw your right fist to the side (Fig.27).



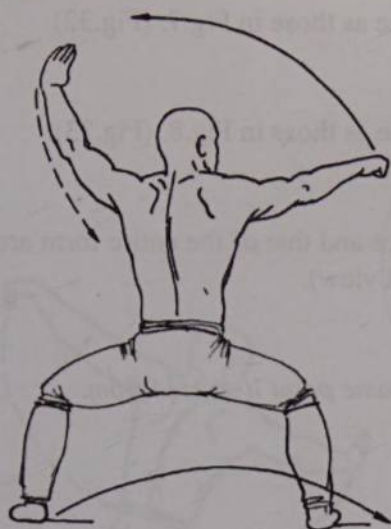


28. Following the preceding position, put right foot down, turn the body 90 degrees counterclockwise and go into a *Horse Stance*. Change your left fist into a palm and bring it in an arch over the head (palm is facing up). Strike to the left with your right fist. Look at the right fist (Fig. 28).

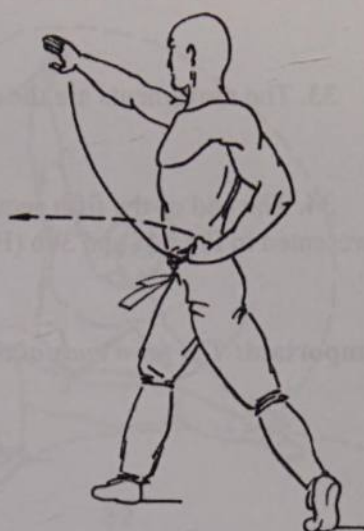
29. Turn your body 180 degrees counterclockwise (to the left). Put your left leg behind the right one into a *High Crossed Leg Stance* or *X- Stance*. Change your right fist into a palm and bring it forward with fingers pointing diagonally upwards. The right arm is extended. Change your left palm into a fist and draw it to the left side. Look ahead. (Fig.29)

30. Continuing the preceding movement squat down into a *Sitting Stance*. Deliver a straight punch with the left fist. Change your right palm into a fist and draw it to the right side. Look ahead. (Fig.30)

31. Turn the body 90 degrees counterclockwise (to the left). Get up. The next movements are the same as those of Fig.6. (Fig.31)



28



29



30



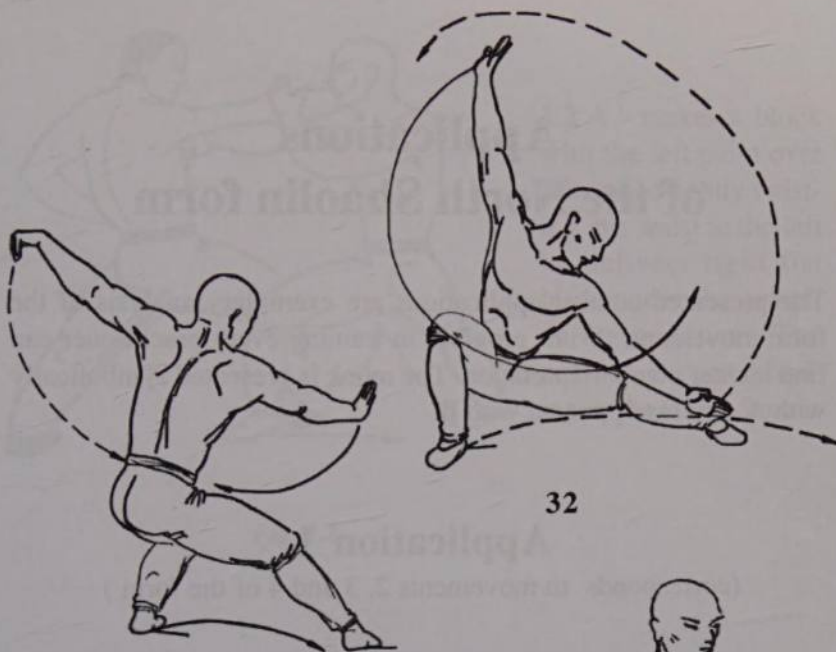
31

32. The movements are the same as those in Fig.7. (Fig.32)

33. The movements are the same as those in Fig.8. (Fig.33)

34. The end of the fifth sequence and that of the entire form are presented in Fig.34a and 34b (Front view).

Important: *The form ends at the same point it started from.*



32

33



34a



34b

Applications of the North Shaolin form

The presented combat applications are exemplary analysis of the form movements. With progress in training every practitioner can find his/her own interpretation. The monk is presented symbolically with **A**, and his opponent with **B**.

Application 1

(corresponds to movements 2, 3 and 4 of the form)



Fig. 1.1

1.1 B strikes A's head with the right fist taking a *Right Bow Stance* .

A - blocks his opponent outwardly with the edge of the right palm. Simultaneously, he delivers a straight punch with the left fist in the **B's** armpit.

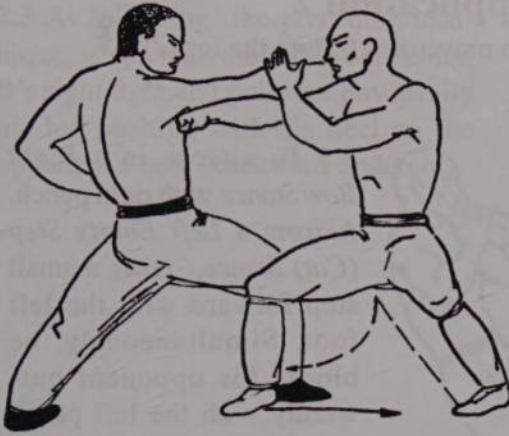


Fig. 1.2

1.2 A - makes a block with the left palm over B's arm. Slightly twisting his waist to the left he delivers right fist blow under the armpit of the opponent. The position is corresponding to the *Horse Stance*.

1.3 A-pulls very quickly sliding back right foot and delivers left low kick - (undercut) to the lower part of the opponents leg.



Fig. 1.3

Application 2

(corresponds to movement 6 from the form)



Fig. 2.1

2.2 A-continues with a blow using the edge of the right hand (reverse knife hand) on the opponent's neck.



Fig. 2.2

2.3 A- following the preceding technique, steps with the right foot behind **B's** right thigh and pulls out powerfully his leg pushing with his heel on the opponent's heel (backward undercut)



Fig.2.3

Application 2A

(corresponds to movement 6 from the form)



2A.1 B- the same as Appl. 2.1

A- From a *Left Frontal (Bow) Stance* delivers a blow to **B's** face with all fingers of his right palm .

Fig.2A.1



Fig. 2A.2

2A.2 A- makes half a step with the left foot diagonally forward and a full step with the right foot behind B's thigh. Simultaneously, he locks the right elbow of his opponent as shown on the illustration (Fig.2A.2)

Application 3

(corresponds to movements 11,12,13, and 14 from the form)

3.1 B- kicks forward with the left leg.

A-From a *Left Empty Stance* he blocks with the left forearm his opponent's stroke. Simultaneously, he goes into a *Left Crossing Leg Stance* moving his right foot forward towards his opponent.



Fig. 3.1

3.2 A- turning from left to the right, he goes from a *Left Crossing Stance* into a *Right Frontal (Bow Stance)*. At the same time, using the turning of the body, he delivers an upside down blow with the right palm upon **B's** head



Fig. 3.2



Fig. 3.3

3.3 A- pulls back quickly, sliding back his right foot and kicks forward with the left foot to **B's** buttocks.



3.4 A- changes the left forward kick into a stamped kick in the folding of his opponents leg. At the same time, he delivers a punch with his left palm in an upward arch into B's face.

Fig. 3.4

Application 4

(corresponds to movements 17 18, 19a, 19b from the form)

4.1 B- delivers a right straight or round stroke standing in a Right Bow Stance .

A- blocks B's punch inwardly with both hands. The left palm gets in contact with the opponent's wrist and the right with inner part of his elbow.



Fig. 4.1

4.2 A-makes a small step towards **B** with the left foot behind the right one and goes into a *Right Cross Stance*. Simultaneously, he delivers a double downward blow with the edges of the hands. The left hand hits **B**'s chest and the right one **B**'s temple.



Fig. 4.2



Fig. 4.3

4.3 A- turns his body 180 degrees counterclockwise and goes into a *Horse Stance*. At the same time the left elbow hits **B**'s arm.

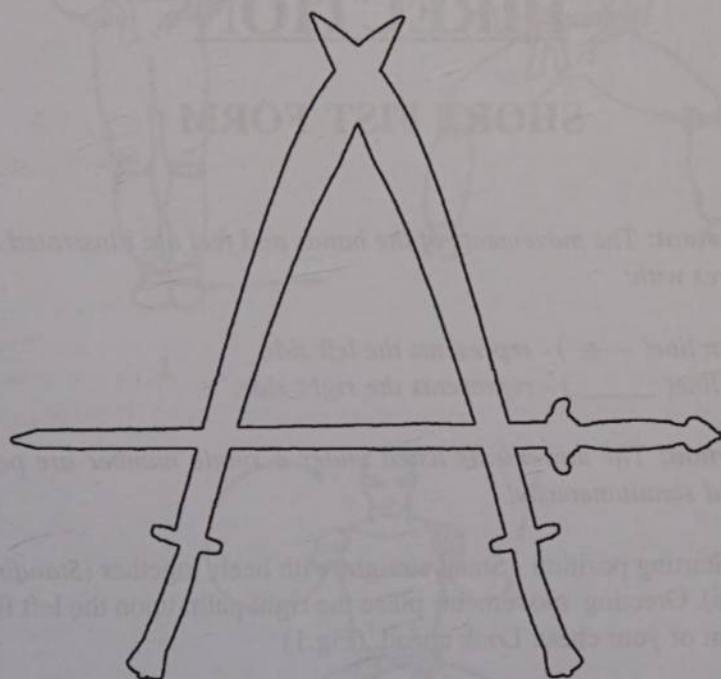


Fig. 4.4

4.5 A- throws B through the left flank.



Fig. 4.5



CHAPTER 4

SOUTH SHAOLIN

DIRECTION

SHORT FIST FORM

Important: *The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:*

Broken line(-----) - represents the left side.

Solid line(_____) - represents the right side.

Important: *The movements listed under a single number are performed simultaneously!*

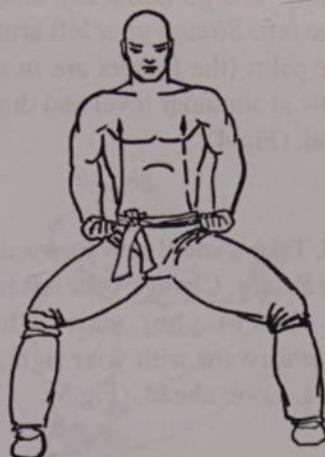
1. Starting position - Stand straight with heels together (*Standing Stance*). Greeting movement- place the right palm upon the left fist in front of your chest. Look ahead. (Fig.1)

2. Following the preceding position, step with the left foot to the left and go into a *Horse Stance*. Change your left palm into a fist, bring it to the left side and pull the right fist to the right side. The knuckles of the fists are facing down. Look ahead. (Fig.2)

3. From the same position strike forward with both fists. (Fig.3)



1



2



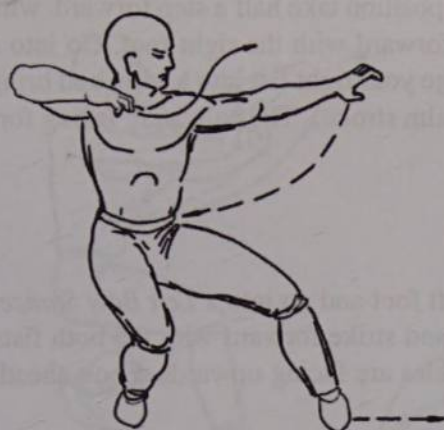
3

4. Shift your body weight to the right foot. Pull the left foot slightly and go into a *Left Empty Step (Cat) Stance*. Turn the body to the left. Stretch your left arm forward. Change your left fist into a tiger palm (the fingers are in a grabbling position). Lift your right elbow at shoulder level and draw the right fist to the shoulder. Look ahead. (Fig.4)

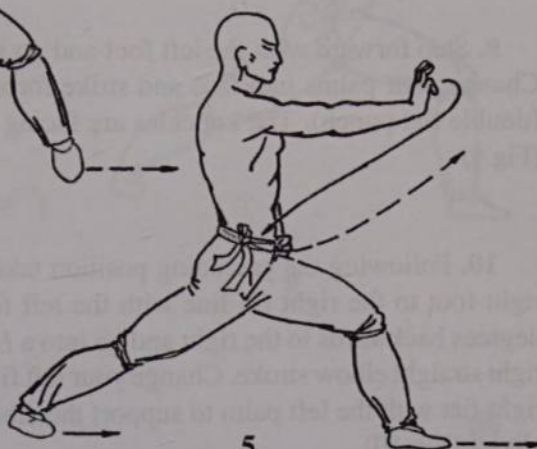
5. Take a small step forward with your left foot and go into a *Left Bow Stance*. Change your left hand into a fist and draw it back to the left side of your waist (the knuckles facing downwards). Strike forward with your right palm with the fingers pointing upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.5).

6. Following the preceding position, take one step forward with the right foot, turn your body 90 degrees to the left and go into a *Horse Stance*. Change your right palm into a fist and bring it back to the right side of your waist. Strike to the left with your left fist. Look at the right fist. (Fig.6).

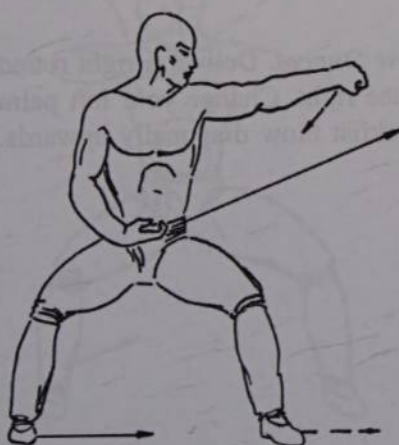
7. Take a small step to the left with the left foot. Move forward and take down the right knee towards the left leg and go into a *Left Half Knee Stance*. Punch forward with a vertical right fist. Change the left fist into a palm and draw it back to the right underarm. The fingers of the left palm are pointing upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.7)



4



5



6



7

8. Following the preceding position take half a step forward with the left foot and a large step forward with the right foot. Go into a *Right Half Knee Stance*. Change your right fist into a palm and bring both palms forward (double palm stroke). The palms are facing forward. Look ahead. (Fig.8)

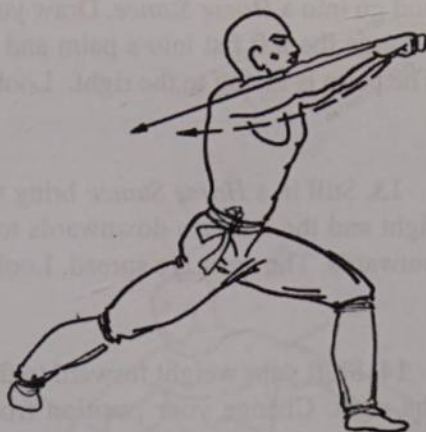
9. Step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Bow Stance*. Change your palms into fists and strike forward with the both fists (double fist punch). The knuckles are facing upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.9)

10. Following the preceding position take a small step with the right foot to the right (in line with the left foot), turn the body 90 degrees backwards to the right and go into a *Horse Stance*. Deliver a right straight elbow stroke. Change your left fist into a palm. Push the right fist with the left palm to support the elbow stroke. Look at the elbow. (Fig.10)

11. Raise your right knee (*Crane Stance*). Deliver a right round backfist blow downwards and to the right. Change your left palm into a fist and deliver a round backfist blow diagonally upwards. Look at the right fist. (Fig.11)



8



9



10

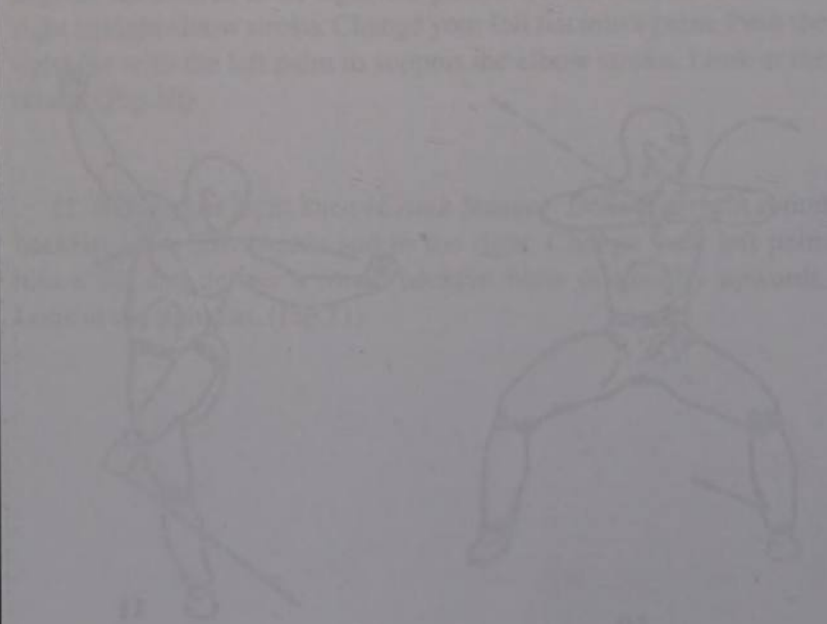


11

12. Following the preceding position, put your right foot down and go into a *Horse Stance*. Draw your right fist to the left shoulder. Change the left fist into a palm and move it under the right armpit. The palm is facing to the right. Look to the left. (Fig.12)

13. Still in a *Horse Stance* bring the right arm downwards to the right and the left arm downwards to the left with the palms facing outwards. The arms are spread. Look to the right. (Fig.13)

14. Shift your weight forward to the right foot. Turn your body to the right. Change your position from a *Horse Stance* into a *Low Right Bow Stance*. Deliver a bottom-up stroke forward with the back of the left fist (the left arm is stretched). Stretch the left arm backwards. The arms are extended. Look ahead. (Fig.14)





12



13



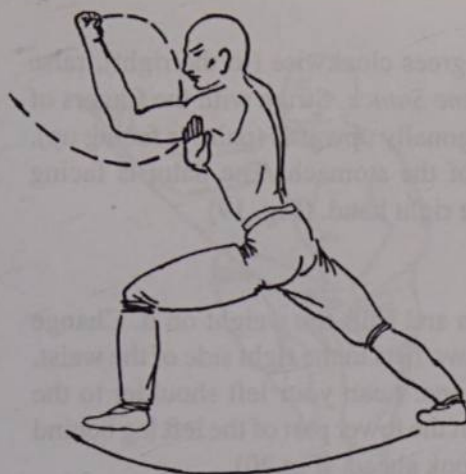
14

15. Take one step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Bow Stance*. Move your left arm upward and slightly forward. The back of the fist is facing forward. Change your right fist into a palm. Bring the right palm under the left armpit. The fingers are pointing upwards and the right palm is facing outwards to the side. Look at the left fist. (Fig.15)

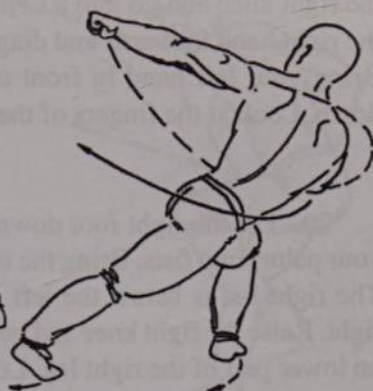
16. Following the preceding position, turn your body 180 degrees clockwise (to the right) and put forward your left leg behind the right one into a *Crossed Leg Stance* (*in this position the toes of the right foot are 90 degrees to the heel of the left one*). Deliver a punch with the base of the left fist to the left. The left arm is stretched. Look at the left fist. (Fig.16)

17. Following the preceding position, turn your body 180 degrees clockwise (to the right) while pivoting on the heels of the feet and go into a *Horse Stance*. Change your right palm into a fist. Strike downwards with the base of the right fist to the right. The right arm is stretched. Change your left fist into a palm and draw it to the right shoulder. The left palm is facing forwards and the fingers are pointing upwards. Look at the right fist. (Fig.17)

18. Shift the weight to the right foot. Turn your body 180 degrees counterclockwise (to the left) and go into a *Left Empty Step (Cat) Stance*. Change your right fist into a palm and bring it in front of the stomach. Strike forward to the left side with the knuckles (or fingers) of the left hand. Look ahead. (Fig. 18)



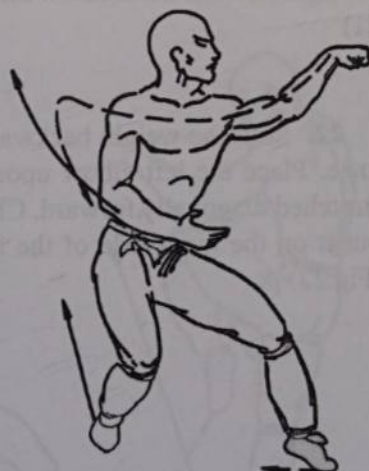
15



16



17



18

19. Turn your body 180 degrees clockwise (to the right), raise the right knee and go into a *Crane Stance*. Strike with the fingers of the right hand forwards and diagonally upwards (palm is facing up). Bring your left hand in front of the stomach. The palm is facing down. Look at the fingers of the right hand. (Fig. 19)

20. Put the right foot down and shift the weight on it. Change your palms into fists. Bring the two fists to the right side of the waist. The right fist is below the left one. Lean your left shoulder to the right. Raise the right knee and put the lower part of the left leg behind on lower part of the right leg. Look ahead. (Fig.20)

21. Step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Bow Stance*. Strike forward with the back of the left fist and with the knuckles of the right fist (left fist is below the right one). Look at the left fist. (Fig. 21)

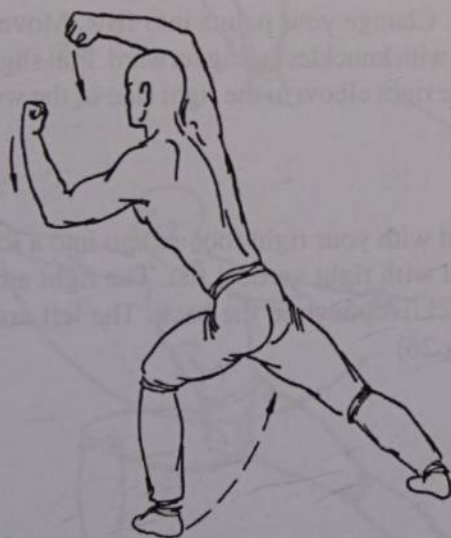
22. Shift the weight backwards to the right foot. Raise your left knee. Place the left elbow upon the left knee. The left forearm is stretched diagonally forward. Change your right fist into a palm and put it on the inner side of the left forearm. Look at the right fist. (Fig.22)



19



20



21



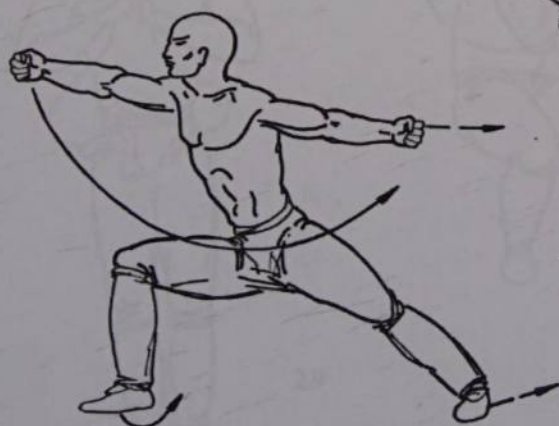
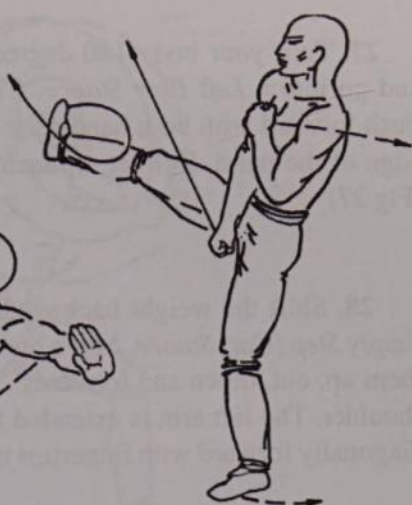
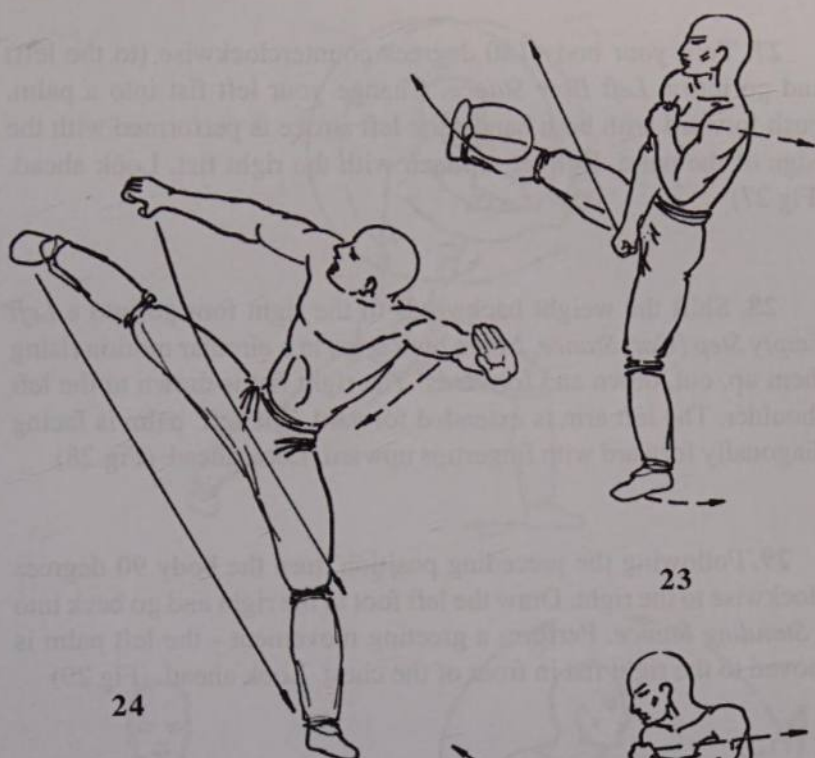
22

23. Following the preceding position, put your left foot down. Kick forward with the right leg. Change your right palm into a fist and put it between your legs. Move the left fist in front of the chest. Look ahead. (Fig. 23).

24. Following the preceding position, pull the kicking leg backwards and kick forward with the same (right) leg pivoting on the heel of the left foot. Change the fists into palms and spread out your arms to keep the balance. The right arm is stretched forward with the palm facing to the right. The left arm goes backwards with the palm facing to the left. Look at the right foot. (Fig.24)

25. Following the preceding position, pull the kicking leg back next to the left leg. Squat slightly with the left leg. The weight is on the left foot. The right foot is next to the left one touching the floor with the toes (Chicken Stance). Change your palms into fists. Move the left fist to the right shoulder with knuckles facing forward. Pull slightly your right arm and bring the right elbow to the right side of the waist. The fist is turned upwards.

26. Take one step forward with your right foot and go into a *Right Bow Stance*. Strike forward with right vertical fist. The right arm is extended. Deliver a left backfist punch to the back. The left arm is extended. Look ahead. (Fig.26)



27. Turn your body 180 degrees counterclockwise (to the left) and go into a *Left Bow Stance*. Change your left fist into a palm. Push forward with both hands, the left stroke is performed with the edge of the palm. Deliver a punch with the right fist. Look ahead. (Fig.27)

28. Shift the weight backwards to the right foot go into a *Left Empty Step (Cat) Stance*. Move both arms in a circular motion rising them up, out, down and forwards. The right fist is drawn to the left shoulder. The left arm is extended forward. The left palm is facing diagonally forward with fingertips upward. Look ahead. (Fig.28)

29. Following the preceding position, turn the body 90 degrees clockwise to the right. Draw the left foot to the right and go back into a *Standing Stance*. Perform a greeting movement - the left palm is moved to the right fist in front of the chest. Look ahead. (Fig.29)



27



29



28

Applications of the South Shaolin form

The illustrated combat applications are exemplary analysis of the form movements. With progress of the training, every practitioner will find his own interpretation. The monk is presented symbolically, with **A** and his opponent with **B**.

Application 1

(corresponds to movement 3 from the form)



Fig. 1.1

1.2 **A** - takes a small step with the right foot towards **B** and goes into a *Right Bow Stance*. Simultaneously, he delivers a double punch with both fists in the chest of the opponent. The backs of the fists are facing up (horizontal fists).



Fig. 1.2

Application 2

(corresponds to movements 4 and 5 of the form)

2.1 B- delivers a straight punch with his left fist.

A- blocks **B's** punch outwardly with the edge of the left palm and catches his wrist. Simultaneously, **A** delivers a direct stroke with his right palm in the ear of his opponent. **A** is in a *Left Bow Stance*.



Fig. 2.1

Application 3

(corresponds to movement 6 from the form)

3.1B- delivers a straight stroke with the left fist.

A- parries **B's** punch inwardly with the left palm. At the same time he strikes with the right half rounded palm stroke into **B's** face.



Fig. 3.1

Application 4

(corresponds to movement 7 from the form)



Fig. 4.1

Application 5

(corresponds to movement 11 from the form)

5.1 B- catches A's waist from behind.

A- rises his right elbow. He is in a *Horse Stance*.



Fig. 5.1

5.2 A - twists his waist to the right. Simultaneously, he kicks **B's** stomach with the right knee and hits his neck with the right elbow. **A** is in a *Right Crane Stance*.



Application 6

Fig. 5.2

(corresponds to movement 19 from the form)



6.1 B- delivers a straight punch with the right fist. **A**- parries with the edge of the left palm and catches **B's** wrist. At the same time he kicks his opponent's stomach and touches his throat with the fingers of the right hand.

Fig. 6.1

Application 7

(corresponds to movements 16 and 17 from the form)



Fig. 7.1

7.1-B delivers a straight punch with the right fist. **A-** from a *Left Cat Stance* blocks and grabs outwardly **B's** wrist. At the same time **A** moves forward his left leg behind the right and strikes with a left hammer fist to **B's** neck.

7.2A- turns his body 180 degrees clockwise (to the right) and goes into a *Horse Stance*. Simultaneously, he strikes **B's** kidney with a right hammer fist.



Fig. 7.2

Application 8

(corresponds to movements 20 and 21 from the form)

8.1 B -grabs A's head, neck or hair with his right hand. **B** is in a *Right Bow Stance*.



Fig. 8.1



Fig. 8.2

8.2 A-following the opponent's attack, shifts the weight forward to the right foot and goes into a *Right Bow Stance*. At the same time he delivers a double fist stroke. He strikes B's stomach with the right fist and B's chest with the left one. The two fists are facing each other.

Application 9

(corresponds to movements 23 and 24 from the form)

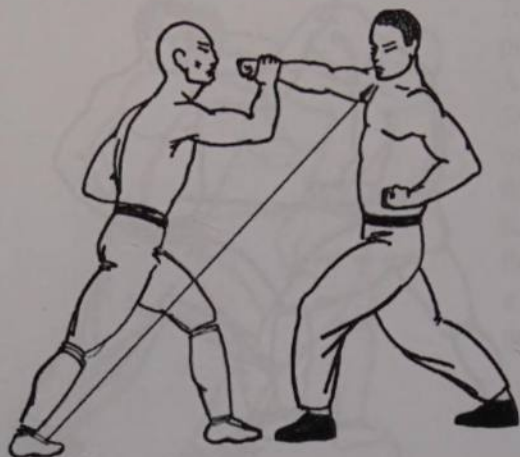


Fig. 9.1

9.2. A- kicks forward with the right leg and pulls the kicking leg backwards and performs a forward side-kick with the same (right) leg pivoting on the ankle of the left foot.



Fig. 9.2

Important: *The given combinations are universal. The applications can be performed either inwardly or outwardly, to the right or to the left, against straight or rounded punches etc.*

CHAPTER 5

IMITATIVE STYLES

PRAYING MANTIS FORM

Important: *The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:*

Broken line(-----) - represents the left side.

Solid(_____) - represents the right side.

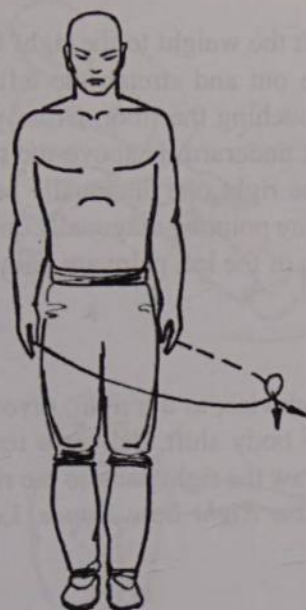
Important: *The movements listed under a single number are performed simultaneously!*

1. Starting position - Stand straight with heels together and palms hanging naturally with fingers pointing down (*Standing Stance*). Look ahead. (Fig.1)

2. Turn the body to the left. Squat slightly down with knees brought together. Cross your hands putting the right under the left one. The right palm is facing upwards and left is facing downwards. (Fig.2)

3. Lift your right knee diagonally to the right. Change your palms into "Praying Mantis" fists* (hooked hands). Move your arms in opposite directions. Bring your left arm forward to the left and the right backward to the right. The left index finger is facing backward and the right index finger is facing forward. The right leg is slightly bent. (Fig.3)

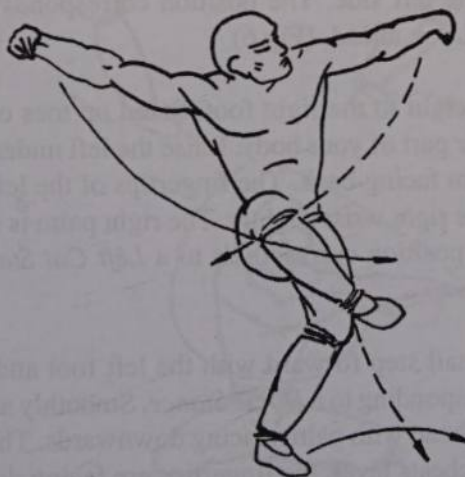
**Bunch fingertips and turn them downward from the wrist to form a "hooked hand". Bring the index finger forward and clench the other fingers.*



1



2



3

4. Put right foot on the floor. Shift the weight to the right foot. Squat down with the right leg. Move out and stretch the left leg diagonally forward. The left heel is touching the floor. Cross your underarms over the left knee. The left underarm is above the right one. The left palm is facing up and the right one diagonally backwards. The fingertips of the right palm are pointing diagonally downwards to the left side and the fingertips of the left palm are pointing to the back.

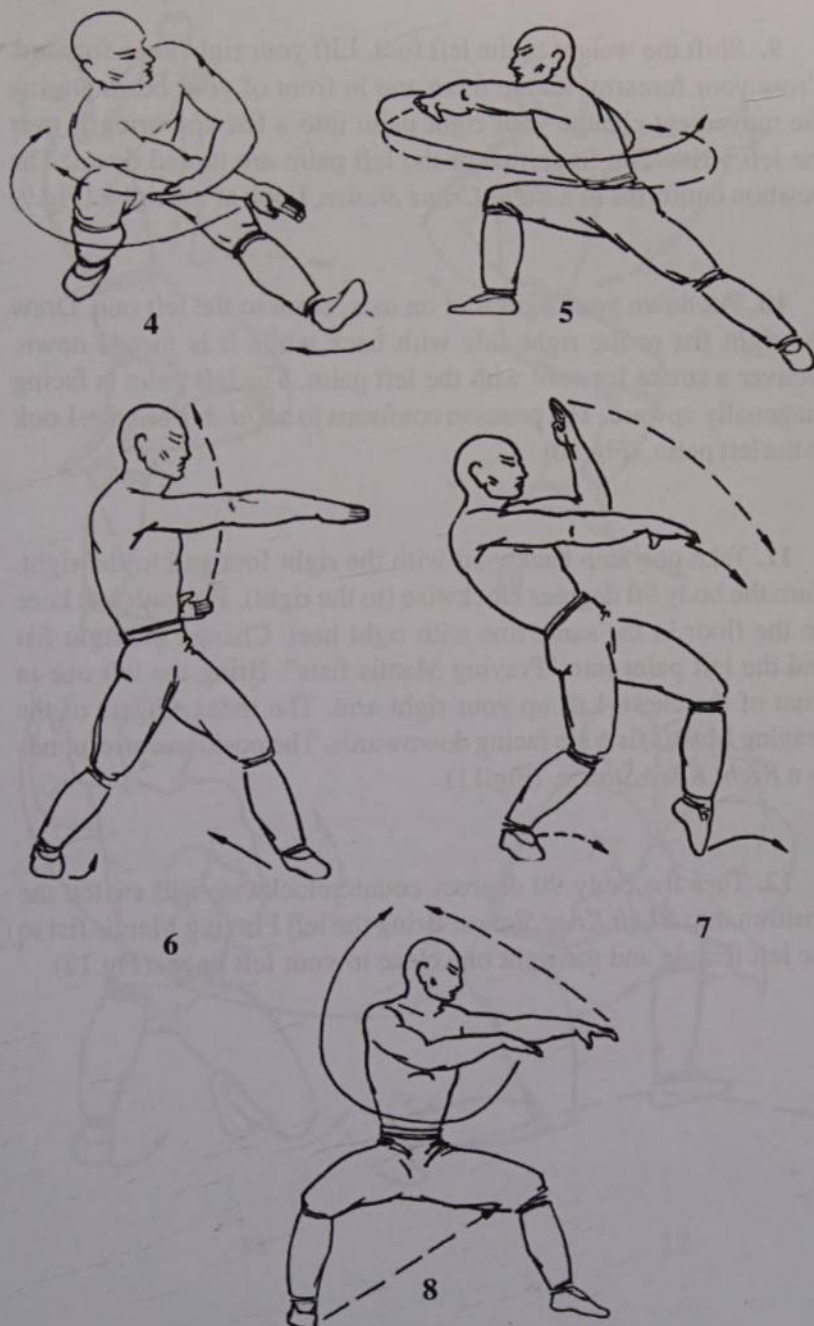
(Fig.4)

5. Turn the body 180 degrees clockwise, to the right, pivoting on the toes of the feet. Following the body shift, deliver a round stroke with the side of the left palm. Draw the right palm to the right side. The position corresponds to a *Low Right Bow Stance*. Look ahead. (Fig.5)

6. Turn the body 180 degrees counterclockwise, to the left, pivoting on the toes of the feet. Following the body shift deliver a round stroke with the inner side of the right palm (ridge-hand stroke). Draw the left palm to the left side. The position corresponds to a *High Left Bow Stance*. Look ahead. (Fig.6)

7. Shift the weight to the right foot. Stand on toes of left foot. Pull back the upper part of your body. Raise the left underarm vertically with the palm facing back. The fingertips of the left palm are facing up. Bend the right wrist slightly. The right palm is diagonally facing down. The position corresponds to a *Left Cat Stance*. Look ahead. (Fig.7)

8. Take one small step forward with the left foot and go into a wide position corresponding to a *Horse Stance*. Smoothly and quickly stretch your arms ahead with palms facing downwards. The arms are relaxed and at the chests level, the fingertips are facing down. Look at the fingertips. (Fig.8)



9. Shift the weight to the left foot. Lift your right knee forward. Cross your forearms above them and in front of your head. During the movement change your right palm into a fist and bring it over the left wrist. The fingertips of the left palm are turned down. The position conforms to a *Right Crane Stance*. Look at the right. (Fig.9)

10. Put down your right foot on toes, close to the left one. Draw the right fist to the right side with back while it is turned down. Deliver a stroke forward with the left palm. The left palm is facing diagonally upward. The position conforms to a *Chicken Stance*. Look at the left palm. (Fig.10)

11. Take one step backward with the right foot and to the right. Turn the body 90 degrees clockwise (to the right). Put your left knee on the floor in the same line with right heel. Change the right fist and the left palm into "Praying Mantis fists". Bring the left one in front of the chest. Lift up your right arm. The index fingers of the Praying Mantis fists are facing downwards. The position corresponds to a *Right Knee Stance*. (Fig.11)

12. Turn the body 90 degrees counterclockwise and switch the position into a *Left Knee Stance*. Bring the left Praying Mantis fist to the left temple and the right one close to your left knee. (Fig.12)



13. Get up and step forward with the right foot. Change your fists into palms. Move your right palm in a circle inwards, downwards and outwards and bring it forward with fingertips facing up diagonally. Move the right palm inwards and downwards and bring it back to the right side. (Fig.13)

14. Take one step forward with the right foot and go into a *Low Stretched Frontal Stance*. The weight is 80% on the right foot and 20% on the toes of the left one. Change your right palm into a fist and strike far forward with it. Place the left palm on the inner part of the right elbow to support the stroke. (Fig.14)

15. Get up. Shift the weight to the left foot and go into a position corresponding with a *Right Cat Stance*. Turn the body 45 degrees to the right. Change your left palm into a fist and the right fist into a palm. Spread out your arms moving the left fist back and the right palm forward. The right palm is turned inwards. (Fig.15)

16. Lift up your right knee. Bring your right palm in front of the chest diagonally facing downwards. Change your left fist into a palm. Strike forward with the left fingertips. The left palm is facing inwards. The position conforms to a *Right Crane Stance*. (Fig.16)



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17. Following the preceding position, take down and forward the left foot. The position corresponds to a *Right Low Stretched Stance*. Change your right palm into a fist and strike far forward with it. Place the left palm on the inner part of the right elbow to support the stroke. (Fig.17).

18. Get up. Take a small step to the right. Turn your body 45 degrees to the right (clockwise), pivoting on the toes of the left foot. Strike forward with the left fingertips. The left palm is facing down. Change your right fist into a palm and draw it in front of the chest, facing up. (Fig.18)

19. Step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Knee Stance*. Change your palms into fists. Strike forward with both fists. The back of the left fist is facing leftward (vertical fist) and the back of the right one is facing downwards. (Fig.19)

20. Get up. Shift the weight to the right foot. Step on the heel of the left leg. Open the fists. Draw the left palm to the left shoulder facing outwards. Bring the right arm backwards to the right side of the body. (Fig. 20)



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21. Move your right foot forward and step on the toes. Turn the right knee slightly inwards. The position corresponds to a *Right Cat Stance*. Change your palms into Praying Mantis fists and bring the left one in front of the chest. Strike with the right fist upwards to the right. (Fig.21)

22a. Perform a back round kick with the right heel. (Fig. 22a)

22b. View from the reverse side. (Fig. 22b)

23. Take your right foot down, turn the body 45 degrees clockwise and go into a *Right High Crossed Legs Stance*. Change your Praying Mantis fists into palms. Stretch your left arm forward and downwards and draw backward the right arm. (Fig.23)



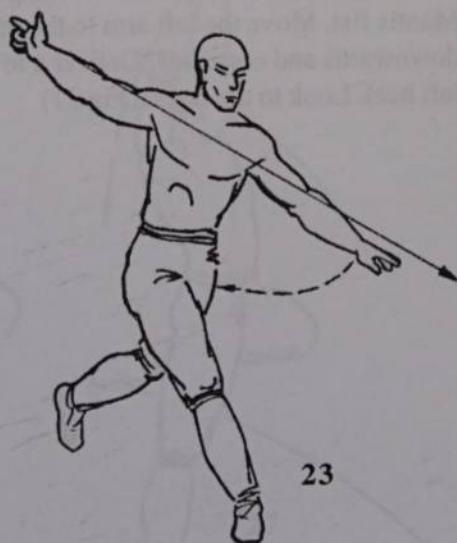
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22a



22b



23

24. Take a large step forward with the left foot, squat slightly and go into a wide *Left Knee Stance*. Take down your left arm with palm facing backwards to the body. Strike forward with the right palm. Look at the right fingertips. (Fig.24)

25. Get up. Take a small step forward with the left foot and follow up with a step with the right one. Draw the palms to the sides. The palms are facing forward and the thumbs diagonally upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.25)

26. Jump forward. Lift up and stretch your right arm. Change your right palm into a Praying Mantis fist. The right index finger is facing outward and downwards. Place your left palm on the right elbow. Look ahead. (Fig.26)

27. Stand on the right foot. Change the left palm into a Praying Mantis fist. Move the left arm to the left. The index finger is facing downwards and outwards. Deliver a low back rounded kick with the left heel. Look to the right. (Fig.27)



24



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26



27

28. Take down and forward the left foot and go into a *Left Bow Stance*. Change your Praying Mantis fists into palms. With the right palm parry the blow from the left. Draw left palm backwards. The left arm is stretched. Twist the body slightly to the left. Look ahead. (Fig.28)

29. Following the preceding position, take a large step forward with the right leg. Change the left Praying Mantis fist into a regular fist and the right one into a palm. Turn the body 360 degrees clockwise (to the right) pivoting on the toes. Using the body turn, perform a punch with the left fist. Place the right palm on the inner part of the left forearm. The position conforms to a *Low Right Bow Stance*. Look to the right. (Fig.29)

30. Turn the body 180 degrees counterclockwise (to the left) and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Change the left fist into a palm. Place both palms facing downwards on the sides. Look to the left front. (Fig.30).



31. Change your palms into Praying Mantis fists. Lift up both arms. The index fingers are facing downward and outwards. Perform a back round kick with the left heel. Look ahead. (Fig.31)

32. Following the preceding position, kick forward with the left knee. Put your left shoulder behind or above the left knee. Draw the arms down and backwards. The index fingers are facing upwards. Look down to your left side. (Fig.32)

33. Following the preceding position take down and forward your left foot. The position conforms to a *Low Horse Stance*. Bring forward your Praying Mantis fists with wrists facing upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.33)

34. Take a large step forward with the right foot. The position corresponds to a *Right Low Stretched Stance*. Change your right Praying Mantis fist into a regular fist and the left one into a palm. Deliver a half hooked punch forward with the right fist. Put the left palm on the right forearm to support the right punch. Look to the right. (Fig.34)



32



31



34



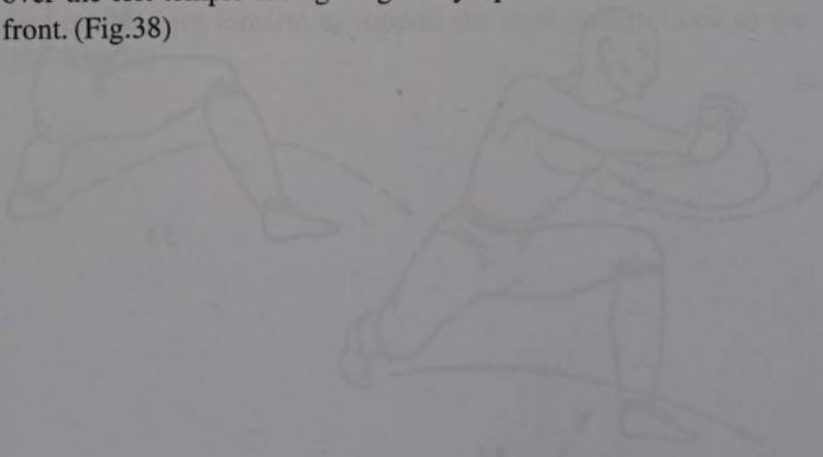
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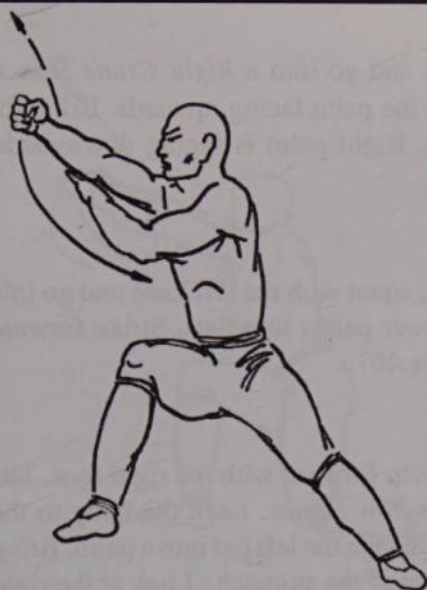
35. Step forward with the left foot. Stretch your left arm to the left side with the palm facing forward. Draw the right fist to the right side. Look ahead. (Fig.35)

36. Take a large step forward with the right leg and go into a position corresponding to a *Right Bow Stance*. Strike forward with a right vertical fist. Place the left palm under the right elbow. The left palm is facing downwards. Look to the right fist. (Fig.36)

37. Shift the weight to the right foot. Deliver a left knife stroke with a palm facing upwards. Change your right fist into a palm. Draw the right palm to the right side of the upper body. The right palm is facing upwards. Look at the left fingertips. (Fig.37)

38. Take one step forward with left foot, squat down on the right leg and go into a *Left Knee Stance*. Deliver a right knife stroke in front of your chest with the palm facing upward. Draw the left palm over the left temple facing diagonally upwards. Look to the right front. (Fig.38)





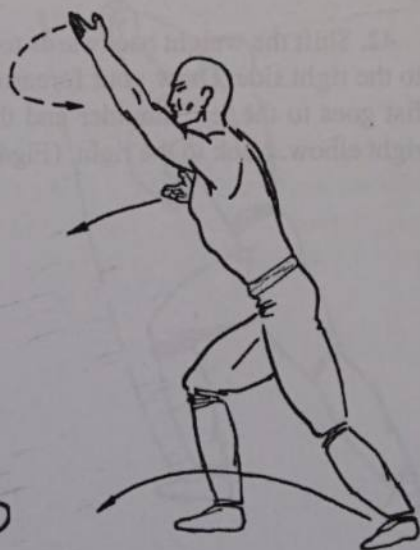
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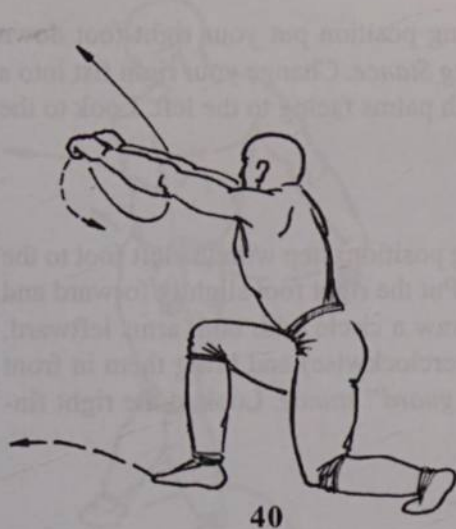
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39. Lift up your right knee and go into a *Right Crane Stance*. Deliver a left knife stroke with the palm facing upwards. Bring the right palm to the right temple. Right palm is facing downwards. Look ahead. (Fig.39)

40. Put down your right foot, squat with the left knee and go into a *Right Knee Stance*. Change your palms into fists. Strike forward with both fists. Look ahead. (Fig.40)

41. Get up and take a small step forward with the right foot. The position corresponds to a *Right Bow Stance*. Lean the body to the right. Deliver a right uppercut. Change the left fist into a palm. Bring the left palm facing down in front of the stomach. Look at the right fist. (Fig. 41)

42. Shift the weight backwards to the left foot. Perform a sidekick to the right side. Draw your forearms in front of the chest- the right fist goes to the left shoulder and the left palm is placed under the right elbow. Look to the right. (Fig42)



43. Following the preceding position put your right foot down and go into a *High Crossed Leg Stance*. Change your right fist into a palm. Put down both arms with palms facing to the left. Look to the right. (Fig.43)

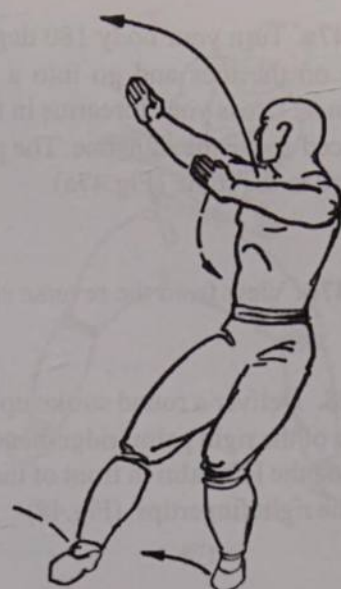
44. Following the preceding position, step with the left foot to the left and shift the weight to it. Put the right foot slightly forward and go into a *Right Cat Stance*. Draw a circle with both arms leftward, upwards and forwards (counterclockwise) and bring them in front of the chest forming a "*Right guard*" stance. Look at the right fingertips. (Fig.44)

45. Take one step forward with the right foot. The position corresponds to a *Right Bow Stance*. Twist and lean the body to the right. Deliver a straight stroke with the right hand fingertips stretched. Bring the left palm in front of the stomach, faced down. Look at the right fingertips. (Fig. 45)

46. Shift the weight to the right foot. Put the left foot forward on the heel and lean the body to the left. Change the right palm into a fist. Deliver a right hook punch. Place the left palm on the right forearm. Look at right fist. (Fig.46)



43



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46



45

47a. Turn your body 180 degrees to the right (clockwise), pivoting on the toes and go into a position corresponding to a *Horse Stance*. Cross your forearms in front of the chest. The left forearm is placed above the right one. The palms are facing diagonally upwards. Look to the right. (Fig.47a)

47b. View from the reverse side. (Fig.47b)

48. Deliver a round stroke upwards and to the right with the inner side of the right palm (ridge-hand strike). The right palm is facing up. Bring the left palm in front of the stomach, facing downwards. Look at the right fingertips. (Fig.48)

49a. Change your right palm into a Praying Mantis fist. From the preceding position, strike with the right fist backward and downwards with the index finger pointing downwards. To support the stroke with the right fist, twist the body slightly to the right. Look at the right index finger. (Fig.49)



47a



47b



48

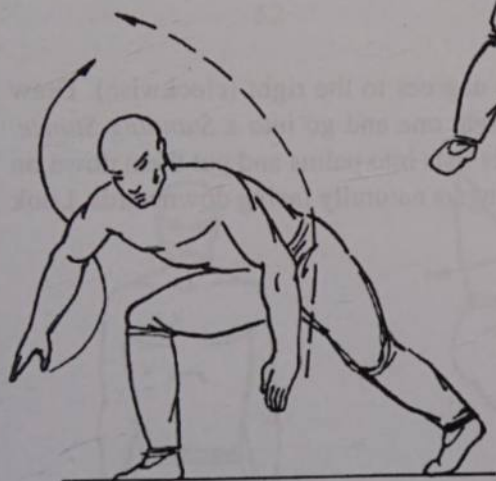


49a

49b. View from the reverse side. (Fig.49b)

50. Take a large forward step with the right foot. Turn the body 180 degrees to the left (counterclockwise). Lean the body downwards and change your right Praying Mantis fist into a palm. Take down both arms. The palms are facing each other with fingertips pointing downwards. Look 45 degrees downwards in front of yourself. (Fig.50)

51. Following the preceding position, lift up your body and turn it 90 degrees to the left (counterclockwise). Perform a back round kick with the left heel. Change your palms into Praying Mantis fists. Rise up both arms. The pointer fingers are facing down and outwards. Look ahead. (Fig.51)



52. Put down and forward your left foot. Lean the body forward over the left knee. Take down both arms. The pointer fingers are pointing downwards. Look 45 degrees down in front of you. (Fig.52)

53. Following the preceding position, shift the body weight backwards to the right foot and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Make two circles with both fists and bring them in front of your chest, the left Praying Mantis fist is in front of the right one. Look at the left pointer finger. (Fig.53)

54. Turn your body 90 degrees to the right (clockwise). Draw your left foot back to the right one and go into a *Standing Stance*. Change your Praying Mantis fists into palms and put them down on the side of the thighs with fingers naturally facing downwards. Look ahead. (Fig.54)



52



53



54

Applications of the Praying Mantis form

The presented combat applications are exemplary analysis of the form movements. With the progress in the training every practitioner can find his own interpretation. The monk is presented symbolically with **A**, and his opponent with **B**.

Application 1

(corresponds to movement 3 from the form)

1.1 B- delivers a straight punch with the right fist.

A- from a left guard position blocks (outwardly) with the side of the right palm and at the same time catches **B's** right wrist. Simultaneously with the blocking, **A** strikes with a left "Praying Mantis" fist to his opponent's throat and kicks his thigh or back.



Fig. 1.1

Application 2

(corresponds to movement 4 from the form)

2.1 B- delivers a straight punch with the right fist.

A- from a left guard position he blocks outwardly his opponent's stroke with the left palm. At the same time he squats down with the right leg and stretches the left one behind **B's** legs and strikes his opponent's groin with the right palm.



Fig. 2.1

Application 3

(corresponds to movements 5 from the form)



Fig. 3.1

3.1 B- delivers a straight punch with the right fist.

A- From a left guard position he blocks outwardly his opponent and catches **B's** right wrist with his right hand. **A** steps forward and pulls back **B's** arm. Going into *Right Bow Stance* he delivers a stroke with the left palm in **B's** back (spinal-cord).

Application 4

(corresponds to movements 9 and 10 from the form)



Fig. 4.1

4.2 A- pulls back his opponent's head with the left palm. Simultaneously, he delivers a punch with the base of the right fist in **B's** face and kicks with the right knee his ribs.



Fig. 4.2

4.3 A- takes down and backwards his right leg and strikes **B's** chin with his left palm.



Fig. 4.3

Application 5

(corresponds to movement 11 from the form)



5.1 B- delivers a straight punch with the right fist

A- from a left guard he blocks outwardly his opponent with a "double block" (the



Fig. 5.2

5.2 A- takes a large step with the right foot backwards at 180 degrees arch, pivoting on the toes of the left foot. Following this movement he pulls B's arm and takes him down.

Application 6

(corresponds to movements 21 and 22 from the form)

6.1 B- delivers a straight stroke with the left fist. B is in a *Left Bow Stance*.

A- from a left guard he blocks and catches outwardly with the left "Praying Mantis" fist B's arm and with the right one strikes his opponent's neck (or eye). Simultaneously, he kicks B's groin with the right heel.



Fig. 6.1

Important: The performance of this movement is accompanied with an inward twisting of the waist .

Application 7

(corresponds to movement 27 from the form)

7.1 A- is attacked by two opponents. He strikes their eyes with his "Praying Mantis" fists. Simultaneously, **A** kicks with a left back round kick the attacker behind him.

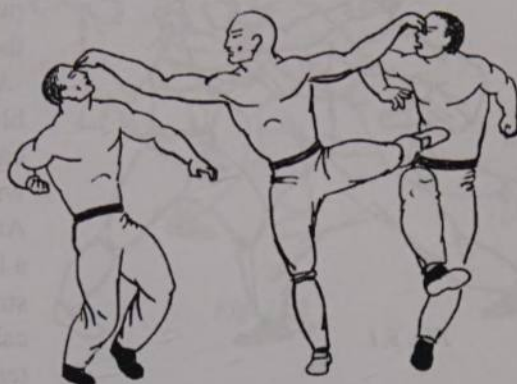


Fig. 7.1

Application 8

(corresponds to movement 34 from the form-Chin Na variant)

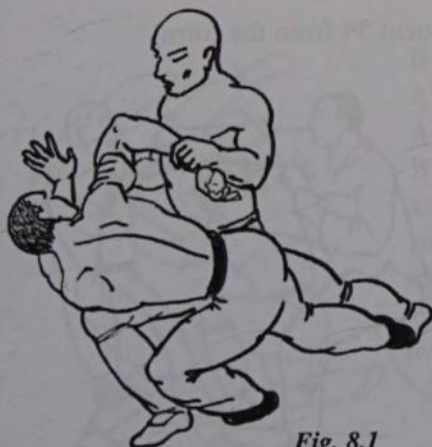


Fig. 8.1

B- delivers a right hooked punch in a *Right Bow Stance*. **A-** from a left guard he blocks **B's** punch and catches inwardly his wrist. Simultaneously, **A** steps far forward, pushes spirally his right forearm under his opponent's elbow and presses **B's** arm.

Application 9

(corresponds to movements 35 and 36 from the form)



Fig. 9.1

9.1 B-delivers a straight punch with the left fist in the *Left Bow Stance*.

A- from a left guard he blocks his opponent and catches outwardly **B's** wrist with the left palm. At the same time he takes a large step forward and strikes with a right vertical punch his opponent's temple or eye.

Remark: For better effectiveness the knuckle of the right vertical fist can be brought forward (*The eye of the Phoenix*).

Application 10

(corresponds to movement 34 from the form)

10.1 B-delivers a left straight or hook (side) punch in a *Right Bow Stance*.

A- from a right guard he blocks inwardly his opponents stroke with the side of the right palm.

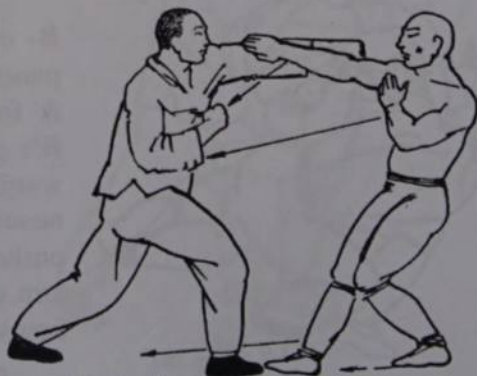


Fig. 10.1

10.2 A- makes a fast sliding step with the right foot towards the opponent and goes into a *Right Low Frontal Stance*. Simultaneously, he delivers a double stroke into B's body. The right Phoenix fist strikes under the chest-bone and the side of the left palm falls onto the stomach.



Fig. 10.2

Application 11

(corresponds to movement 38 from the form)



Fig. 9.1

B- kicks with a right round kick to A's head.

A- from right guard takes a step in B with the left foot, squats down and goes into *Left Knee Stance*. Simultaneously he blocks opponents kick with the left palm (the block is over B's knee) and delivers stroke with the right palm in B's groins.

CHAPTER 6

WUDANG DIRECTION

Hsing I Chuan - Linking form

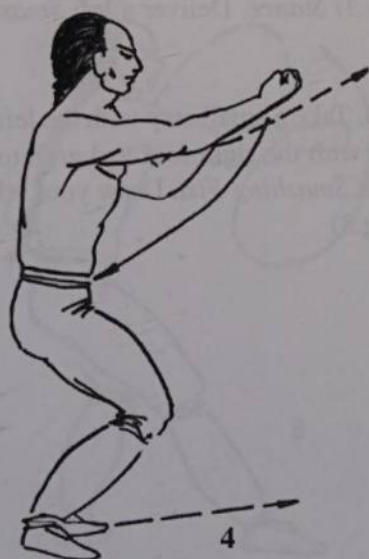
Important: *The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:*

Broken line(-----) - represents left side.

Solid line(_____) - represents right side.

Important: *The movements listed under a single number are performed simultaneously!*

1. Starting position - Stand straight with body turned diagonally forward. The heels are together and the palms are hanging naturally with fingers facing down (*Standing Stance*). Look to the left. (Fig.1)
2. Turn the toes of the right foot to the right. Squat slightly and bring the palms in front of the chest facing downward. Look to the right. (Fig.2)
3. Following the preceding position. Take the palms down with the fingers pointing downwards. (Fig.3)
4. Turn your body 45 degrees to the left. Turn the toes of the left foot 45 degrees to the left. Change your palms into fists. Lift up your fists. Stretch the right arm with the back of the fist facing downward and bring the left fist next to the right elbow with the back facing upward. Look ahead. (Fig.4)

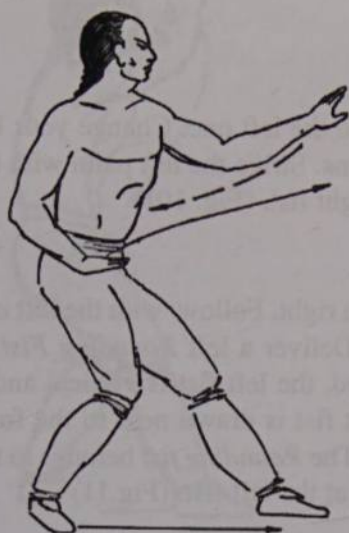


5. Move your left foot forward, follow a with small step of the right foot and go into a *San Ti Stance* - the *Position of the Three Essences* (the weight is 30 % on the front foot and 70% on the rear one). Change your fists into palms. Deliver a *Splitting Fist* stroke or *Pi Chuan* (belongs to the Metal from the Five Elements) with the left palm (the arm is stretched diagonally forward, the palm is stretched ahead). Draw the right palm facing down and to the right side. Look at the fingertips of the left hand. (Fig.5)

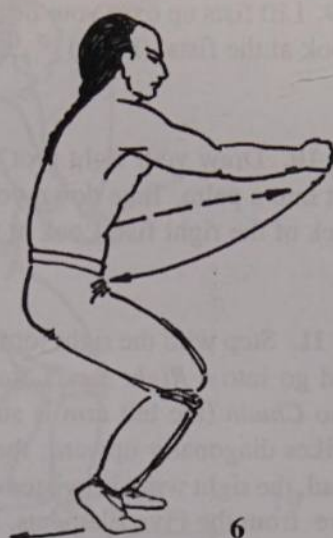
6. Bring your right foot on toes close to the left one. The knees are stuck together (*Chicken Stance*). Change your palms into fists. Deliver a *Smashing Fist* or *Peng Chuan* (belongs to the Wood from the Five Elements) with the right fist (the arm is stretched forward, the fist is vertical, the force is directed forward). Draw the left fist at the left side. Look ahead. (Fig 6)

7. Take one step backward with the right foot and go into a *Left San Ti Stance*. Deliver a left *Smashing fist*. Look ahead. (Fig.7)

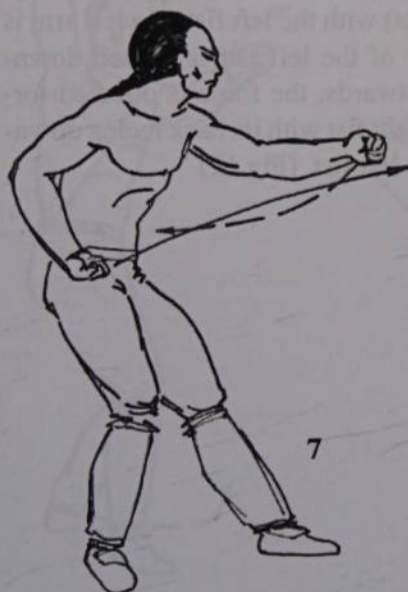
8. Take a small step with the left foot forward followed by a large one with the right foot and go into a *Right San Ti Stance*. Deliver a right *Smashing Fist*. Draw your left fist to the left side. Look ahead. (Fig.8)



5



6



7



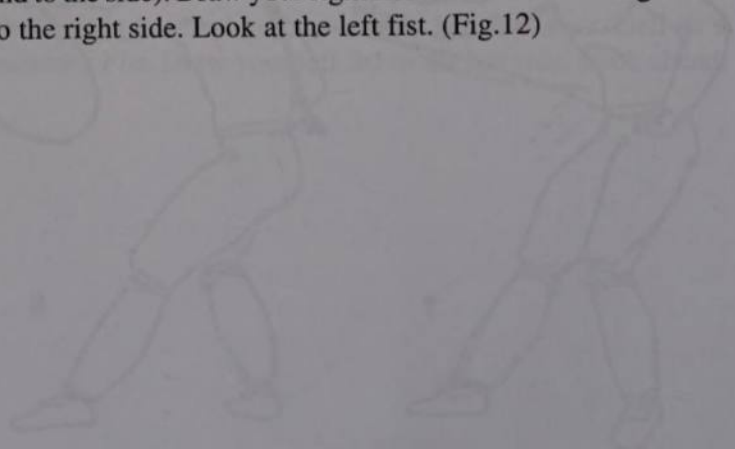
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9. Lift fists up over your head. The knuckles are facing each other. Look at the fists. (Fig.9)

10. Draw your right foot next to the left one. Change your left fist into a palm. Take down your arms. Strike the left palm with the back of the right fist. Look at the right fist. (Fig. 10)

11. Step with the right foot to the right. Follow with the left one and go into a *Right SanTi Stance*. Deliver a left *Pounding Fist* or *Pao Chuan* (the left arm is stretched, the left fist is vertical and it strikes diagonally upward; the right fist is drawn near to the forehead, the right wrist is twisted out). The *Pounding fist* belongs to the Fire from the Five Elements. Look at the left fist. (Fig.11)

12. Bring your left foot forward on the heel with toes facing outwardly (to the left). Deliver a *Crossing Fist* or *Heng Chuan* (belongs to the Earth from the Five Elements) with the left fist (the left arm is stretched diagonally up, the back of the left fist is shifted downwards, the left wrist is twisted outwards, the force is directed forward and to the side). Draw your right fist with its back facing downward to the right side. Look at the left fist. (Fig.12)





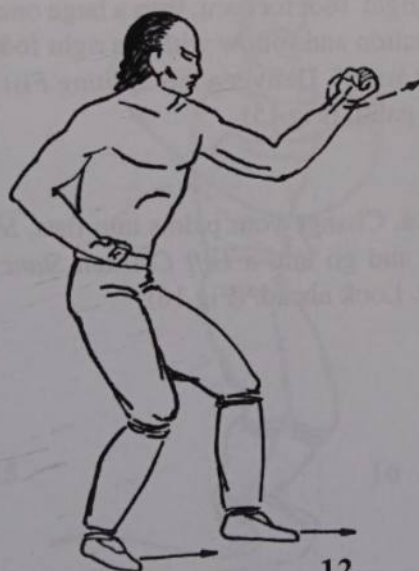
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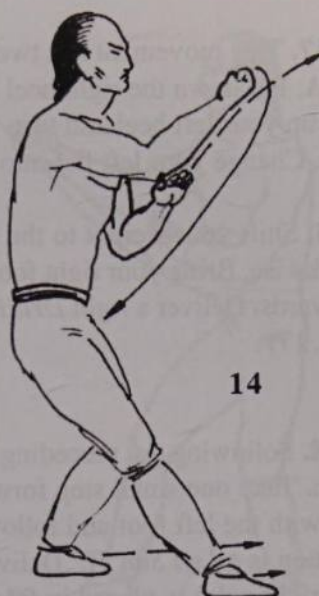
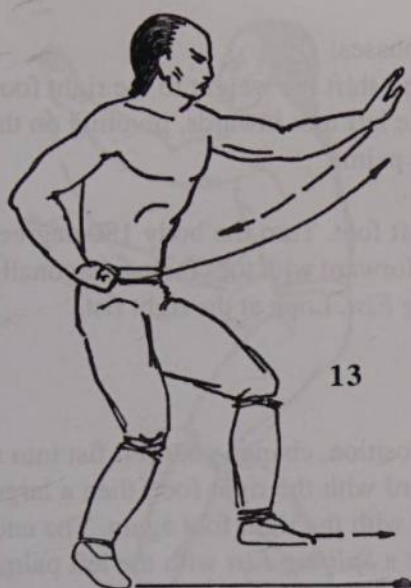
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13. Following the preceding position, change your left fist into a palm. Take one small step forward with the right foot and go into a *Left San Ti Stance*. Deliver a *Splitting Fist* with the left palm. The right fist remains on the right side. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.13)

14. Take one small step with the left foot, then a large one with the right foot and follow with the left foot again. The end position is a *Right San Ti*. Deliver a right *Drilling Fist* or *Tsuan Chuan* (the left arm is stretched diagonally upwards, the back of the fist is facing downward, the right wrist is twisted out, the force is directed diagonally upward; the left palm, facing down is moved under the right elbow. The *Drilling Fist* belongs to the Water from the Five Elements. Look at the right fist. (Fig.14)

15. Change your right fist into a palm. Take one small step with the right foot forward, then a large one with the left foot in the same direction and follow with the right foot again. The end position is a *Left San Ti*. Deliver a left *Splitting Fist*. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.15)

16. Change your palms into fists. Move the right foot to the left one and go into a *Left Chicken Stance*. Deliver a right *Smashing Fist*. Look ahead. (Fig.16)



17. This movement has two phases:

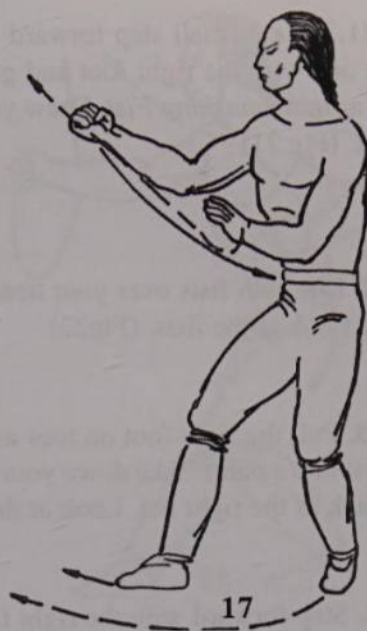
A. Put down the right heel and shift the weight to the right foot. Lift up your left heel and turn the left foot inwards, pivoting on the toes. Change your left fist into a palm.

B. Shift your weight to the left foot. Turn the body 180 degrees clockwise. Bring your right foot forward with toes facing diagonally outwards. Deliver a right *Drilling Fist*. Look at the right fist.
(Fig. 17)

18. Following the preceding position, change your left fist into a palm. Take one small step forward with the right foot, then a large one with the left foot and follow with the right foot again. The end position is a *Left San Ti*. Deliver a *Splitting Fist* with the left palm. The right palm is placed in front of the stomach, facing downward (fingertips are stretched). Look at the fingertips of the left palm.
(Fig.18)

19. Bring your right foot next to the left one. The knees are stuck together (*Chicken Stance*). Change your palms into fists. Deliver a *Smashing Fist (Peng Chuan)* with the right fist. Draw your left fist at the left side. Look ahead. (Fig 19)

20. Take one step backward with the right foot and go into a *Left San Ti Stance*. Deliver a left *Smashing Fist*. Look ahead. (Fig.20)

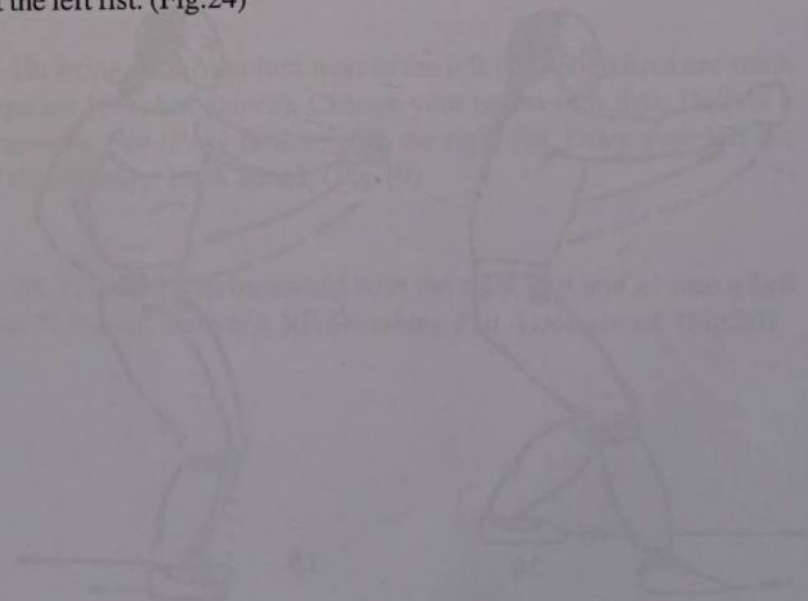


21. Take a small step forward with the left foot followed by a large one with the right foot and go into a *Left San Ti Stance*. Deliver a right *Smashing Fist*. Draw your left fist to the left side. Look ahead. (Fig.21)

22. Lift both fists over your head. The knuckles are facing each other. Look at the fists. (Fig.22)

23. Pull the right foot on toes next to the left one. Change your left fist into a palm. Take down your arms. Strike your left palm with the back of the right fist. Look at the right fist. (Fig. 23)

24. Step forward with the right foot, following with the left one and go into a *Right SanTi Stance*. Deliver a left *Pounding Fist*. Look at the left fist. (Fig.24)



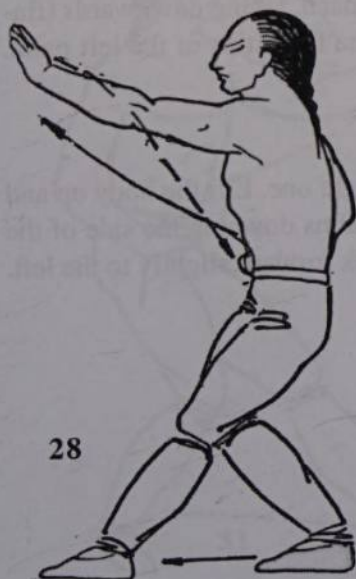


25. Bring your left foot forward with toes facing outwards (to the left). Deliver a *Crossing Fist (Heng Chuan)* stroke with the left fist. Draw your right fist facing up to the right side. Look at the left fist. (Fig.25)

26. Following the preceding position, change your left fist into a palm. Take one small step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left San Ti Stance*. Deliver a *Splitting Fist* with the left palm. The right fist remains on the right side. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.26)

27. Take one small step forward with the left foot, then a large one with the right foot and follow with the left foot again. The end position is a *Right San Ti*. Deliver a right *Drilling Fist (Tsuan Chuan)*. Look at the right fist. (Fig.27)

28. Change your left fist into a palm. Take one small step with the right foot, then a large one with the left foot and follow with the right foot again. The end position is a *Left San Ti*. Deliver a left *Splitting Fist*. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.28)



29. Change your palms into fists. Move the right foot to the left one and go into a *Left Chicken Stance*. Deliver a right *Smashing Fist*. Look ahead. (Fig.29)

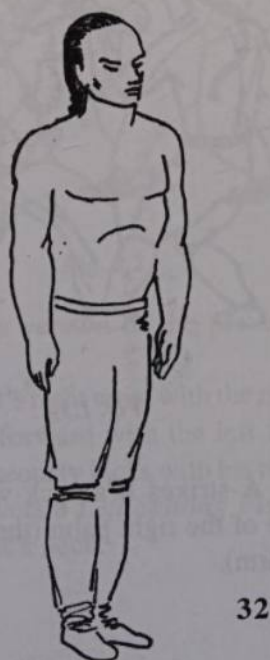
30. This movement has two phases:

A. Put down the right heel and shift the weight to the right foot. Lift up your left heel and turn the left foot inward, pivoting on the toes. Change left fist into a palm.

B. Shift the weight on the left foot. Turn the body 180 degrees to the right (clockwise). Bring your right foot forward with toes facing diagonally outward. Deliver a right *Drilling Fist*. Look at the right fist. (Fig.30)

31. Take one small step forward with the right foot, then a large one with the left foot and follow with the right foot again. The end position is a *Left San Ti*. Deliver a *Spliting Fist* with the left palm. The right palm falls in front of the stomach, facing downwards (fingertips are facing forward). Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.31)

32. Pull your left foot back to the right one. Lift the body up and shift it slightly to the right. Put both palms down on the side of the thighs and take a *Standing Stance*. Look forward slightly to the left. (Fig.32)



Applications of the Hsing I Linking form

The presented combat applications are exemplary analysis of the form movements. With the progress in the training every practitioner can find his own interpretation. The monk is presented symbolically with A, and his opponent with B.

Application 1 Splitting Fist (Metal)



Fig. 1.1

1.2 A-strikes B's neck with the edge of the right palm (the blocking arm).

1.1 B- delivers a right round (hook) punch.

A- blocks his opponent with the left forearm or palm slightly twisted counter clockwise (drilling movement).



Fig. 1.2

Application 2

Splitting Fist (Metal)



Fig. 2.1

2.2 A-catches B's right wrist with his right palm, steps forward with the left foot and delivers a *Left Splitting Fist* to his opponent's neck.



Fig. 2.2

2.3 This is a version of the previous application.

A-catches B's right wrist with the right palm, steps forward with the left foot and simultaneously kicks with his right leg and delivers a *Left Splitting Fist* to the opponent's neck.



Fig. 2.3

Application 3

Smashing Fist (Wood)

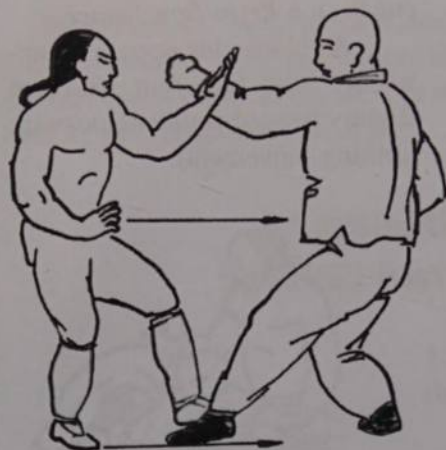
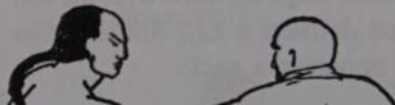


Fig. 3.1

3.1. B- attacks with a left straight punch.

A- blocks his opponent outwardly with the left forearm or with the back of the left palm slightly twisted clockwise. The position is a *Left San Ti*.

3.2 A- catches B's arm



3.3 B- blocks A's punch inwardly with the inner side of the left forearm.



Fig. 3.3



3.4 A- without changing the position (*Right San Ti*) counter attacks the opponent with a *Left Smashing Fist*.

Fig. 3.4

Application 4 Drilling Fist (Water)



Fig. 4.1

4.1. B-delivers a right punch into A's stomach.

A - blocks outwardly his opponent with the back of his left forearm.

4.2. A - steps forward with the right foot and goes into a *Right San Ti*. Simultaneously, he delivers a *Right Drilling Fist* to B's chin.



Fig. 4.2

Application 5

Pounding Fist (Fire)



Fig. 5.1

5.1 B - delivers a right round (hook) punch.

A - from a *Left San Ti* attacks **B** taking a small step forward with the left foot and performs a *Right Pounding Fist*. The left forearm blocks inwardly **B**'s blow, the right fist strikes **B**'s chin.

Application 6

Crossing Fist (Earth)

6.1. B - attacks with a right punch

A - blocks outwardly **B**'s punch and grabs his right wrist with the right palm. Simultaneously, he puts his arm under opponent's right armpit.



Fig. 6.1

6.2. A - steps forward with the left leg behind **B**'s right leg. Simultaneously, he performs a *Left Crossing Fist*.



Fig. 6.2

CHAPTER 7

TWO - PERSON TRAINING DRILL



1

1. A and B are in a *Standing Stance*.

The major objective of these exercises are blocking of every stroke and performing of counter stroke. This develops the sense of contact with the opponent- the feeling for distance, "understanding power" and other valuable skills. The monk is presented symbolically with A and his opponent with B.



2

2. B prepares himself for a diagonal backfist punch.

3. **B** steps with the right foot towards **A** and goes into a *Horse Stance*. At the same time he delivers a diagonal backfist punch with the right hand to **A**'s right temple.



3



4

4. Before **B**'s stroke reaches the target, **A** steps forward with the right foot forward towards **B** and blocks **B**'s punch outwardly with the right forearm. **A** is in a *High Right Bow Stance*.



5. A- delivers a left straight punch in B's ribs.

5

6. B- goes into a *Right Bow Stance* and blocks inwardly A's punch with the edge of the right hand.



6

7. B- Without changing the position, he delivers a blow to **A's** chin with the inner side of the right palm.



7



8

8. A- blocks outwardly **B's** blow with his right forearm (or with the side of his palm), draws slightly his right foot and steps forward, to the side of **B's** right foot in a *Right Bow Stance*.



9. A- steps in large arch behind B. A is in a *Horse Stance*.

9

10. A- delivers a heavy stroke with the back of his right palm (or with the base of his fist) to B's backbone (or kidneys).



10

11. B- pulls back his left foot and steps forward with the right one by the inner part of A's right foot. **B** is in a *Right Bow Stance*. Simultaneously, he blocks the opponent's stroke with the side of his right palm (or with the right forearm).



11



12

12. B- delivers a left straight punch to A's ribs.



13. A- blocks outwardly B's punch with the side of the left palm or with his left forearm. A is in a *Right Empty Step (Cat) Stance*.

13

14. A- kicks forward with his right foot (frontal kick) into B's groin or stomach.



14

15. B- shifts the weight on the left foot avoiding his opponent's kick. He blocks outwardly A's leg with a right grappling block.



15



16. A- to escape his opponent's grip, he bends the knee of the blocked leg and pulls it inwardly.

16



17

17. A- stepping with the right foot behind the left one, he turns his body counter clockwise at 270 degrees (pivoting). He faces B.

18. B- steps towards A taking a large step with his left foot crossed in front of the right one and goes into a *High Crossing Stance*.



18

19. **B**- steps forward with the right foot and delivers a round backfist punch to his opponent's right temple. **B** is in a *Right Bow Stance*.



19



20. **A**-pulls his left foot behind the right one and squats in a *Low Crossing Stance*. Simultaneously, he blocks inwardly **B**'s punch with the side of his left palm.

20

21. A- gets up and kicks forward with his left foot into B's ribs.



21

22. B- blocks inwardly with the right forearm A's kick.



22

23. **B-** steps forward with the left foot. At the same time he delivers a left punch with a vertical fist into the opponent's ribs and a right punch into **A's** chest with horizontal fist. **B** is in a *Horse Stance*.



23



24. **A-** shifts his weight on the left foot, turns his right foot on the toes. Simultaneously, he twists his body to left and blocks outwardly **B's** double punch with his right arm.

24



25. A- strikes with knife stroke to **B's** right temple. The palm of his striking hand is facing up.

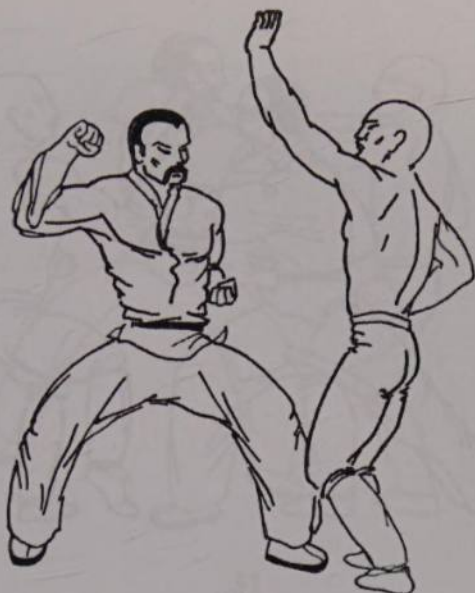
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26. B- parries A's blow bottom up with the right palm (an arch block).

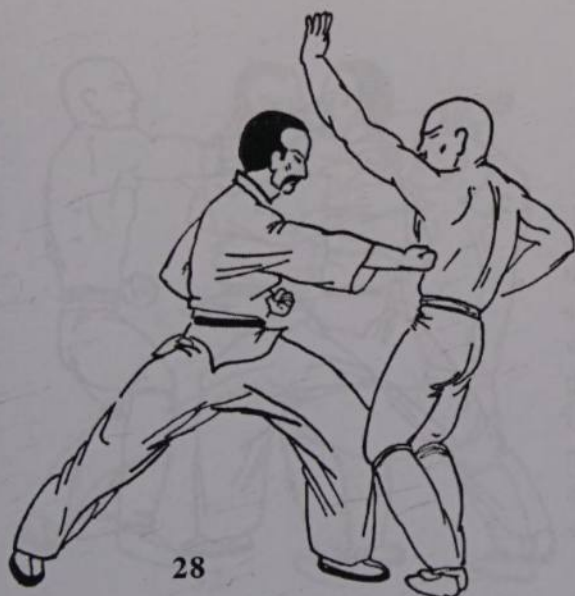


26

27. B- forms a fist with his blocking hand.



27



28

28. B- twists his body from right to left and delivers a side punch with the base of his right fist into A's ribs .



29

29. A- in order to escape he takes a small step backwards with his right foot, pulls slightly back the left one and goes into a *Left Empty (Cat) Stance*. At the same time he blocks the opponent's attack with the inner part of his left forearm.

30. A- counter attacks B's eyes with a left "two fingers spear hand".



30

31. B- blocks inwardly with edge of the right palm and delivers straight horizontal stroke with the knuckles of the left hand into A's throat.



31



32

32. A- blocks and catches inwardly with the right hand B's striking arm. He steps with the left foot into the opponent and goes in *Horse Stance*. Simultaneously A delivers left round elbow stroke to B's chest.



33. B- steps backwards in a large arch with his left foot. Simultaneously, he blocks outwardly A's elbow with a side elbow stroke of his right hand.

33

34. B - delivers a right back fist punch to A's head.



34

35. A- blocks with the right palm, pushing B's hand upwards.



35



36. A- strikes with a left punch into B's ribs.

36



37. B- shifts his weight slightly to the left foot. At the same time he blocks outwardly A's stroke with the right forearm.

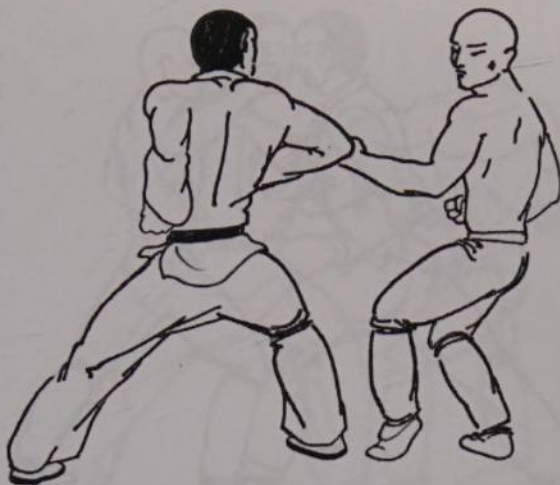
37

38. B- shifts the weight to the right foot and delivers a direct elbow stroke into A's chest.



38

39. A- in order to escape, he shifts the weight backwards on the right foot and goes into a *Left Empty Step (Cat) Stance*. Simultaneously, he pushes **B's** elbow downwards with the side of his left palm.



40. A- goes into a *Left Bow Stance* and strikes with the knuckle of the left index finger (eye of the phoenix) into A's ear.





41. B- while twisting his waist to the right, he blocks inwardly the opponent's stroke with the left palm. B's position is a *Right Bow Stance*.

41

42. B- delivers a round blow with the right palm to A's kidneys.



42

43. A- twists his waist to the left and blocks his opponent with right twisting block from the top downwards.



43

44. A- steps with his left foot towards **B** and delivers a round blow with the left palm into **B's** kidney.



44



45. B- shifts the weight to the left foot and blocks his opponent inwardly with the right forearm with a downward movement (heavy arm block).

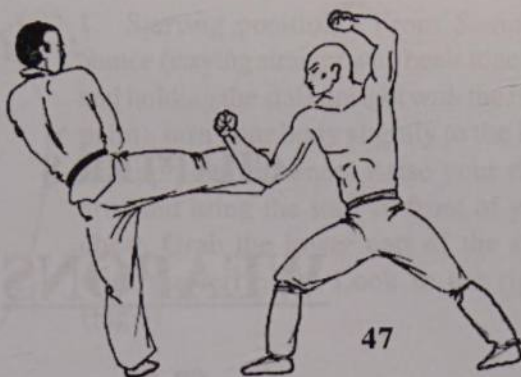
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46. B- kicks A's chest with a right side kick.

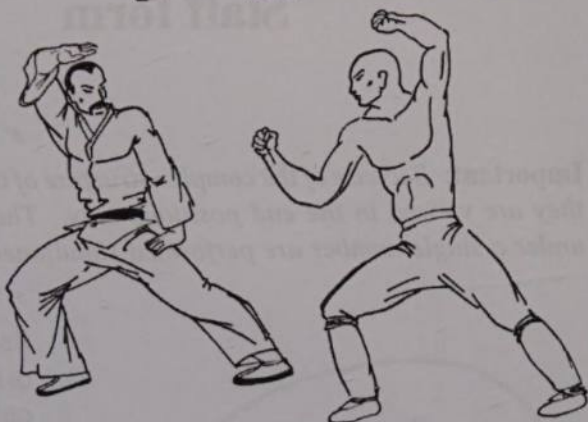


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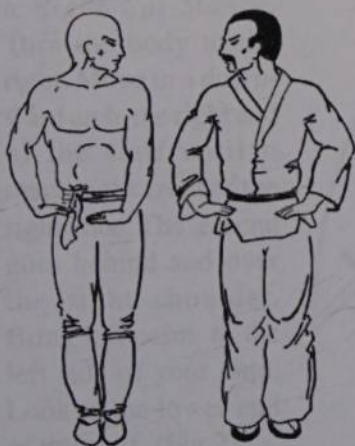
47. A -steps backwards with the left foot and blocks outwardly B's kick. A is in a *Right Bow Stance*.



48. B- pulls back his right leg, turns on the ankle of his left foot on 270 degrees counter-clockwise and forms a *Right Diagonal Stance*.



49. A and B are going back into a *Standing Stance*. They start a second fighting sequence reversing their roles.



CHAPTER 8

WEAPONS

Staff form

Important: *Because of the complex structure of the presented forms, they are viewed in the end positions only. The movements listed under a single number are performed simultaneously!*



1

1. Starting position - From *Standing Stance* (staying straight with heels together and holding the staff upright with the right palm), turn your body slightly to the left. Lift up your left knee. Raise your right arm and bring the staff in front of your chest. Grab the lower part of the staff with the left hand. Look to the right. (Fig.1)

2. Take down your left foot. Shift the weight to the left foot and go into a *Right Cat Stance*. Turn the body to the right. Move in a downward arch the right end of the staff until it reaches the front of the right knee. The left end goes behind and over the right shoulder. Bring left palm to the left side of your chin. Look at the lower end of the staff. (Fig.2)



2

3. Jump up with both feet and fall into a *Right Knee Stance*. Grab the lower end of the staff with the right wrist and turn it in an arch (clock-wise). The upper end follows in an arch downwards, upwards and forward. Catch the staff with the left hand. Look at the tip of the staff. (Fig.3)



3



4

4. Get up and shift the weight to the left foot. Go into a *Right Cat Stance*. Grab the staff with the pointer finger of the right hand stretched. Turn the staff clockwise with the right hand until the end comes in front of the right knee. Place the left palm to the left side of the chin. Look at the lower end of the staff. (Fig.4)



5. Take a small step backwards with the right foot. Lift up your left knee. Turn the lower end of the staff clockwise in a circle. "Hide" the staff moving your right arm behind the back (the staff is behind the right shoulder). Draw the left palm, facing inwards, in front of your face. (Fig.5)

6. Take down your left knee and go into a *Right Monkey Knee Stance* (corresponds to a *Knee Stance*). Turn the staff counterclockwise twisting your right wrist, catch over the staff with the left hand and continue the circle with the left wrist. Hide the staff behind your left shoulder. Bring the right palm in front of your chin with fingers facing downwards. (Fig.6)

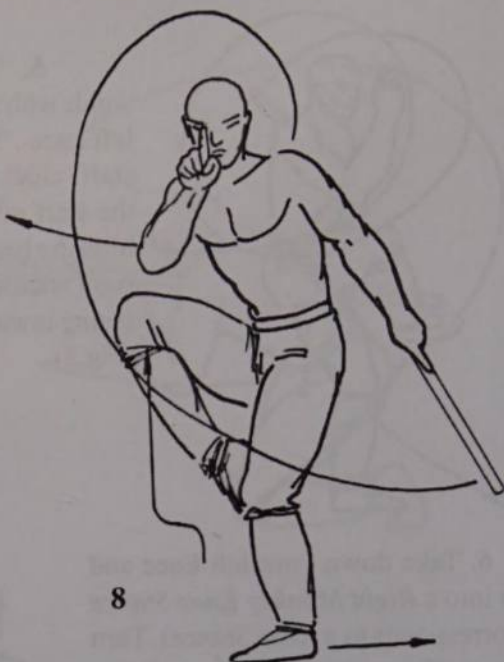


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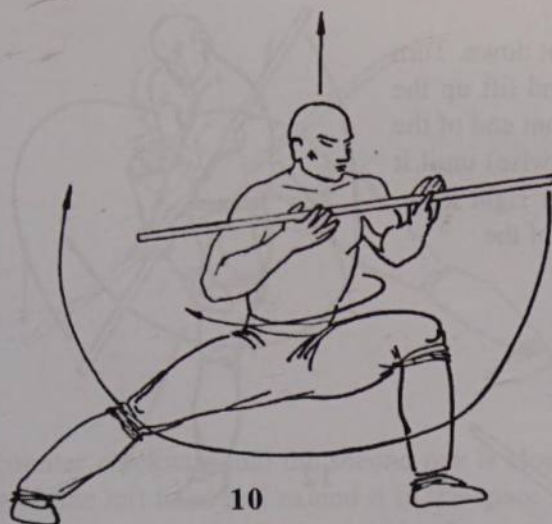


7. Pull backward the right foot. Move the staff vertically to the left thigh (the staff and the foot are in the same line). Draw the right hand to the right with fingers facing outward. (Fig.7)

8. Step forward with the right foot and backward with the left one. Lift up your right knee. Turn the body slightly to the left. Draw the right hand facing inward in front of your face. Hold the staff with left hand. (Fig.8)

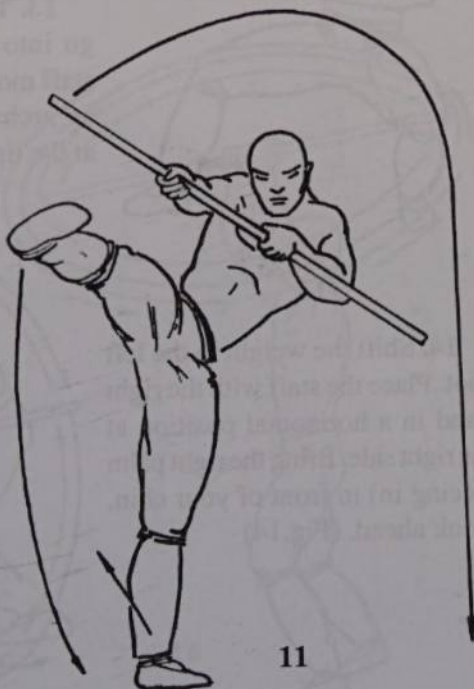


9. Following the preceding position, put down the right foot. When the toes of the right foot touch the floor, lift up the right knee. Turn the body 90 degrees to the left (counterclockwise), pivoting on the toes of the left foot. Move the lower end of the staff in an arch upwards. Catch the staff with the right hand and move the same end backwards, downwards and forward. (Fig.9)



10. Take down the left foot. Turn the body to the right. Step forward with the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Push forward with the left end of the staff . (Fig.10)

11. Turn your body to the right. Make a cross catch over the staff and move the frontal end of the staff in an arch (clock-wise). Perform a right side kick to the right front. Look at the kicking foot. (Fig.11)



12. Put the right foot down. Turn the body to the left and lift up the left knee. Move the front end of the staff in an arch (clockwise) until it comes in front of your right knee. Look at the lower end of the staff. (Fig.12)



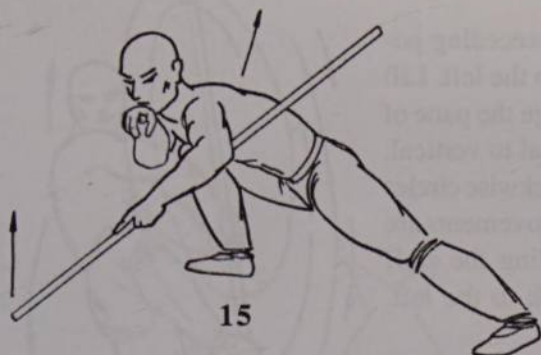
13. Take down the left foot and go into a *Horse Stance*. Turn the staff moving the upper (rear) end in an arch (counterclockwise). Look at the tip of the staff. (Fig.13)

13

14. Shift the weight to the left foot. Place the staff with the right hand in a horizontal position at the right side. Bring the right palm (facing in) in front of your chin. Look ahead. (Fig.14)



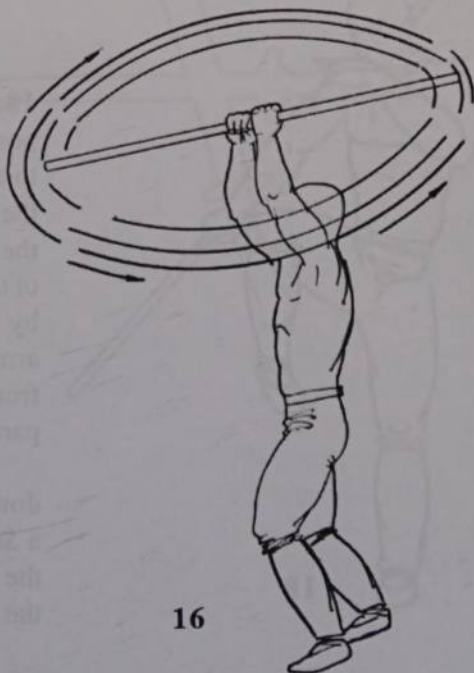
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15. Take a small step forward with the left foot. Shift the weight to the right foot. Turn the body to the right. Make two vertical circles turning the staff vertically with the right hand, the first circle is

counter clockwise and the second one is clockwise. Grab the staff with the left hand and extend it in the space in front of your body. Bend the upper part of your body leaning on the right knee. Bring the right wrist in front of your chin. Look slightly to the left. (Fig.15)

16. Stand up. Grab the staff with both hands. Turning the staff, make three horizontal circles to the left (counterclockwise) and three to the right (clockwise). Look ahead. (Fig.16)



17. Following the preceding position, turn the body to the left. Lift up the left knee. Change the plane of the turn from horizontal to vertical. Make three counter clockwise circles with the staff. These movements are performed while holding the staff with both hands. Look to the left. (Fig. 17)



17



18

18. Following the preceding position, turn the body slightly to the left. Grab the staff with the left hand. Draw the staff to the left until it comes in front of the left knee (the staff is held by the inner side of the left arm). Bring the right palm in front of the chin. Look at lower part of the staff. (Fig. 18)

18a.- not shown. Take down the left foot and go into a *Standing Stance*. Put down the upper part of the staff on the floor .

Applications of the Staff Form

A study of the staff form in the music of the American Indians

Important The movement of the hand and feet are illustrated by pictures with

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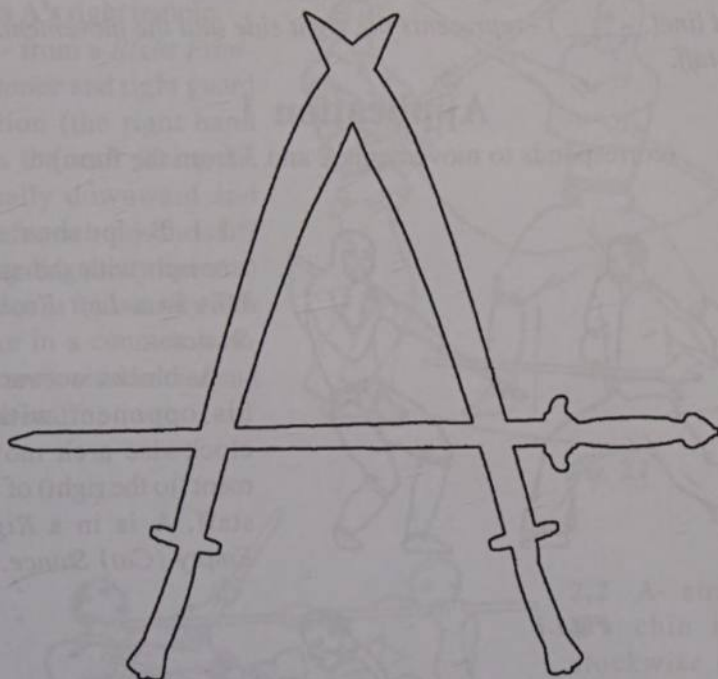
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Applications of the staff form

Important: The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:

Broken line(-----) - represents left side.

Solid line(_____) - represents the right side and the movements of the staff.

Application 1

(corresponds to movements 2 and 3 from the form)



Fig.1.1

1.1 B- pushes A's stomach with the staff. B is in a *Left Frontal Stance*.

A blocks outwardly his opponent with a clockwise arch movement (to the right) of the staff. A is in a *Right Empty (Cat) Stance*.

1.2 A- squats down in a *Right Knee Stance* and delivers a bottom-up stroke (in an arch) in B's crouch with the rear end of the staff.



Fig. 1.2

Application 2

(corresponds to movement 9 of the form)

2.1 B- delivers a round stroke with the staff towards A's right temple.

A- from a *Right Frontal Stance* and right guard position (the right hand holds the staff facing diagonally downward and the left one holds the staff facing diagonally upward) he blocks outwardly B's stroke in a counterclockwise arch with the rear end of the staff.

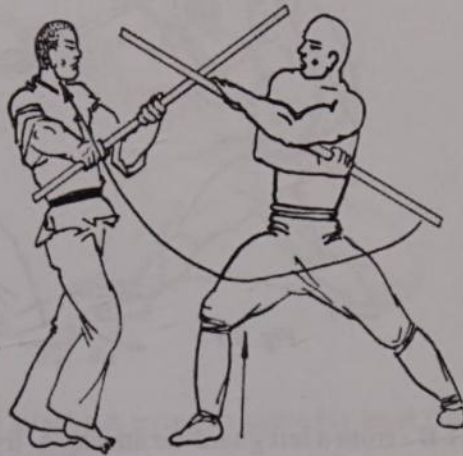


Fig. 2.1

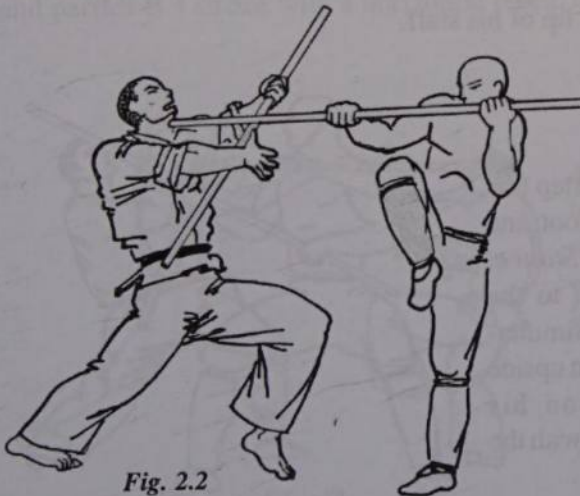


Fig. 2.2

2.2 A- strikes B's chin in a clockwise arch (slightly downward, forward and upward) with the rear end of the staff.

Application 3

(corresponds to movements 13 and 14 from the form)

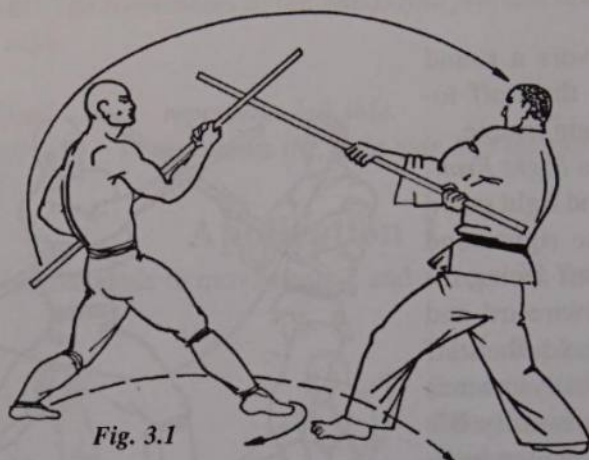


Fig. 3.1

3.1 B - from a left guard he attacks **A** trying to strike his left temple with the front tip of the staff.

A - from a right guard , he blocks outwardly his opponent's stroke with the front tip of his staff.

3.2 A - takes a large step forward with the left foot and goes into a *Horse Stance*, placing the left foot to the side of **B**'s left leg. Simultaneously, **A** delivers an upside - down stroke upon his opponent's forehead with the rear end of the staff.



Fig. 3.2

Application 4

(corresponds to movement 16 from the form)

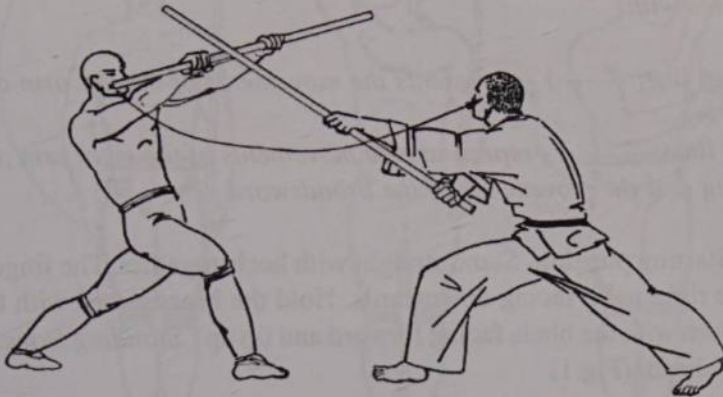
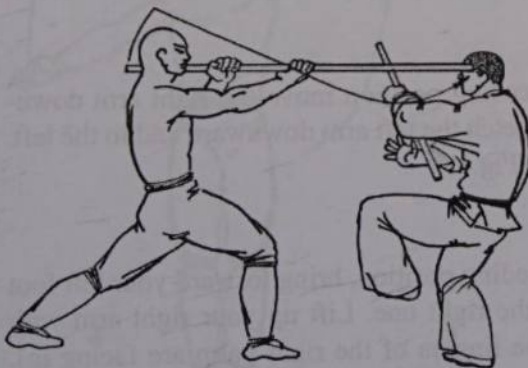


Fig. 4.1

4.1 B - from a left guard he attacks **A** trying to strike his head with an upside-down stroke of the staff.

A - from a right guard he moves the rear end of the staff forward and parries **B**'s stroke with a horizontal block.



4.2 A - turns the staff to the left delivering a stroke with the right end of the staff on **B**'s left temple.

Fig. 4.2

Broadsword form

Important: *The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:*

Broken line(-----) - represents the movements of the left arm and right leg.

Solid line(_____) - represents the movements of the right arm ,the left leg and the movements of the broadsword.

1. Starting position- Stand straight with heels together. The fingers of the right palm facing downwards. Hold the broadsword with the left palm with the blade facing forward and tip up (*Standing Stance*). Look ahead. (Fig.1)

2. Lift your right arm diagonally upwards with the palm facing inwards. Look at the right palm. (Fig.2)

3. Lift the handle of the broadsword upward. The blade is facing back and the tip downward. Put the right palm downwards on the back of the broadsword's blade. (Fig.3)

4. Following the preceding position move the right arm downwards and to the right. Stretch the left arm downward and to the left. Look at the right palm. (Fig.4)

5. Following the preceding position, bring forward your left foot and shift the weight to the right one. Lift up your right arm with palm facing upwards (the fingers of the right palm are facing in). Take down the handle of the broadsword. The blade is facing forward. Look to the left. (Fig.5)



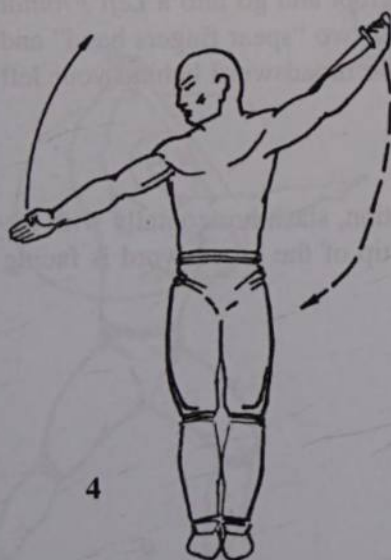
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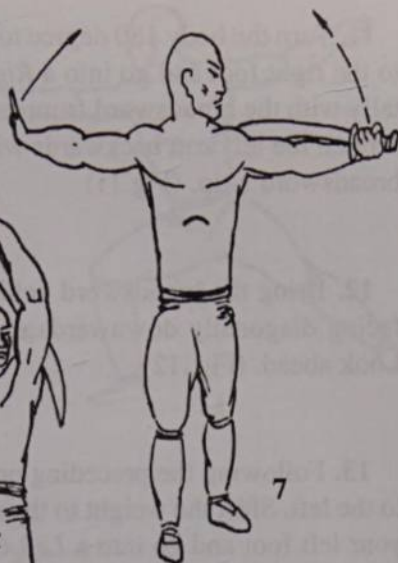
6. Take a small step forward with the left foot. Take down the right arm with the palm facing diagonally forward. Look to the left. (Fig.6)

7. Following the preceding position, step forward with the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Lift both arms up to shoulder level and stretch them aside. Turn the right palm to the right. Turn the left palm with the broadsword upwards until the blade is facing up. Look to the left. (Fig.7)

8. Step forward with the left foot and put it next to the right one. Lift up your arms over the head. Hold the handle of the broadsword with both hands. The tip of the broadsword is facing diagonally downwards. Look to the left. (Fig.8)

9. Step to the left with the left foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Change your left palm into a two "spear fingers hand" and stretch it to the left. Pull slightly the broadsword behind your left shoulder. (Fig.9)

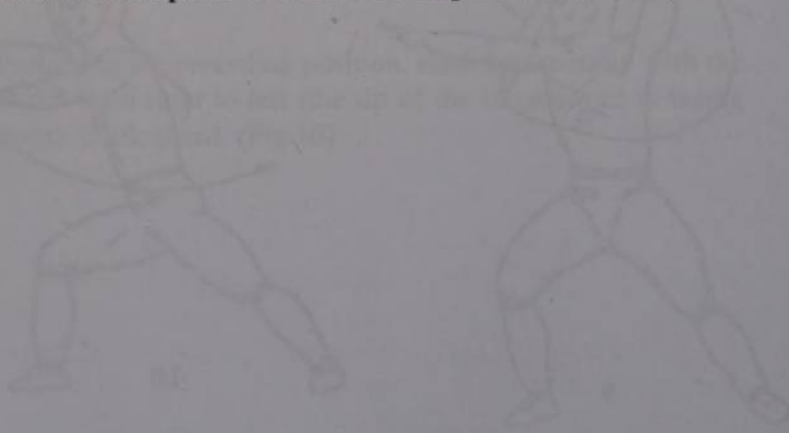
10. Following the preceding position, slash horizontally with the broadsword from right to left (the tip of the broadsword is facing backwards). Look ahead. (Fig.10)

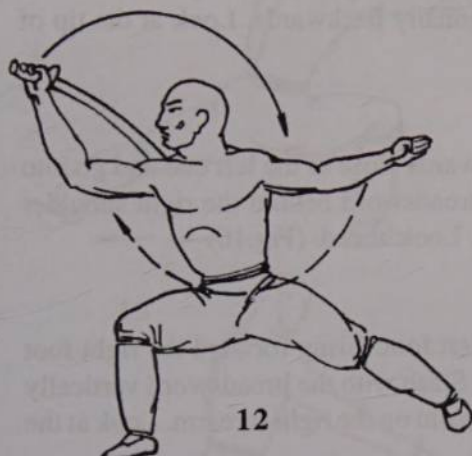
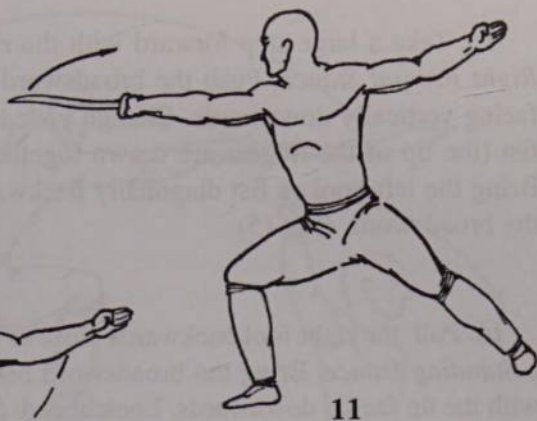


12. Bring the broadsword behind your right shoulder. The tip is facing diagonally downwards and the blade is facing backwards. Look ahead. (Fig. 12)

13. Following the preceding position, turn the body 180 degrees to the left. Shift the weight to the right foot. Pull slightly backwards your left foot and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Put the left arm under the right armpit with palm facing backwards. Draw the handle of the broadsword to the left shoulder. The blade is facing horizontally outwards. Look ahead. (Fig. 13)

14. Draw the broadsword downwards and backwards, slashing vertically. The blade is facing downwards and the tip is by the right knee. Move the left palm forward, stretching the arm. (Fig. 14)





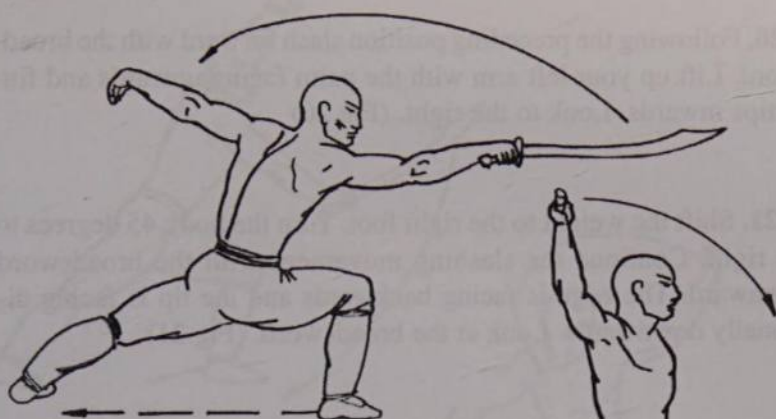
15. Take a large step forward with the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Push the broadsword forward. The blade is facing vertically downwards. Change your left palm into a hooked fist (the tip of the fingers are drawn together, facing downwards). Bring the left hooked fist diagonally backwards. Look at the tip of the broadsword. (Fig.15)

16. Pull the right foot backwards close to the left one and go into a *Standing Stance*. Bring the broadsword behind the right shoulder with the tip facing downwards. Look ahead. (Fig.16)

17. Shift the weight to the left foot. Bring forward the right foot and go into a *Right Cat Stance*. Slash with the broadsword vertically in front of yourself. Put the left palm on the right forearm. Look at the tip of the broadsword. (Fig.17)

18. Turn the body 45 degrees to the left. Shift 60% of the weight to the right foot. Move the broadsword with the tip facing to the left front and the edge facing down. Look to the left. (Fig.18)

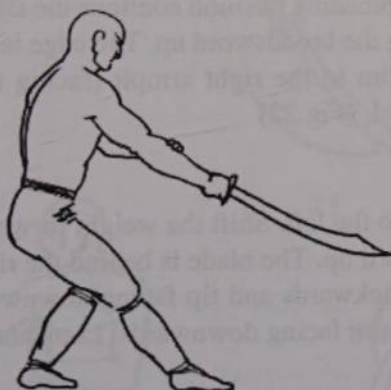
19. Step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Lift the right arm upwards until the upper part of the blade of the broadsword is situated over the left shoulder. The edge is facing up. Keep the left palm on the right forearm. Look to the right. (Fig.19)



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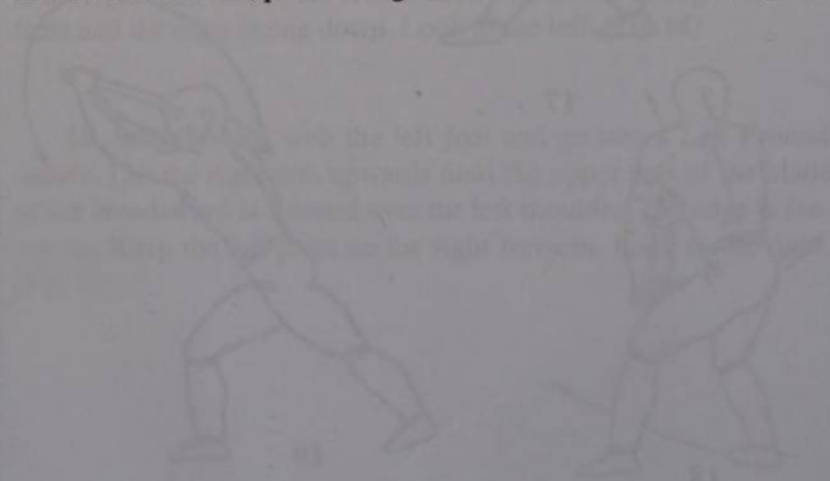
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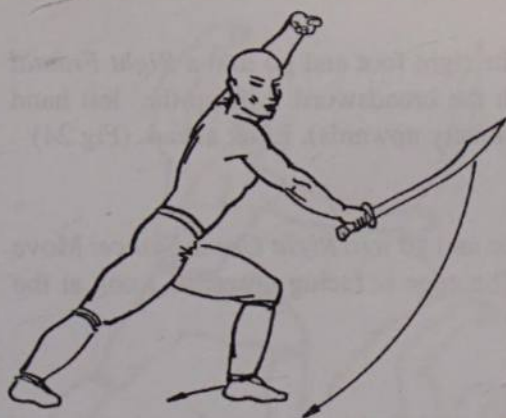
20. Following the preceding position slash forward with the broadsword. Lift up your left arm with the palm facing upwards and fingertips inwards. Look to the right. (Fig.20)

21. Shift the weight to the right foot. Turn the body 45 degrees to the right. Continue the slashing movement with the broadsword downward. The edge is facing backwards and the tip is facing diagonally downwards. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.21)

22. Following the preceding position continue the slashing movement in an arch, lifting the broadsword up. The edge is facing backwards. Put the left palm to the right armpit (facing to the right). Look at the broadsword. (Fig.22)

23. Turn the body to the left. Shift the weight forward to the left foot. Lift the broadsword up. The blade is behind the right shoulder with its edge facing backwards and tip facing downwards. Stretch forward the left arm, palm facing downwards. Look ahead. (Fig.23)





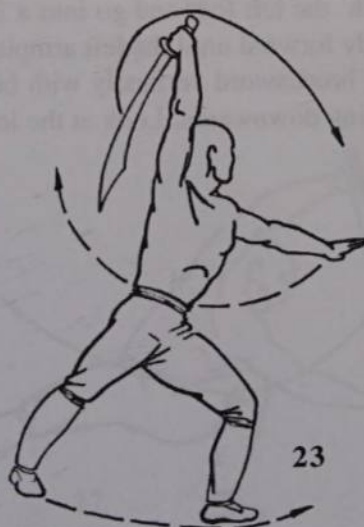
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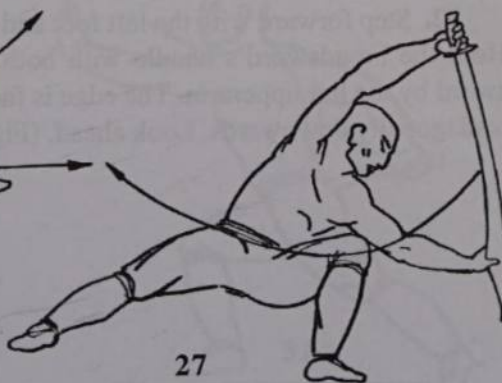
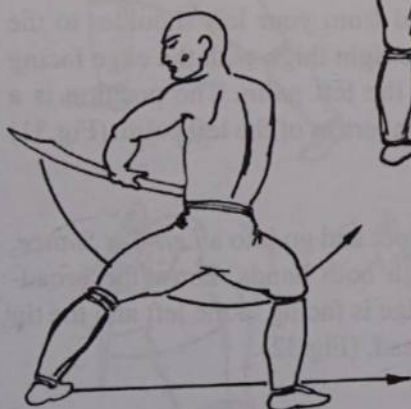
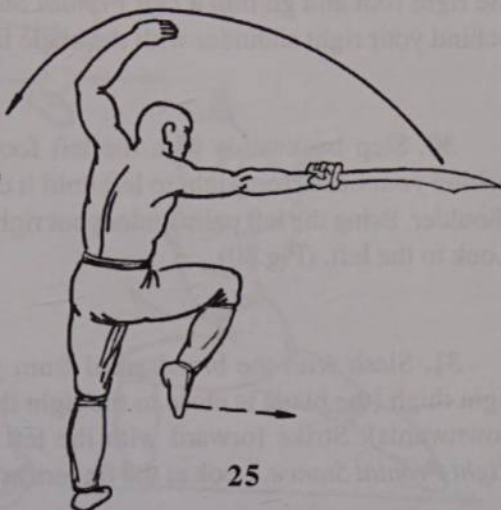
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24. Step forward with the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Slash forward with the broadsword. Lift up the left hand over your head (facing obliquely upwards). Look ahead. (Fig.24)

25. Lift up the right knee and go into *Right Crane Stance*. Move the broadsword forward. The edge is facing upwards. Look at the broadsword's tip. (Fig. 25)

26. Put down the right foot. Shift the weight to it and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Turn the body 90 degrees to the left. Slash with the broadsword in an arch backwards (counterclockwise). The edge is facing down and the tip back. Put the left palm on the back of the broadsword's blade. Look backwards. (Fig.26)

27. Following the preceding position take a large step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Low Frontal Stance*. Lean the body forward until the left armpit is placed over the left knee. Push the broadsword vertically with both palms. The tip of the blade is facing downwards. Look at the left palm. (Fig.27)



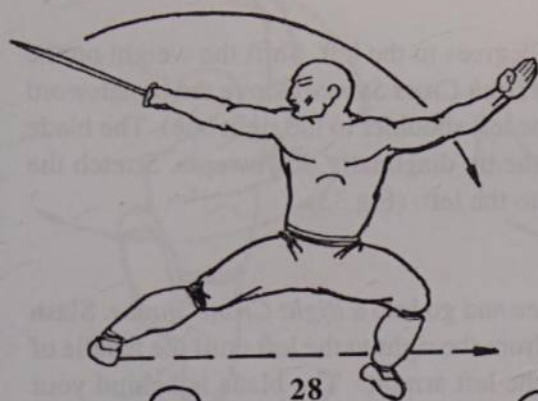
28. Turn the body to the right. Slash with the broadsword from left to right. Lift up and stretch backwards the left arm with the palm facing inwards. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.28)

29. Turn the body to the right. Take a large step backwards with the right foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Put the broadsword behind your right shoulder with the blade facing backwards.

30. Step backwards with the left foot. Move the broadsword behind your back from right to left until it comes in front of your left shoulder. Bring the left palm under your right armpit facing outwards. Look to the left. (Fig.30)

31. Slash with the broadsword from your left shoulder to the right thigh (the blade is close to the right thigh with the edge facing downwards). Strike forward with the left palm. The position is a *Right Frontal Stance*. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.31)

32. Step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Hold the broadsword's handle with both hands. Draw the broadsword by the left upperarm. The edge is facing to the left and the tip is diagonally downwards. Look ahead. (Fig.32)

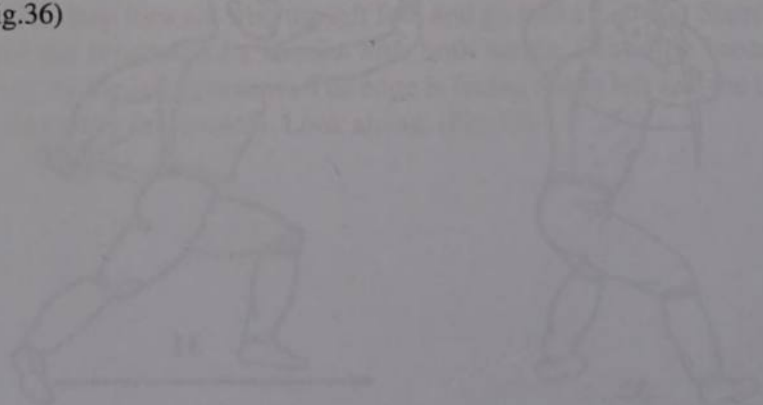


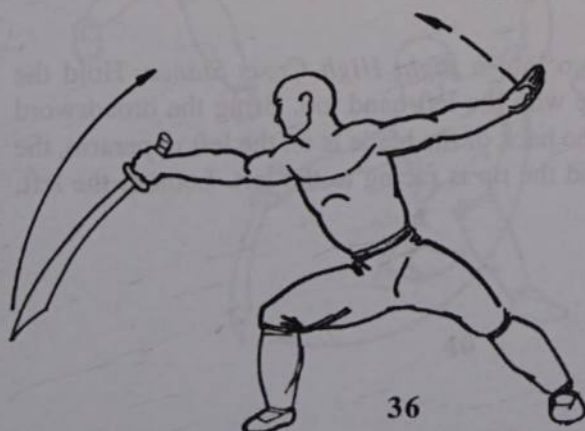
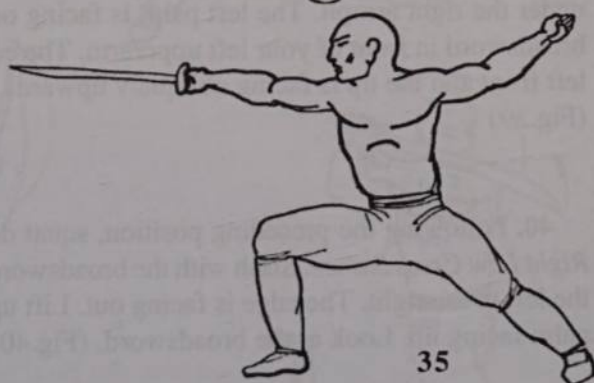
33. Turn the body 180 degrees to the left. Shift the weight on the left foot and go into a *Left High Cross Stance*. Move the broadsword behind your back (from the left shoulder to the right one). The blade is facing backwards and the tip diagonally downwards. Stretch the left arm to the left. Look to the left. (Fig.33)

34. Lift up your right knee and go into a *Right Crane Stance*. Slash in a large horizontal arch from the right to the left until the handle of the broadsword is under the left armpit. The blade is behind your back with its cutting edge facing backwards. Lift up the left arm with palm facing upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.34)

35. Take down the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Slash horizontally from the left to the right. The cutting edge of the broadsword is turned to the right. Stretch the left arm backwards with the palm facing diagonally out. Look ahead. (Fig.35)

36. Take down the broadsword. The cutting edge is faced diagonally up and the tip downwards. Look at the broadsword's blade. (Fig.36)





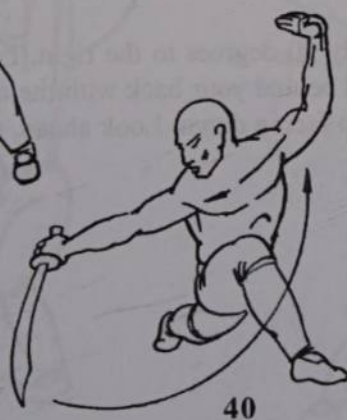
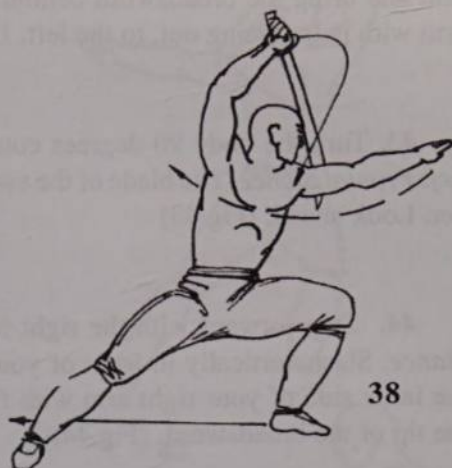
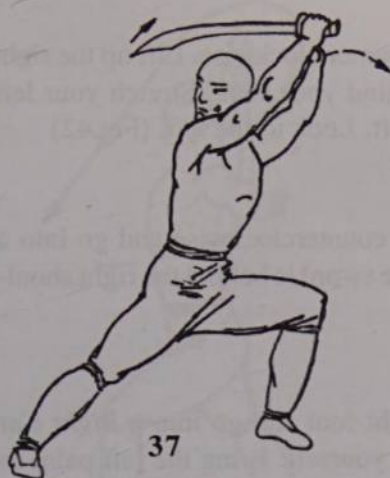
37. Hold the handle of the broadsword with both hands. Shift the weight to the left foot. Turning the right wrist clockwise, pull the broadsword upwards and backwards. The cutting edge is turned up and the tip to the right. Look to the right. (Fig.37)

38. Turn your head and body to the right. Stretch forward the left arm with palm facing downward. Bring the broadsword behind your left shoulder with the tip facing down. Look ahead. (Fig.38)

39. Draw the left foot backwards and go into *Right High Cross Stance*. Turn the body and the head to the right. Move the left palm under the right armpit. The left palm is facing outwards. Bring the broadsword in front of your left upperarm. The edge is facing to the left front and the tip is facing obliquely upwards. Look to the right. (Fig.39)

40. Following the preceding position, squat down and go into a *Right Low Cross Stance*. Slash with the broadsword downwards from the left to the right. The edge is facing out. Lift up the left arm with palm facing up. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.40)

41. Get up and go into a *Right High Cross Stance*. Hold the broadsword's handle with the left hand too. Bring the broadsword up and to the left. The back of the blade is on the left upperarm, the edge is facing up and the tip is facing to the left. Look to the left. (Fig.41)



42. Turn the body 90 degrees counter clockwise. Lift up the right arm and bring the broadsword behind your back. Stretch your left arm with palm facing out, to the left. Look to the left. (Fig.42)

43. Turn the body 90 degrees counterclockwise and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. The blade of the sword is behind the right shoulder. Look ahead. (Fig.43)

44. Step forward with the right foot and go into a *Right Cat Stance*. Slash vertically in front of yourself. Bring the left palm to the inner side of your right arm with fingertips facing up. Look at the tip of the broadsword. (Fig.44)

45. Following the preceding position turn the body 90 degrees to the left and continue the slashing movement of the broadsword in a circle, down and backwards. The edge is facing downwards and the tip backwards. Put the left palm on the right wrist. Look to the left. (Fig. 45)

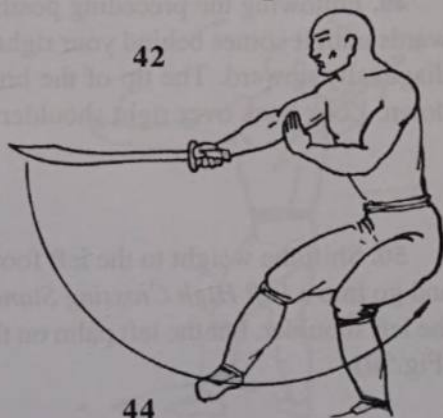
46. Turn your body 90 degrees to the right. Lift up both arms. Bring the broadsword behind your back with the edge facing backwards and with the tip facing down. Look ahead. (Fig.46)



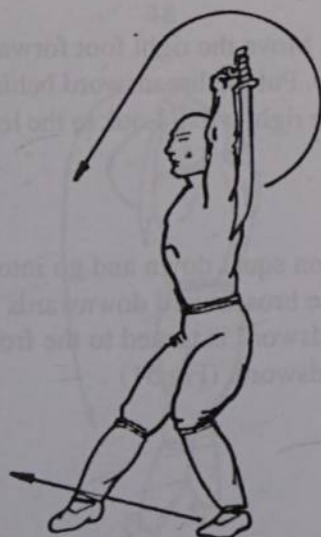
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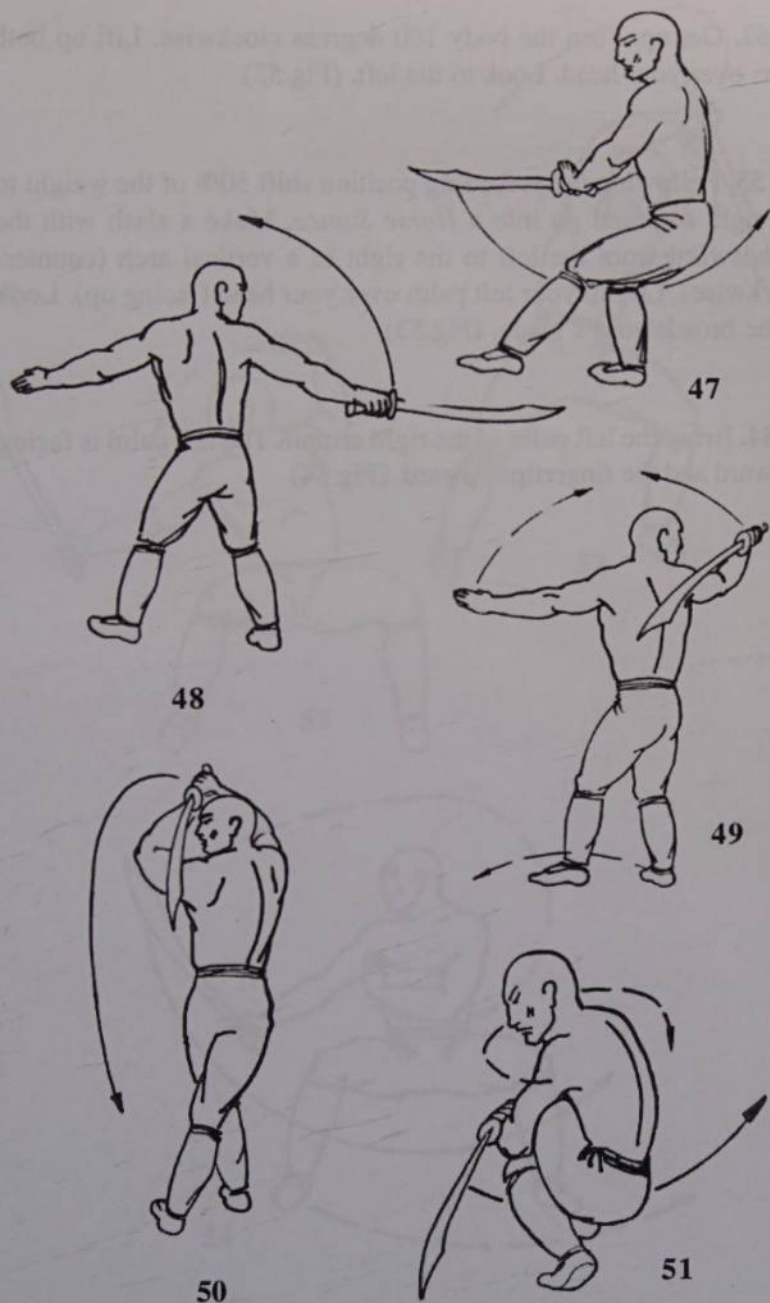
47. Take a step forward with the left foot and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Slash vertically in front of yourself. Support the slashing movement pressing down the handle of the broadsword with the left palm. Look at the tip of the blade. (Fig.47)

48. Turn your body 90 degrees to the right (clockwise). Slash in an arch downwards. The edge of the broadsword is facing downwards and the tip backwards. Stretch the left arm forward with the palm facing inward. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.48)

49. Following the preceding position, move the broadsword upwards until it comes behind your right shoulder with the edge facing diagonally upward. The tip of the broadsword is facing diagonally down. Look back over right shoulder. (Fig.48)

50. Shift the weight to the left foot. Move the right foot forward and go into a *Left High Crossing Stance*. Put the broadsword behind the left shoulder. Put the left palm on the right wrist. Look to the left. (Fig.50)

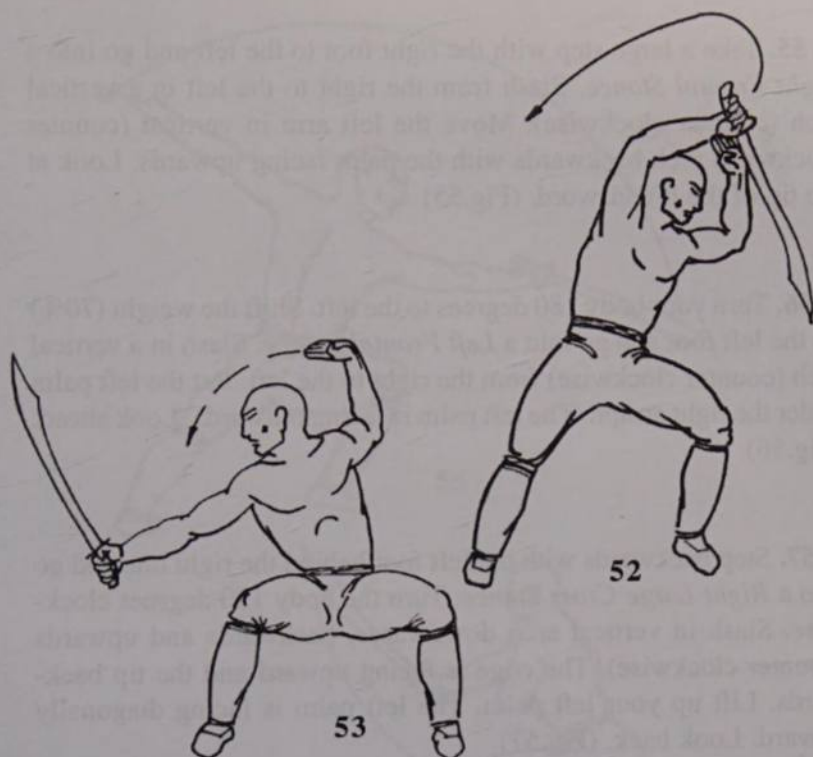
51. Following the preceding position squat down and go into a *Left Sitting Cross Stance*. Slash with the broadsword downwards in front of yourself. The edge of the broadsword is turned to the front and the tip to the left. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.51)



52. Get up. Turn the body 180 degrees clockwise. Lift up both arms over your head. Look to the left. (Fig.52)

53. Following the preceding position shift 50% of the weight to the right foot and go into a *Horse Stance*. Make a slash with the broadsword from the left to the right in a vertical arch (counter-clockwise). Lift up your left palm over your head (facing up). Look at the broadsword's blade. (Fig.53)

54. Bring the left palm to the right armpit. The left palm is facing outward and the fingertips upward. (Fig.54)

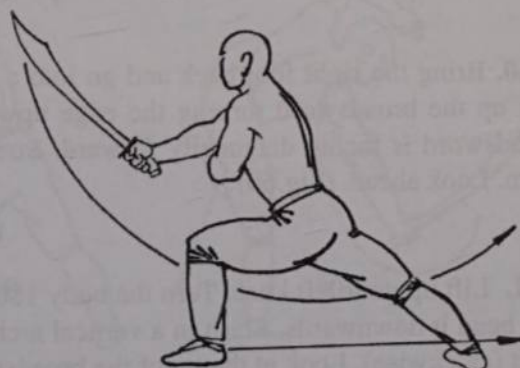
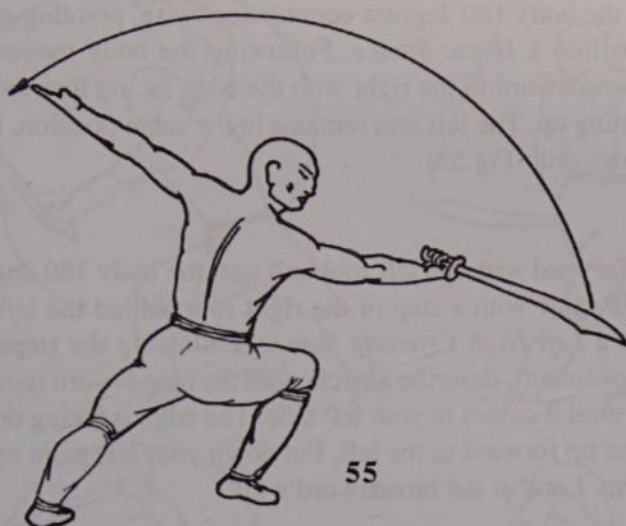


55. Take a large step with the right foot to the left and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Slash from the right to the left in a vertical arch (counter clockwise). Move the left arm in vertical (counter clockwise) arch backwards with the palm facing upwards. Look at the tip of the broadsword. (Fig.55)

56. Turn your body 180 degrees to the left. Shift the weight (70%) on the left foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Slash in a vertical arch (counter clockwise) from the right to the left. Put the left palm under the right armpit. The left palm is facing outwards. Look ahead. (Fig.56)

57. Step backwards with the left foot behind the right one and go into a *Right Large Cross Stance*. Turn the body 120 degrees clockwise. Slash in vertical arch downwards, backwards and upwards (counter clockwise). The edge is facing upward and the tip backwards. Lift up your left palm. The left palm is facing diagonally upward. Look back. (Fig.57)





58. Turn the body 180 degrees counterclockwise, pivoting on the toes and go into a *Horse Stance*. Following the body movement, move the broadsword to the right with the edge facing forward and the tip pointing up. The left arm remains in the same position. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.58)

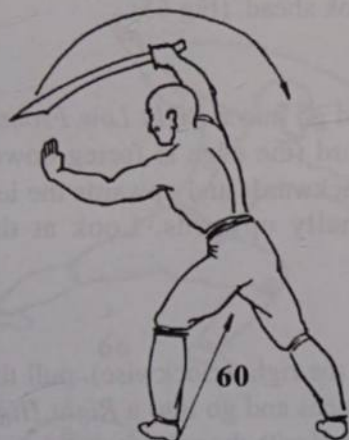
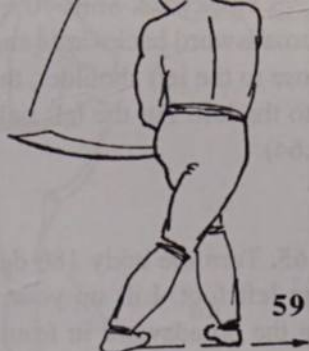
59. Step forward with the left foot and turn the body 180 degrees clockwise. Follow with a step of the right foot behind the left one and go into a *Left High Crossing Stance*. Following the steps and the body movements, describe a circle with the broadsword (counterclockwise) until it comes to your left side. The edge is facing downward and the tip forward to the left. Put down your left palm on the right forearm. Look at the broadsword's tip.

60. Bring the right foot back and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Lift up the broadsword turning the edge upwards. The tip of the broadsword is facing diagonally forward. Stretch forward the left palm. Look ahead. (Fig.60)

61. Lift up your left knee. Turn the body 180 degrees to the right and bend it downwards. Slash in a vertical arch from the left to the right (clockwise). Look at the tip of the broadsword. (Fig.61)

62. Put down your left foot. Shift 70% of the weight on the left foot. Draw the broadsword behind your back with the edge facing backwards and the tip down. Place the left palm under the right arm-pit. The left palm is facing out. Look to the right. (Fig.62)

63. Squat down and go into a *Right Snake Stance*. Turn the body 90 degrees to the right. Slash diagonally downwards (clockwise). Lift the left palm over your head. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.63)



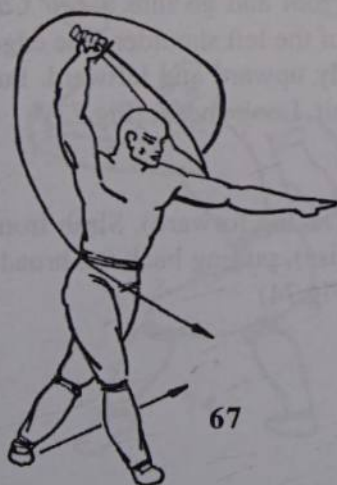
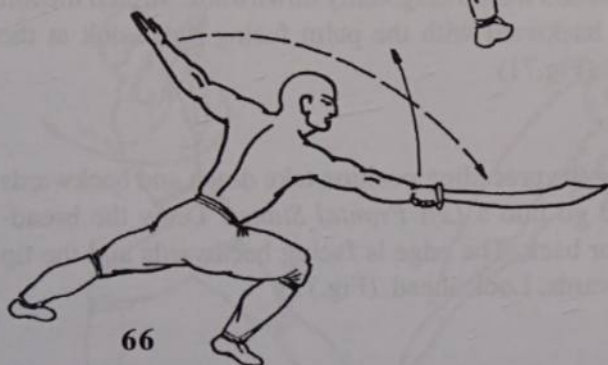
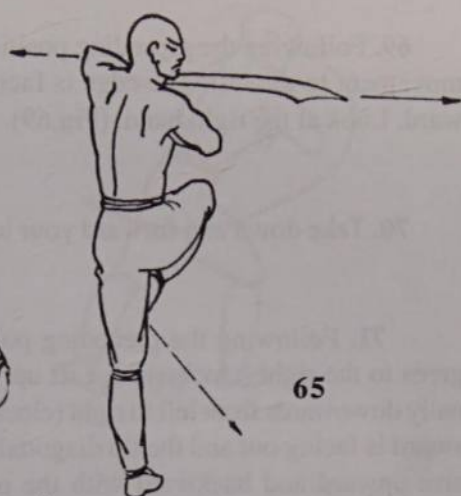
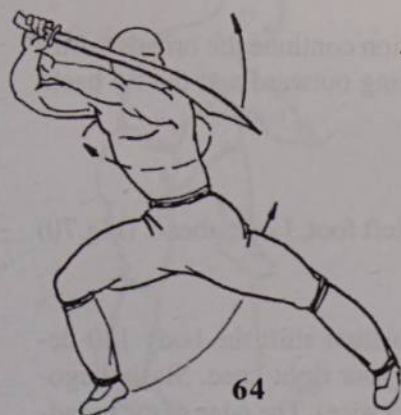
64. Get up. Step forward with the left foot. Turn the body 90 degrees clockwise. Shift 70% of the weight to the right foot. Draw the broadsword backwards and upwards. The upper part of the blade is close to the left shoulder, the edge is facing diagonally up and the tip, to the left. Put the left palm on the right wrist. Look to the left. (Fig.64)

65. Turn the body 180 degrees clockwise, pivoting on the toes of the left foot. Lift up your right knee. Following the body turn, bring the broadsword in front of yourself with the edge facing upwards and the tip facing forward. Look ahead. (Fig.65)

66. Take down the right foot and go into a *Right Low Frontal Stance*. Move the broadsword forward (the edge is facing downward and the tip forward). Stretch backwards and upwards the left arm with the palm facing diagonally upwards. Look at the broadsword's tip. (Fig.66)

67. Turn the body 90 degrees to the right (clockwise), pull the left foot slightly forward, twist the knees and go into a *Right High Cross Stance*. Stretch the left arm forward with the palm facing downward and fingertips forward. Lift up and draw the broadsword behind your back (the upper part of the blade is slightly over and behind the left shoulder). Look at the left fingertips. (Fig.67)

68. Lift up the left knee. Bent the body forward over the left knee. Slash with the broadsword in a diagonal circle (counter clockwise). Put the left palm on the right forearm. The edge of the broadsword is facing to the left and the tip is facing diagonally downward. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.68)



69. Following the preceding position continue the broadsword's movement to the left. The edge is facing outward and the tip backward. Look at the right hand. (Fig.69)

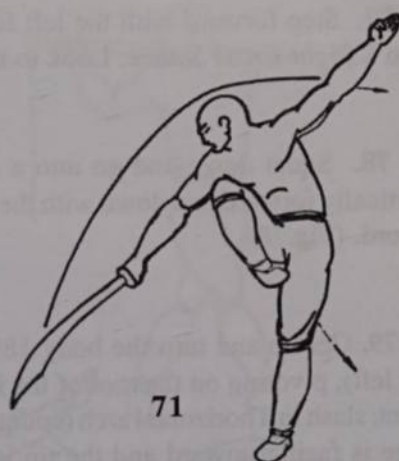
70. Take down and forward your left foot. Look ahead. (Fig.70)

71. Following the preceding position shift the body 180 degrees to the right (clockwise). Lift up your right knee. Slash diagonally downwards from left to right (clockwise). The edge of the broadsword is facing out and the tip diagonally downward. Stretch the left arm upward and backward with the palm facing out. Look at the broadsword's tip. (Fig.71)

72. Following the preceding position take down and backwards the right foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Draw the broadsword behind your back. The edge is facing backwards and the tip diagonally downwards. Look ahead. (Fig.72)

73. Shift the weight to the right foot and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Bring the broadsword in front of the left shoulder. The edge is facing forward and the tip diagonally upward and leftward. Put down the left palm under the right armpit. Look ahead. (Fig.73)

74. Stretch forward the left palm (facing forward). Slash from left to right in a diagonal arch (clockwise), pulling back the broadsword to the right thigh. Look ahead. (Fig.74)



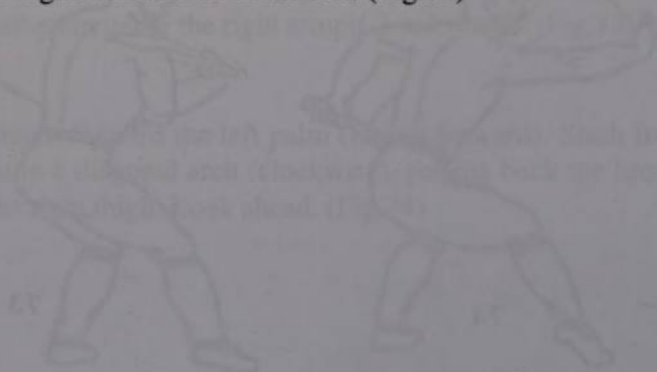
75. Move the broadsword forward, upwards, leftward and backward until it comes outwardly of the left shoulder. The edge is facing out to the left and the tip is facing diagonally downwards. Put the left palm on the right wrist. Look ahead. (Fig.75)

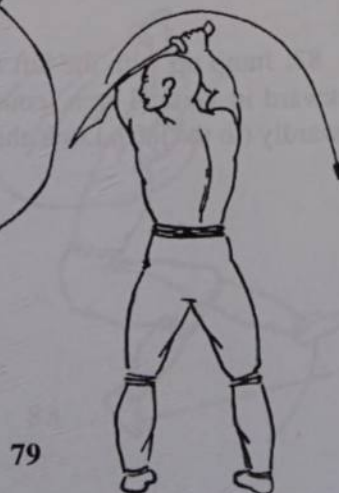
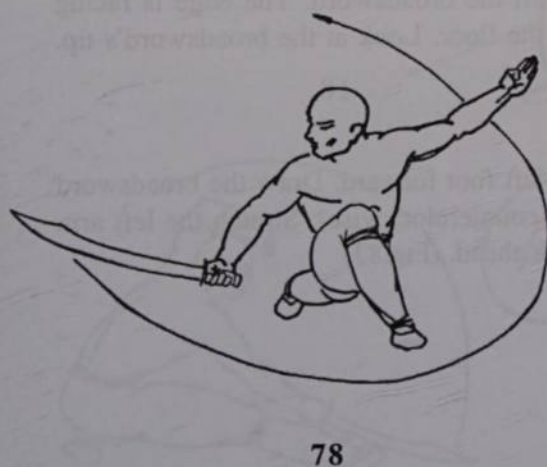
76. Stepping forward with the right foot, turn the body 180 degrees to the right (counter clockwise). Stretch the left arm with the palm facing backwards. Look forward slightly to the right. (Fig.76)

77. Step forward with the left foot behind the right one and go into a *Right Cross Stance*. Look to the right. (Fig.77)

78. Squat down and go into a *Right Low Cross Stance*. Slash vertically forward and down with the broadsword. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.78)

79. Get up and turn the body 180 degrees counterclockwise (to the left), pivoting on the toes of the feet. Following the body movement, slash in a horizontal arch (counterclockwise). The broadsword's edge is facing upward and the tip is facing to the left. Put the left palm on the right wrist. Look to the left. (Fig.79)



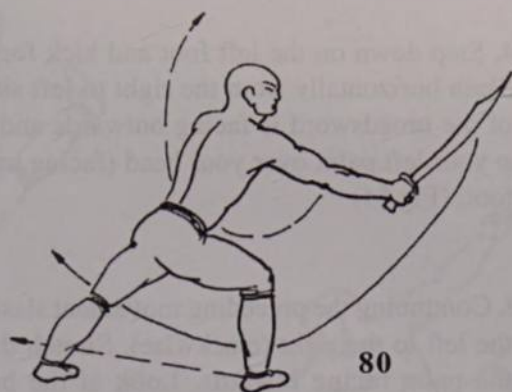


80. Following the preceding position, turn the body 90 degrees to the right (clockwise) and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Slash vertically forward and downward with the broadsword. Look ahead. (Fig.80)

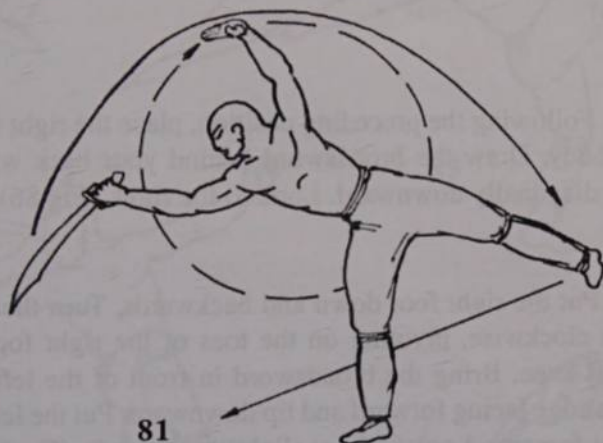
81. Following the preceding position, turn the body 180 degrees to the left (counterclockwise) and step forward (to the left front) with the right foot. Shift the weight to the right foot, bend the body forward, lift up and backwards the left leg. Following the body turn, slash in large vertical arch. The edge of the broadsword is diagonally upward. Stretch up your arm with the palm facing upwards. Look at the broadsword. (Fig.81)

82. Put the left foot down and far forward (behind the right leg). Shift the weight to the right foot, squat down on it and go into a *Right Snake Stance* (the right leg remains stretched). Following the steps, turn the body 180 degrees to the left. Slash vertically upward, forward and downward with the broadsword. The edge is facing downward and is close to the floor. Look at the broadsword's tip. (Fig.82)

83. Jump up with the left foot forward. Draw the broadsword backward in vertical arch (counterclockwise). Stretch the left arm outwardly (to the left). Look ahead. (Fig.83)



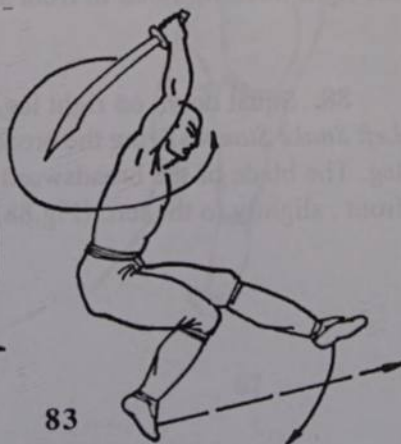
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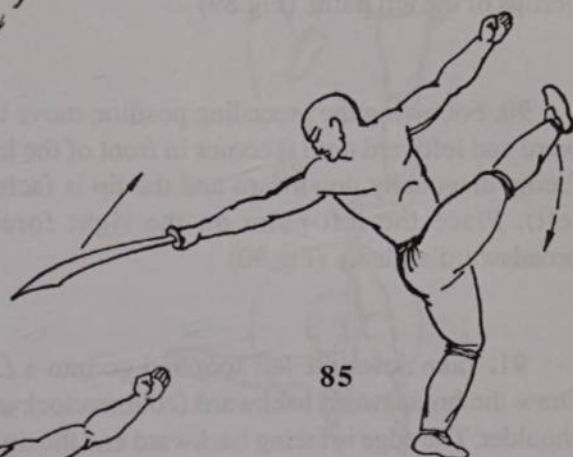
84. Step down on the left foot and kick forward with the right foot. Slash horizontally from the right to left side of the body. The edge of the broadsword is facing outwards and the tip backwards. Lift up your left palm over your head (facing upward). Look at the right foot. (Fig.84)

85. Continuing the preceding movement slash in a diagonal arch from the left to the right (clockwise). Stretch the left arm forward with the palm facing inwards. Look at the broadsword's edge. (Fig.85)

86. Following the preceding position, place the right knee close to the body. Draw the broadsword behind your back with the tip facing diagonally downward. Look to the right. (Fig.86)

87. Put the right foot down and backwards. Turn the body 180 degrees clockwise, pivoting on the toes of the right foot. Lift up your left knee. Bring the broadsword in front of the left shoulder with the edge facing forward and tip downward. Put the left palm on the right forearm. Look in front slightly to the left. (Fig.87)

88. Squat down on right leg, stretch the left one and go into a *Left Snake Stance*. Bring the broadsword downward close to the left leg. The blade of the broadsword is parallel to the left leg. Look in front, slightly to the left. (Fig.88)



89. Lift up the body and the left knee and go into a *Left Crane Stance*. Stretch forward the left palm. Pull backward the broadsword (the edge is facing diagonally backward and the tip is facing diagonally downward). Bend the body slightly forward. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.89)

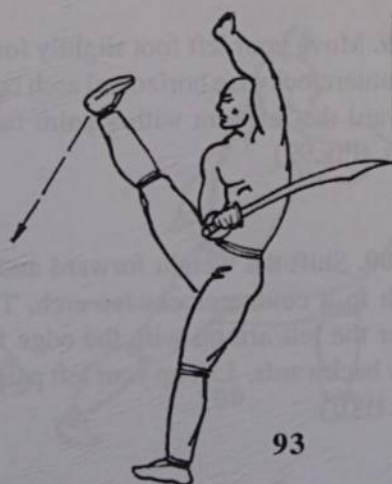
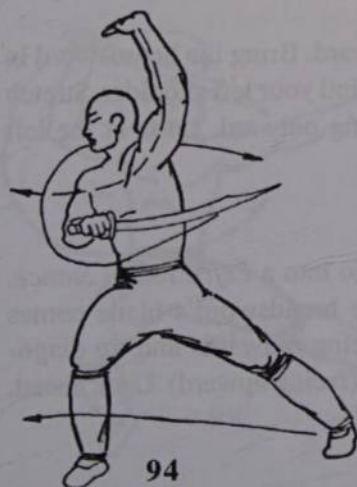
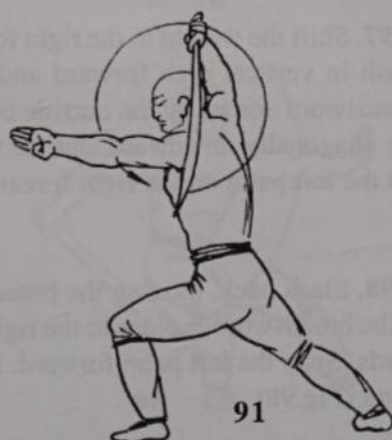
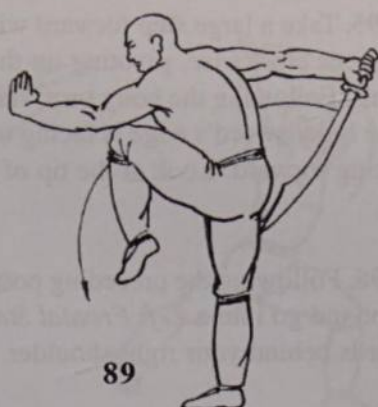
90. Following the preceding position move the broadsword forward and leftward until it comes in front of the left foot. The edge is facing diagonally downward and the tip is facing outwards (to the left). Place the left palm on the right forearm. Look at the broadsword's blade. (Fig.90)

91. Take down the left foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Draw the broadsword backward (counterclockwise) behind the left shoulder. The edge is facing backward and the tip downward. Stretch the left arm forward with the palm facing out. Look ahead. (Fig.91)

92. Slash diagonally in a counterclockwise circle until the back of the blade comes under the left armpit. The edge of the broadsword is facing outwards (to the left) and the tip is facing backwards. Stretch up the left arm with the palm facing upwards. Look ahead. (Fig.92)

93. Kick forward with right foot. Look at the right foot. (Fig.94)

94. Take down the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Look ahead. (Fig.94)



95. Take a large step forward with the left foot. Turn the body 180 degrees clockwise, pivoting on the toes of the left foot. Spread the arms. Following the body turn, slash in a clockwise horizontal arch. The broadsword's edge is facing outward (to the right) and the tip is facing forward. Look at the tip of the broadsword. (Fig.95)

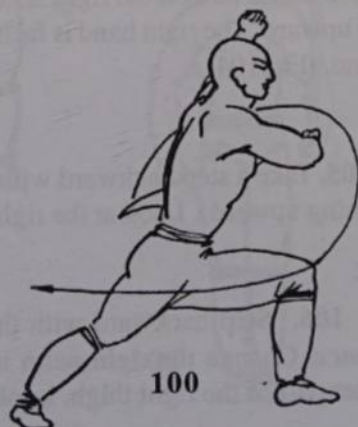
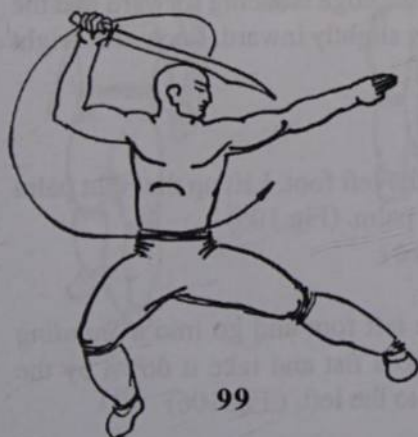
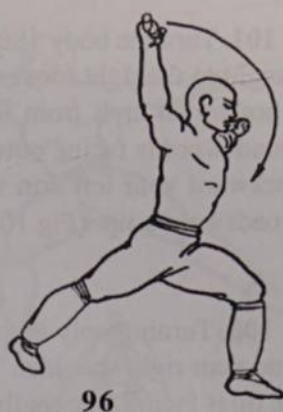
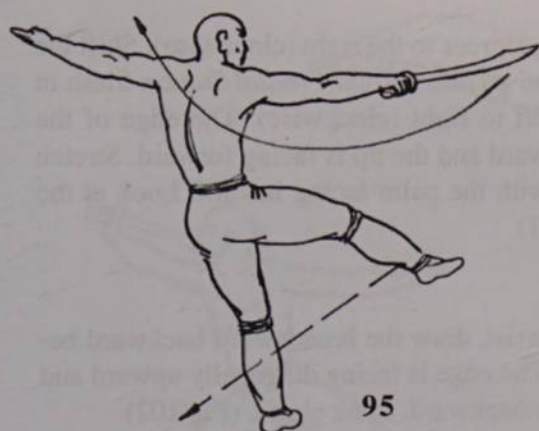
96. Following the preceding posture step backwards with the right foot and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Draw the broadsword backwards behind your right shoulder. Look ahead. (Fig.96)

97. Shift the weight to the right foot and go into a *Left Cat Stance*. Slash in vertical arch forward and downward. The handle of the broadsword comes by the outside of the right thigh, the edge is facing diagonally downward and the tip is facing diagonally upward. Put the left palm on the right forearm. Look down. (Fig.97)

98. Slash back, moving the broadsword to the rear side. The tip of the broadsword is close to the right knee facing diagonally downwards. Snap the left palm forward. Look at the fingertips of the left palm. (Fig.98)

99. Move your left foot slightly forward. Bring the broadsword in a counterclockwise horizontal arch behind your left shoulder. Stretch forward the left arm with a palm facing outward. Look at the left palm. (Fig.99)

100. Shift the weight forward and go into a *Left Frontal Stance*. Slash in a counterclockwise arch. The broadsword's blade comes under the left armpit with the edge facing outwards and tip diagonally backwards. Lift up your left palm (facing upward). Look ahead. (Fig.100)



101. Turn the body 180 degrees to the right (clockwise). Shift the weight to the right foot and go into a *Right Frontal Stance*. Slash in a horizontal arch from left to right (clockwise). The edge of the broadsword is facing outward and the tip is facing forward. Stretch backward your left arm with the palm facing inward. Look at the broadsword's tip. (Fig.101)

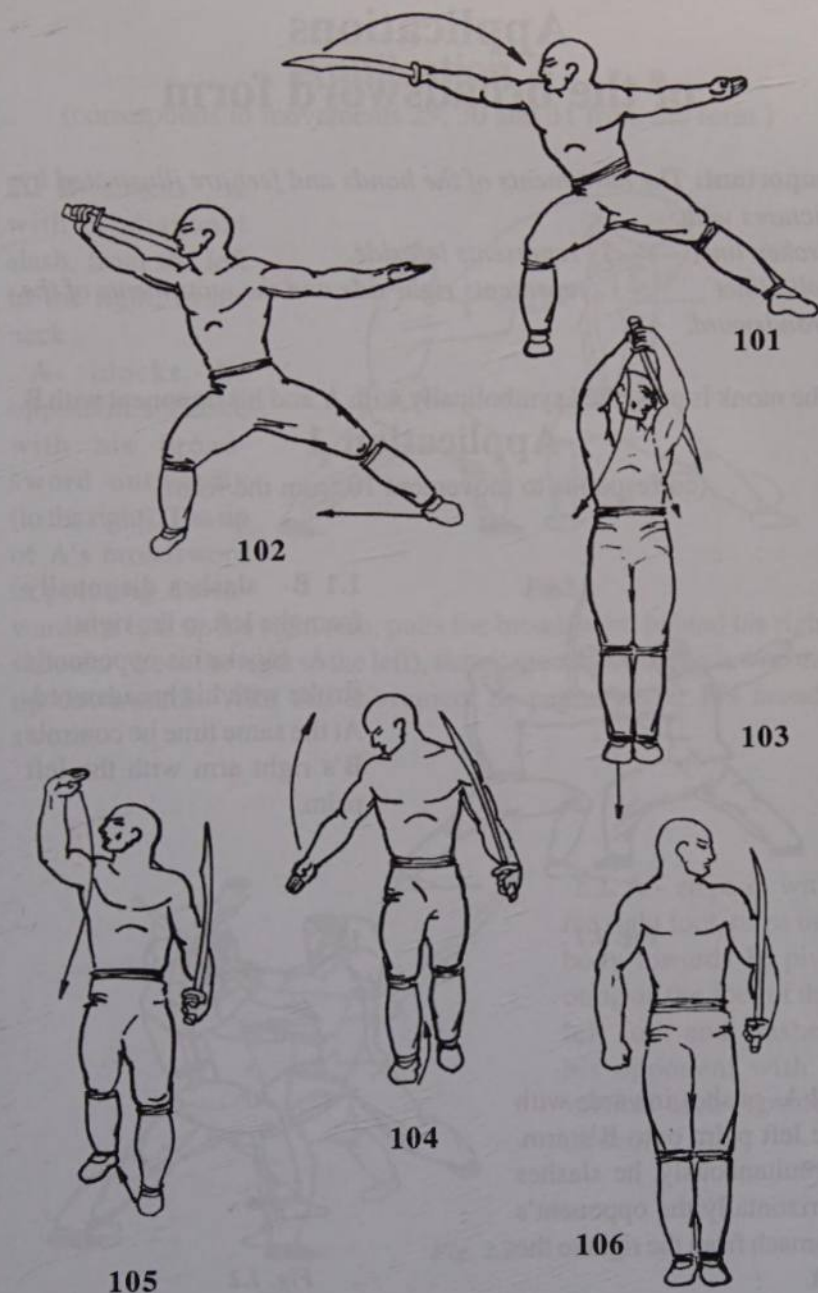
102. Turning only the wrist, draw the broadsword backward behind your right shoulder. The edge is facing diagonally upward and the tip is facing diagonally backward. Look ahead. (Fig.102)

103. Draw the left foot to the right one and go into a *Standing Stance*. Lift the handle of the broadsword over your head. The blade is behind the left shoulder with its edge facing to the left and with the tip facing diagonally downward. Hold the handle of the broadsword with the left hand too. Look to the left. (Fig.103)

104. Take a step forward with right foot. Transfer the broadsword's handle from the right to left hand. Put both arms down and aside. The broadsword's handle is in the left hand, the back of the blade is laid on the right arm, the edge is facing forward and the tip upward. The right hand is facing slightly inward. Look at the right hand. (Fig.104)

105. Take a step backward with the left foot. Lift up the right palm (facing upward). Look at the right palm. (Fig.105)

106. Step backward with the left foot and go into a *Standing Stance*. Change the right palm into a fist and take it down by the outer part of the right thigh. Look to the left. (Fig.106)



Applications of the broadsword form

Important: The movements of the hands and feet are illustrated by pictures with:

Broken line(-----) - represents left side.

Solid line(_____) - represents right side and the movements of the broadsword.

The monk is presented symbolically with A, and his opponent with B

Application 1

(corresponds to movement 10 from the form)



Fig. 1.1

1.1 B- slashes diagonally from the left to the right.

A- blocks his opponent's stroke with his broadsword. At the same time he controls B's right arm with the left palm.



Fig. 1.2

1.2 A- pushes inwards with the left palm onto B's arm. Simultaneously, he slashes horizontally the opponent's stomach from the right to the left.

Application 2

(corresponds to movements 29, 30 and 31 from the form)

2.1 B- attacks **A** with a diagonal slash, from the left to the right, to his neck .

A- blocks the opponent's stroke with his broadsword outwardly (to the right). The tip of **A's** broadsword is pointing downwards.

A lifts up his right arm, pulls the broadsword behind his right shoulder (from the right to the left), simultaneously, turning it with the tip downwards. With this movement he passes under **B's** broadsword.

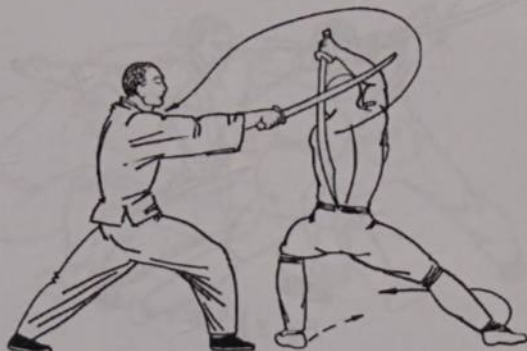


Fig.2.1



Fig. 2.2

2.2. A - steps in with the right foot, turns the body towards **B**, pivoting on the toes of the left foot and slashes his opponent with a vertical arch (upside-down).

Application 3

(corresponds to movements 57 and 78 from the form)



Fig. 3.1

3.1. B- slashes horizontally inwards into A's neck.

A-from a right guard (the right foot is forward, the broadsword is in the right hand with the blade facing forward and tip diagonally upward)

he blocks with the left palm B's right wrist. Simultaneously, he steps towards his opponent with the left foot and goes into a *Right Cross Stance*. A strikes, with the broadsword downwards in a vertical arch, into B's thigh.

Application 4

(corresponds to movement 71 from the form)

4.1 B- falling down in a *Right Snake Stance*, he slashes inwards (from the right to the left) A's right leg.

A- from a right guard, he pulls and lifts up his right leg to avoid B's attack and slashes vertically downwards his opponent's arm.



Fig. 4.1

Application 5

(corresponds to movements 27 and 82 from the form)



Fig. 5.1

5.1 B- swings with the broadsword bottom-up and from the left to the right.

A- blocks vertically (the tip of the broadsword is downward). Simultaneously, he presses inwardly **B's** broadsword with both hands (the left palm catches the back of the blade in the upper part of the broadsword).



Fig. 5.2

5.2 A- moves the right leg 180 degrees clockwise towards **B's** right leg, pivoting on the toes of the left foot. At the same time he catches **B's** right wrist and cuts his left leg.

Application 6

(corresponds to movement 90 from the form)

6.1B- moves the sword forward towards A.

A- pulls backward and lifts up his right leg. At the same time he blocks downwards with a diagonal stroke of the broadsword the opponent's stroke.

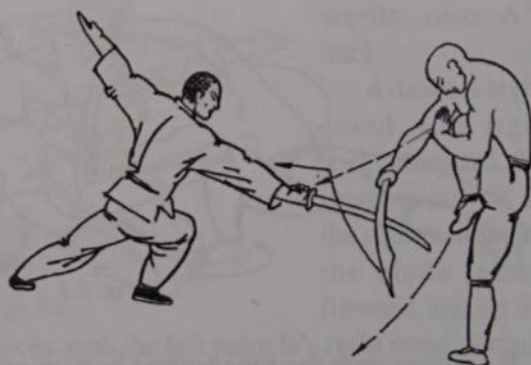


Fig. 6.1

6.2 A - parries inwardly, with his left arm, B's stroke and takes a large step forward with the left foot. Simultaneously, he cuts his opponent's neck in a bottom-up arch.

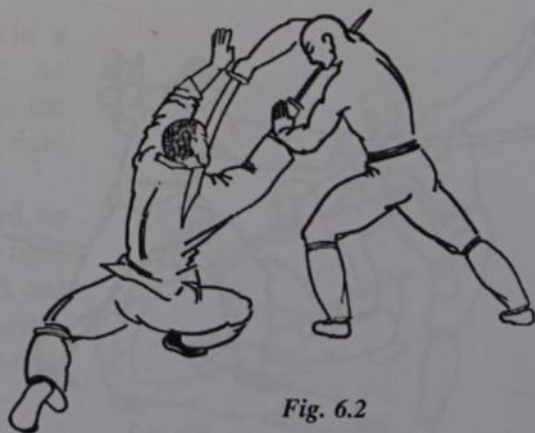


Fig. 6.2

Application 7

(corresponds to movement 85 from the form)



Fig. 7.1

7.1 A- is attacked by two opponents from the front and from the back. He performs a high front kick into the chin of the one who is in front of him. Simultaneously, he slashes the right leg of the opponent at his back.

Conclusion

The vast variety of styles, forms and techniques in Wushu can not be comprehended neither in one, nor in hundreds of books. Such was not the goal of the this issue. The deeper we go into the world of Martial Art, the better we understand how poor our knowledge is. One human life is not enough for mastering even of few of the Wushu styles. In spite of this, the correct practical choice in learning a particular style, as well as the exploration of the characteristics of the others, one, can achieve an understanding of the common principles of Martial Arts.

The presentation of the popular forms from different style directions and their combat interpretations can help the reader get acquainted with relative classification of the Wushu styles used in the international practice. Undoubtedly, this would help every beginning enthusiast in the correct choice of style, responding to his/her skills. On the other hand, those who are advanced in their practice can think over and enrich their individual program. The best illustration of the above are the words of the ancient sage:

"To better see your mountain , you should climb the neighboring one..."



About the author

Andrean Karavastev is European Martial Arts expert. Born in Bulgaria (1956) he is one of the founding members of Bulgarian Wushu Federation and he has been involved in the practices of Wushu/Kung Fu for the past twenty five years. His teacher is the legendary European master Dr. Dorijan Alexandrov who has studied from world renown Chinese grandmasters like Yang Jing Pin (Hsing I, Tai Chi, Chin Na, Chi Kung), Lu Kwok Chen (Pa Kua), Lu Jwing and others. Andrean Karavastev attended the Institute of Veterinary Medicine and Zooengineering (now Tracian University), where received master degree in Zooengineering (1981). Later he specialized in the field of Biotechnology. His education in Wushu/Kung Fu began in the Kung Fu Club at the same university in 1978. The following are some of the highlights of Andrean Karavastev's career; member of the first National team, cofounder of Bulgarian Wushu Federation, Senior Instructor (Bulgarian Wushu Federation), General Judge, organizer of the firsts national competitions, researcher, publisher writer. Specialist in Hsing I, Tai Chi Chuan (Yang and Chen Styles), Shaolin, Chin Na, military and police techniques, he has written seven book and many articles about Martial Arts. A lot of his students are top competitors and golden medalists from many competition in Europe.

Now living in the USA. A. Karavastev focuses on teaching his students for self improvement, self defense and inner harmony.

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Wushu

The Ultimate Fighting Art

by
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\$22.95

Wushu - The Ultimate Fighting Art

STYLE DIRECTIONS, STYLES AND THEIR COMBAT APPLICATIONS

Wushu- Experience and tradition

Wushu- A synonym of warrior art

Wushu- Diversity of styles and style directions

Wushu- The way to achieve spiritual and cognitive perfection

Wushu- A method of life and behavior

Wushu- The origin of the martial arts of the Orient

In this illustrated publication we have presented in practice the main style directions of the Chinese Martial Art- Wushu. By studying the forms and analyzing their combat applications the reader will get acquainted with the interesting world of the martial arts in general. The basic motto of the book is "Ten ounces practice are more than thousands of tones theory". Summarizing a big amount of material is what makes "Wushu -The Ultimate Fighting Art" a very useful manual and a gift for most martial artists and for people with versatile interests.



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